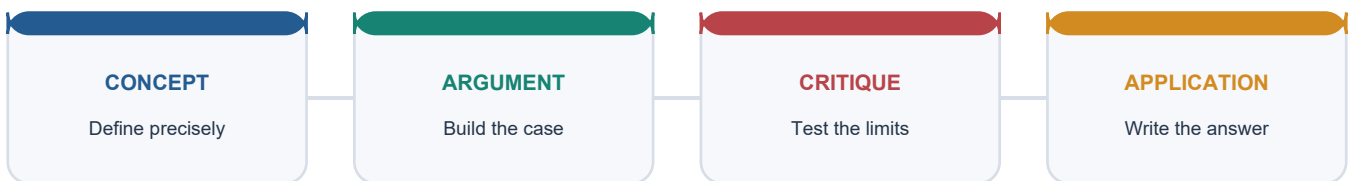


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A, item 6 | Twelve teaching sessions, 32 MCQs, 14 solved PYQs, six original
Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Complete Learning Session	4
What this package contains	4
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	4
CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SOURCE TERM IMMEDIATELY AFTER	4
ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT	6
HOW TO READ THIS SESSION	7
ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM	7
ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP	8
SESSION 1 - THE ANALYTIC REVOLT: THREE PROGRAMMES, ONE TARGET, AND THE ATTRIBUTION FIREWALL	9
SESSION 2 - MOORE'S DEFENCE OF COMMON SENSE: TRUISMS, KNOWING AGAINST ANALYSING, AND COMPARATIVE CERTAINTY	14
SESSION 3 - MOORE'S PROOF OF AN EXTERNAL WORLD: THREE CONDITIONS, TWO HANDS, AND THE SCEPTICAL REPLY	19
SESSION 4 - MOORE'S REFUTATION OF IDEALISM: AWARENESS, OBJECT AND THE TRANSPARENCY THESIS	24
SESSION 5 - RUSSELL'S INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND THE THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS	29
SESSION 6 - ACQUAINTANCE AND DESCRIPTION: THE EPISTEMOLOGY THE LOGIC WAS BUILT TO SERVE	34
SESSION 7 - LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS AND THE SUPREME MAXIM	39
SESSION 8 - RUSSELL'S LOGICAL ATOMISM: ATOMIC FACTS, TRUTH-FUNCTIONS, ISOMORPHISM AND NEGATIVE FACTS	44
SESSION 9 - THE TRACTATUS: FACTS, OBJECTS, STATES OF AFFAIRS AND THE PICTURE THEORY OF MEANING	49
SESSION 10 - BIPOLARITY, LOGICAL SPACE, THE GENERAL FORM OF THE PROPOSITION, AND THE TWO WAYS OF FAILING TO SAY ANYTHING	54
SESSION 11 - SAYING AND SHOWING: THE LIMIT OF LANGUAGE, THE MYSTICAL, THE LADDER AND PROPOSITION 7	60
SESSION 12 - COMPARISONS, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVES AND PROVENANCE	67
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	76
32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills	76
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	93
Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below	93
SUPPORTING ROUTED PARTS THAT NAME THE TRIO BUT ARE OWNED ELSEWHERE	107

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	108
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	111
Prerequisite check before using this block	111
A1. Descriptions after the textbook solution CAUTION:	111
A2. Logical constructions or phenomenal reduction? CAUTION:	112
A3. What "showing" finally means CAUTION:	112
A4. Russell's paradox and the theory of types ANALYSIS: - background, not a printed limb	112
A5. Solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the limit ANALYSIS:	113
A6. Moore's naturalistic fallacy - named here only to be excluded WRONG:	113
Conceptual links - not current-affairs items	113
Source trail for this block	113
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	113
A. Attribution map - who owns what, and what is not owned at all	114
B. Chronology and provenance - examiner-checked	114
C. Moore - the defence of common sense	114
D. Moore - the proof of an external world	115
E. Moore - the refutation of idealism	115
F. Russell - incomplete symbols and the theory of descriptions	115
G. Russell - acquaintance, description and logical constructions	116
H. Russell - logical atomism	116
I. Early Wittgenstein - ontology and the picture theory	116
J. Early Wittgenstein - sense, logical space and the general form	117
K. Early Wittgenstein - saying, showing and the ladder	117
L. Comparisons and the criticism ledger	118
M. Exam craft - directives, architecture, traps and the answer spine	118
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	119

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein : Defence of Commonsense; Refutation of Idealism; Logical Atomism; Logical Constructions; Incomplete Symbols; Picture Theory of Meaning; Saying and Showing - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 6. The official paper prints "**Sying**"; that printed wording is retained when the clause is quoted, and the correct doctrine-name **Saying and Showing** is used everywhere else. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute or a contested attribution. Moore and Russell are cited by **paper and year**; the *Tractatus* is cited by **decimal proposition number**, because the numbering is Wittgenstein's own and is identical in every edition and translation, whereas page numbers and wordings are not. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the source term follows immediately in parentheses - *to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)*, *state of affairs (Sachverhalt)*, *sense (Sinn)*, *senseless (sinnlos)* as against *nonsensical (unsinnig)*, *picture or model (Bild)* and *to depict (abbilden)*, *pictorial form (Form der Abbildung)*, *logical form (logische Form)*, *logical space (logischer Raum)*, *fundamental idea (Grundgedanke)*, *this is how things stand (Es verhält sich so und so)*, *said (gesagt)* as against *shown (gezeigt)*. Moore and Russell wrote in English, so their sentences are quotable as written; every English sentence attributed to Wittgenstein is a **translation**, and where Ogden/Ramsey and Pears-McGuinness diverge the divergence is stated rather than hidden.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	12
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	14
Supporting routed parts that name the trio but are owned elsewhere	3
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	13 (A-M)
ASCII master flow panels authored	28

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SOURCE TERM IMMEDIATELY AFTER

THE ONE MOVE THIS CLAUSE MAKES
 A PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEM IS TO BE SETTLED BY EXAMINING THE
 PROPOSITION THAT STATES IT - WHAT IT COMMITS US TO, WHAT ITS
 LOGICAL FORM ACTUALLY IS, AND WHETHER IT HAS SENSE AT ALL.
 ANALYSIS REPLACES SYSTEM-BUILDING. THAT IS THE REVOLT.

THE INHERITANCE THAT FORCES THE MOVE
 BRITISH ABSOLUTE IDEALISM (Bradley, McTaggart, and the Hegelian
 inheritance behind them): reality is one spiritual whole, ordinary
 things and relations are "appearance", and the argument runs
 through internal relations and degrees of truth.
 THE REVOLT: three men, three different scalpels, ONE negative
 target - the claim that a system may overturn what we ordinarily
 know or ordinarily say.

G. E. MOORE	B. RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
1873-1958	1872-1970	1889-1951
DEFENDS	DISSECTS	PICTURES
DEFENCE OF COMMONSENSE (1925 truisms)	LOGICAL ATOMISM (1918 lectures)	PICTURE THEORY OF MEANING (Tractatus)
REFUTATION OF IDEALISM (1903, act/object)	INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS + THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS ("On Denoting" 1905)	SAYING AND SHOWING (4.12-4.1212, 6.522)
PROOF OF AN EXTERNAL WORLD (1939, two hands)	LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS (1914 maxim)	facts / objects / states of affairs; logical space; bipolarity; the general form of the proposition;
comparative CERTAINTY, not proof of premises	acquaintance / description is the epistemology	sinnlos vs unsinnig; the ladder and 7
analysis may fail while KNOWLEDGE survives	the logic serves	the LIMIT is drawn IN language, from inside; the other side is nonsense

THE ONE SHARED INSIGHT - AND THE THREE DIFFERENT USES OF IT
 GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM
 MOORE the ordinary judgement is safe; its ANALYSIS is the
 hard part, and difficulty of analysis does not cancel
 knowledge
 RUSSELL the ordinary sentence is misleading; QUANTIFIED form
 dissolves the pseudo-entity ("the golden mountain")
 WITTGENSTEIN the ordinary sentence has sense only by SHARING
 logical form with a possible situation - and that
 sharing can never itself be stated

WHERE THE THREE PROGRAMMES END
 MOORE burden of proof reversed; no neutral criterion of
 knowledge supplied
 RUSSELL ontological economy achieved; the final inventory of
 simples never fixed, and negative facts admitted as a cost
 TRACTATUS the sayable exhaustively characterised; the book's own
 sentences fall outside it - hence 6.54, the ladder

WHAT IS NOT OWNED HERE
 VERIFICATION PRINCIPLE Topic 07, Logical Positivism
 MEANING AS USE, LANGUAGE-GAMES,
 FAMILY RESEMBLANCE, PRIVATE
 LANGUAGE Topic 08, Later Wittgenstein
 STRAWSON'S OWN SEMANTICS Topic 11, Quine and Strawson
 BERKELEY'S IMMATERIALISM Topic 03, Empiricism
 HEGEL'S ABSOLUTE IDEALISM Topic 05, Hegel
 THE NATURALISTIC FALLACY AND
 THE OPEN QUESTION ARGUMENT ... Moore's ETHICS, not this clause

*Concept spine: read it downward. One inherited target, three scalpels, one shared insight used three different ways,
 and three different endings.*

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the ownership rule, "Moore DEFENDS, Russell DISSECTS, Wittgenstein PICTURES."** Nine of the ten commonest errors in this topic are attribution errors. Fix the owner before you write the doctrine.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - Russell's descriptions in three beats, "E-U-P".** Existence -> Uniqueness -> Predication. Write the three conjuncts, then the scope point, then the puzzle solved.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - Moore's proof in three tests, "D-K-F".** Different premiss from conclusion -> premiss Known, not merely believed -> conclusion Follows.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the Tractatus ladder of sense, "B-L-G".** Bipolarity (the condition of sense) -> Logical space (where the possibilities live) -> General form of the proposition (the rule that generates all of them).

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the two failure-words, "S before U".** Sinnlos = *senseless but well-formed (tautology, contradiction)*. Unsinnig = nonsensical, no sense at all (metaphysical pseudo-proposition). Writing them as synonyms is a marked error.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Classification	Content
CORE MAINS	Moore's list of truisms and the knowing/analysing distinction (1925); the comparative-certainty method and the reversal of the burden of proof; the two-hands proof and Moore's own three conditions for a rigorous proof (1939); the awareness/object distinction and the transparency or diaphanous thesis, with the blue-green-consciousness sentence (1903); Russell's incomplete symbol and the contextual analysis of definite descriptions into existence, uniqueness and predication ("On Denoting", 1905); the three puzzles - negative existentials, excluded middle, substitutivity in attitude contexts; primary and secondary occurrence; the acquaintance/description distinction and the Principle of Acquaintance; logical constructions and the supreme maxim (1914); atomic and molecular propositions, atomic facts, the isomorphism thesis and negative facts (1918); "logical atoms, not physical atoms"; the <i>Tractatus</i> on facts rather than things (1.1), objects and states of affairs, the picture theory with pictorial form against logical form, bipolarity, logical space, the general form of the proposition at 6, <i>sinnlos</i> against <i>unsinnig</i> , saying against showing (4.1212), the ladder (6.54) and proposition 7
CORE SUPPORTING	The provenance discipline: three different Moore papers of 1903, 1925 and 1939 with three different arguments; Russell's 1918 preface crediting the ideas to Wittgenstein; the German publication of 1921 and the bilingual <i>Tractatus</i> of 1922, with the Latin title suggested by Moore; the Ogden/Ramsey and Pears-McGuinness divergence at proposition 7 and at 4.5 and 6.54; <i>Sachverhalt</i> rendered "atomic fact" by Ogden and "state of affairs" by Pears-McGuinness; the fact that there is no proposition 7.1; the N-operator as joint negation; the phase-dependence of Russell's views, so that sense-data acquaintance, the 1918 atomism and later neutral monism are not one timeless doctrine; Strawson's presupposition objection (1950), Sellars on the Given (1956) and Kripke on rigid designation (lectures 1970, book 1980) as one-objection enrichment
SUPPORTING	Moore's paradox of analysis as method-context for why analysis is not trivial verbal substitution; the colour-exclusion problem of 1929 as a diagnosed internal pressure on the independence of elementary propositions; solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the limit of the world, kept to the depth the say/show boundary requires; the standard-ineffability against resolute/therapeutic dispute over 6.54, stated in one clause and then ruled on
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	Whether the theory of descriptions is a quantificational device or a deeper account of how apparent names disappear; whether logical constructions are genuine phenomenalist reductions or methodological housekeeping; what "showing" finally means, and whether the <i>Tractatus</i> self-destructs; Russell's paradox and the theory of types as the background technique behind "no meaning in isolation"; Moore's naturalistic fallacy named only to be excluded
NOT OWNED HERE	The verification principle and the rejection of metaphysics as a positive doctrine (Topic 07); meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance and the private-language argument (Topic 08); Strawson's own theory of reference and persons (Topic 11); Berkeley's immaterialism as doctrine (Topic 03); Hegel's Absolute Idealism as doctrine (Topic 05); Moore's ethics, including the naturalistic fallacy and the Open Question Argument; Russell's logicism, <i>Principia</i> technique and later neutral monism as systems

ANALYSIS: **Ownership boundary, stated once.** The printed clause names **three thinkers and seven doctrines**, and it is the only Western clause that makes attribution itself examinable. Everything in this package earns its place because a printed limb or one of the **fourteen** routed 2018-2025 question-parts requires it. Two consequences follow, and both are worth marks. First, no doctrine may be transferred between the three men: Moore's method is comparative certainty, Russell's is quantificational analysis, and early Wittgenstein's is a transcendental account of the conditions of representation, and a script that writes "Moore and Russell held that..." without a discriminating clause has already lost the attribution mark. Second, the topic ends where the *Tractatus* ends: the moment a script writes "and therefore only empirically verifiable statements are meaningful", it has answered Topic 07's question inside Topic 06's answer.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

Every subtopic below runs in the same order, so the shape becomes automatic:

Step	What it gives you
DEFINITION	plain-language definition, then the technical one
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING	a sentence you can adapt directly as an introduction or a conclusion
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS	the terms that signal control of the topic
Plain-language visual	the idea before the vocabulary
VISUAL: VISUAL	the diagram that carries the argument
Numbered teaching	the doctrine, argument by argument, with paper, year or decimal reference
HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH	claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, written out for this subtopic
Exam link	which PYQ this subtopic answers, and how
UPSC traps	the specific ways candidates lose marks here
Revision notes	the compressed recall list
CLOSING RECALL FLOW	the subtopic reduced to one flow you can redraw from memory

Complete the Basic block first. Interpretive depth - the resolute reading of the *Tractatus*, the status of logical constructions, Russell's paradox and the theory of types - is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections. Nothing in that block is needed to write a complete answer to any of the fourteen routed questions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

ANALYSIS: This clause is a **movement with a datable beginning**, and examiners test the dates through the papers rather than through biography. The rail below is the minimum that prevents the four commonest anachronisms: merging Moore's three papers, dating the English *Tractatus* to 1921, letting Russell's 1918 atomism absorb his later neutral monism, and importing the Vienna Circle into a Tractarian answer.

THE TARGET ALREADY IN PLACE

1893 BRADLEY, Appearance and Reality - British Absolute Idealism at its height: internal relations, degrees of truth, the ordinary world demoted to "appearance"

|

THE REVOLT BEGINS - MOORE FIRST, RUSSELL FOLLOWING

1903 MOORE, "The Refutation of Idealism" (Mind) ACT/OBJECT

1903 Moore, Principia Ethica - SAME YEAR, DIFFERENT SUBJECT.

The naturalistic fallacy lives HERE, in ethics, not in item 6

1905 RUSSELL, "On Denoting" (Mind) DESCRIPTIONS BEGIN

Ramsey later calls it "a paradigm of philosophy"

1910-11 Russell, "Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by

Description" (Proceedings of the Aristotelian Society)

1910-13 Whitehead and Russell, Principia Mathematica - the technique of CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION that "incomplete symbol" names

1912 Russell, The Problems of Philosophy, Ch. 5 - the PRINCIPLE OF ACQUAINTANCE, safe to quote verbatim

1914 Russell, Our Knowledge of the External World + "The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics" LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS

|

THE TWO ATOMISMS, WRITTEN IN THE SAME YEARS

1918 RUSSELL, "The Philosophy of Logical Atomism" - lectures given in London, published in The Monist 1918-19. Russell's own preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein. SAY SO IN THE EXAM.

1918 WITTGENSTEIN completes the Tractatus manuscript while on active service and then in captivity

1921 German text published as Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung in Annalen der Naturphilosophie

1922 BILINGUAL EDITION, German-English, with the Latin title Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus - the title was MOORE'S SUGGESTION. Ogden translation, assisted by Ramsey, checked by Wittgenstein. NEVER date the English text 1921.

|

MOORE COMPLETES HIS CASE

1925 MOORE, "A Defence of Common Sense" (Contemporary British Philosophy) THE TRUISMS PAPER

1939 MOORE, "Proof of an External World" (British Academy lecture) THE HANDS PAPER

|

THE PRESSURES THAT END THE PERIOD

1929 Wittgenstein, "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (PAS Supplementary) - the COLOUR-EXCLUSION problem; the only philosophical article besides the Tractatus published in his lifetime, and an analysis he quickly abandoned

1929+ VIENNA CIRCLE takes Tractarian resources in a direction Wittgenstein did not take them TOPIC 07

1950 STRAWSON, "On Referring" (Mind) - presupposition, not falsity

1953 Philosophical Investigations, posthumous TOPIC 08

1956 SELLARS, "Empiricism and the Philosophy of Mind" - the Myth of the Given, against acquaintance as bedrock

1961 PEARS-McGUINNESS translation of the Tractatus - divergent wording at exactly the most quoted propositions

1970/1980 KRIPKE, Naming and Necessity - lectures 1970, book 1980; give ONE date, not a merged one

ANALYSIS: What the rail earns you. Three separate marks are commonly available from it: the 1903/1925/1939 separation in any Moore answer; Russell's own 1918 attribution of atomism to Wittgenstein in any atomism answer; and the 1921/1922 distinction in any *Tractatus* answer. None of them costs more than a clause.

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP

THE FOURTEEN ROUTED QUESTIONS, SORTED BY THE SUBTOPIC THAT ANSWERS THEM

MOORE - COMMON SENSE	2019 Q3(c) 15 2021 Q3(a) 20
Sessions 2 and 3	2024 Q1(c) 10
MOORE - REFUTATION OF IDEALISM	2020 Q2(b) 15 2025 Q3(c) 15
Session 4	
RUSSELL - DESCRIPTIONS AND	2018 Q4(c) 15 2023 Q4(b) 15
INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS	2024 Q3(a) 20 2025 Q1(d) 10
Sessions 5, 6 and 7	
RUSSELL - ANALYSIS AND ATOMISM	2020 Q2(c) 15 2022 Q1(b) 10
Session 8 (with 5-7)	2018 Q4(c) 15 and 2024 Q3(a) 20 again
WITTGENSTEIN - PICTURE THEORY	2022 Q3(c) 15
Sessions 9 and 10	
WITTGENSTEIN - SAYING/SHOWING	2018 Q3(c) 15 2021 Q4(c) 15
Session 11	
COMPARISON AND CRAFT	every 15- and 20-mark part
Session 12	

THE FOUR SENTENCES THAT OPEN FOUR DIFFERENT ANSWERS

MOORE	"The premisses of a sceptical argument are never more certain than the ordinary proposition they are used to deny."
RUSSELL	"A denoting phrase is not a name that must find an object; it is a quantifier that must find a satisfier - and when none exists the sentence is false, not meaningless."
TRACTATUS	"A proposition has sense because it shares logical form with the situation it depicts - and that sharing is the one thing no proposition can state."
ALL THREE	"The three programmes agree that philosophy proceeds by analysis and disagree about what analysis reaches."

SESSION 1 - THE ANALYTIC REVOLT: THREE PROGRAMMES, ONE TARGET, AND THE ATTRIBUTION FIREWALL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: At the turn of the twentieth century three Cambridge philosophers stopped trying to build a picture of reality as a whole and started examining, one at a time, the individual sentences in which philosophical claims are made. They asked what a sentence commits you to, what its real structure is, and whether it succeeds in saying anything at all. That change of unit - from *system* to *proposition* - is what is meant by the analytic revolt.

Technical definition: Analytic philosophy, in its founding phase, is the programme of settling philosophical questions by the **analysis of propositions** rather than by the construction of a metaphysical system. Its shared negative target is **British Absolute Idealism** - the monistic doctrine, associated with F. H. Bradley and J. M. E. McTaggart and inherited ultimately from Hegel, that relations are internal, that ordinary things and ordinary judgements are "appearance", and that only the whole is fully real. Its shared positive commitment is that **grammatical form need not be logical form**. ANALYSIS: Beyond that shared commitment the three programmes diverge completely in method, in what analysis is supposed to reach, and in what counts as success.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

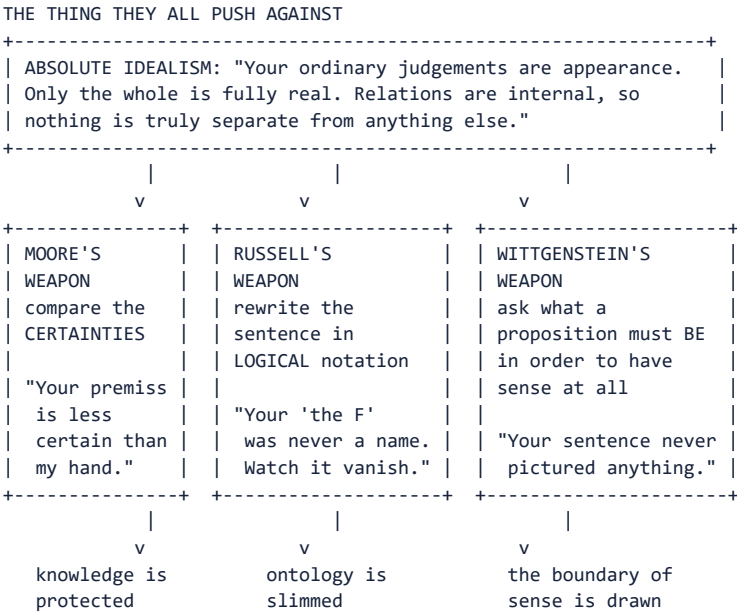
The founders of analytic philosophy were united by what they refused rather than by what they proposed: Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein all denied that a philosophical system may overrule what we ordinarily know or ordinarily say, and each then built a completely different instrument for showing why - comparative certainty, quantificational analysis, and a transcendental account of the conditions of sense.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **analysis** - the shared method, and the term whose three different senses this clause turns on
- **British Absolute Idealism** - the named target, not "idealism" in general
- **grammatical form is not logical form** - the single shared insight of Russell and the *Tractatus*
- **act/object distinction** - Moore's instrument, taken over by Russell for sense-data
- **atomic fact / state of affairs (Sachverhalt)** - the two atomisms, deliberately kept apart
- **attribution firewall** - the discipline of never letting one man's doctrine drift onto another

How to use them: name the target in your first clause, because "revolt" without a named opponent reads as decoration; then state the shared insight; then immediately divide the three programmes, because the division is the marks-bearing content of any comparative question in this clause.

Plain-language visual - one enemy, three weapons



In simple words: imagine three people confronting the same over-confident theory. The first says, *whatever your argument is, I am more sure of my hands than I am of your premises*. The second says, *your sentence looks as though it names something; write it out properly and the apparent name disappears*. The third says, *before we ask whether your sentence is true, ask whether it depicts any possible situation - if it does not, it is not false, it is nonsense*. Those three replies are not variants of one another. They are three separate philosophies that happen to share an enemy.

Remember first	Meaning
The target is a named doctrine	British Absolute Idealism, Bradley and McTaggart, not idealism in the abstract
The shared insight is about form	surface grammar can misdescribe logical structure
"Analysis" is three methods, not one	commitment-analysis · quantificational analysis · conditions-of-sense analysis
Moore is first in time	1903 precedes "On Denoting" (1905) and the <i>Tractatus</i> (1918/1921)
The influence runs both ways	Russell's 1918 preface credits logical atomism to Wittgenstein

One-line memory: one enemy, three weapons, and the marks are in telling the weapons apart.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the attribution firewall, term by term

PRINTED SYLLABUS TERM	OWNER	KEY TEXT
Defence of Commonsense	MOORE	"A Defence of Common Sense", 1925
Refutation of Idealism	MOORE	"The Refutation of Idealism", Mind, 1903
Logical Atomism	RUSSELL and, distinctly, WITTGENSTEIN	"The Philosophy of Logical Atomism", 1918 Tractatus
Logical Constructions	RUSSELL	"The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics", 1914; Our Knowledge of the External World, 1914
Incomplete Symbols	RUSSELL	"On Denoting", 1905; Principia Mathematica
Picture Theory of Meaning	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN	German text 1921; bilingual Tractatus 1922
Saying and Showing (printed "Syng and Showing")	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN	Tractatus 4.12-4.1212, 6.522, 6.54, 7

THE ONE ENTRY WITH TWO OWNERS, AND WHY

Logical Atomism is jointly listed because Russell's 1918 lectures and the Tractatus are two DIFFERENT atomisms that arose in conversation:

RUSSELL	atoms are particulars plus qualities and relations, identified through ACQUAINTANCE in that phase; the programme is logical AND epistemological
WITTGENSTEIN	objects are logical simples whose nature is never exemplified; they are required by the CONDITIONS OF DETERMINATE SENSE, not found by inspection

TERMS THAT LOOK AS IF THEY BELONG HERE AND DO NOT

naturalistic fallacy / Open Question	Moore's ETHICS (Principia Ethica, 1903) - same author, same year, different subject
verification principle	Topic 07
meaning as use, language-games	Topic 08
presupposition (Strawson)	one objection only; the positive theory is Topic 11
Russell's paradox, theory of types	optional orientation only

ANALYSIS: Caption. This table is the single highest-yield object in the topic, because the examiner can test it in a one-line Prelims-style discrimination or make it the assessment half of a 15-mark answer. Learn it as a table, not as prose.

1. What exactly was being revolted against

FACT: British Absolute Idealism held that reality is a single spiritual whole; that relations are **internal**, so that nothing could be what it is if its relations were different; and that ordinary claims about separate things in space and time are therefore true only in a degraded sense - "appearance", in Bradley's word, arranged by **degrees of truth**.

ANALYSIS: The consequence that provoked the revolt is a methodological one. If ordinary claims are appearance, then a sufficiently powerful system may correct them wholesale. Moore's answer is that this gets the order of confidence backwards; Russell's is that the doctrine of internal relations is an artefact of taking every proposition to have subject-predicate form; Wittgenstein's is that the system's own sentences fail the test any sentence must pass to have sense.

ANALYSIS: What not to overwrite. Hegel's Absolute Idealism is Topic 05 and Berkeley's immaterialism is Topic 03. This session needs the target only as a target. **WRONG:** It is a marked error to answer "Moore's refutation of idealism" by expounding Hegel, and **WRONG:** equally an error to treat Bradley's monism and Berkeley's *esse est percipi* as the same doctrine - Moore's 1903 paper attacks the second, not the first.

2. Three senses of "analysis" - the distinction that most scripts miss

Programme	What analysis takes as input	What it delivers	When it has succeeded
Moore FACT:	an ordinary judgement we already know to be true	an account of what that judgement commits us to	when the commitments are clear; ANALYSIS: and if they are not, the <i>knowledge</i> is untouched
Russell FACT:	a sentence whose surface suggests a suspect entity	a quantified paraphrase in which the apparent name disappears	when the paraphrase preserves truth-conditions and removes the ontological commitment
Early Wittgenstein FACT:	any proposition whatever	its resolution into truth-functions of elementary propositions	when the analysis reaches a base of logically independent elementary propositions - ANALYSIS: a base the <i>Tractatus</i> requires but never exhibits

- ANALYSIS: **The examinable consequence.** Because "analysis" means three different things, the three men can share a slogan and still disagree about everything that matters. Russell's descriptions do not vindicate Moore's truisms; Moore never accepted that ordinary objects are constructions; Wittgenstein's objects are not Russell's sense-data.

3. Where influence really ran - and why the direction is worth a mark

FACT: Russell's 1918 lectures open by disclaiming originality: he presents logical atomism as growing out of conversations with Wittgenstein, his student from 1911. ANALYSIS: Writing "Russell invented logical atomism and Wittgenstein developed it" is therefore doubly wrong - it reverses the credit Russell himself gave, and it suggests a single doctrine where there are two.

FACT: In the other direction the debts are equally concrete: Wittgenstein takes the technique of the **variable and the quantifier** from Russell and Frege, and then removes what he regards as their central mistake - the treatment of logical constants as names of anything (4.0312, the *fundamental idea* or *Grundgedanke*). FACT: Moore's contribution is earlier and different in kind: the **act/object distinction** of 1903, which Russell adopts wholesale for sense-data, and the tone of the whole movement - the refusal to be argued out of what one knows.

4. What each programme finally achieved, stated without inflation

1. **Moore FACT:** reversed the burden of proof in epistemology and made ordinary knowledge a fixed point against which theories are tested. ANALYSIS: He did not supply a neutral criterion for deciding whose premisses are more certain, and the objection that his proof begs the question against the sceptic is not silenced.
2. **Russell FACT:** produced in the theory of descriptions a technique still in universal use, and with it a general method of ontological economy. ANALYSIS: He never fixed the final inventory of simples, admitted negative facts as a cost, and changed his own view of the base more than once.
3. **Early Wittgenstein FACT:** gave the most complete account ever attempted of the conditions under which a sentence has sense, and drew from it a boundary around the sayable. ANALYSIS: The account's own statement falls outside that boundary, which is the ladder problem of 6.54 - a difficulty the book itself raises rather than one imported by critics.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The early analytic movement is best characterised negatively: what unites Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein is a refusal to let a philosophical system overrule ordinary knowledge or ordinary discourse, not a shared positive doctrine. **Named evidence.** Moore's "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903) and "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) protect ordinary certainties by comparing them with sceptical premisses; Russell's "On Denoting" (1905) rewrites "the F is G" as an existentially quantified sentence so that the apparent name disappears; the *Tractatus* (1921/1922) grounds sense in shared logical form and consigns what cannot be depicted to the domain of what can only be shown. **Analysis.** Each instrument works on the proposition rather than on the system, which is why the shared insight is formal - that grammatical form may misdescribe logical form - and why the shared enemy is a monism that had made ordinary judgement provisional. **Qualification.** The unity is genuine but thin: "analysis" names commitment-clarification in Moore, quantificational paraphrase in Russell and the resolution of propositions into a truth-functional base in Wittgenstein, so a script that treats the three as one programme has recorded the movement's slogan while missing its content.

Exam link

- **2018 Q4(c)** and **2024 Q3(a)** both ask how a Russellian technique *leads to* atomism; Section 2 supplies the discrimination that keeps the answer from sliding into Wittgenstein's atomism.
- **2018 Q3(a)** (Empiricism-owned) explicitly asks whether Moore's reaction to Berkeley differs from Russell's; Section 2 and Section 3 are the whole answer to the comparative half.
- **2022 Q1(b)** ("Russell's method of logical analysis") is opened correctly by the third column of Section 2 and closed by Section 4.2.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Moore, Russell and Wittgenstein held the same view"	They shared a target and an insight about form. Their methods, their ontologies and their criteria of success differ
Treating the target as Hegel or Berkeley indifferently	The movement's local opponent is British Absolute Idealism ; Moore's 1903 paper attacks <i>esse est percipi</i> specifically
"Russell invented logical atomism"	His own 1918 preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein - and the two atomisms are still not identical
Importing the naturalistic fallacy into this clause	It belongs to <i>Principia Ethica</i> (1903) and to ethics. Same author, same year, different syllabus item
Ending the topic with verificationism	The <i>Tractatus</i> asks whether a sentence depicts a possible situation, not whether it can be empirically checked

Revision notes

- Target: British Absolute Idealism - internal relations, degrees of truth, ordinary world as appearance (Bradley, McTaggart).
- Shared insight: grammatical form is not logical form. Shared unit: the proposition.
- Three analyses: commitment (Moore) · quantificational paraphrase (Russell) · resolution into a truth-functional base (Wittgenstein).
- Ownership: Moore owns commonsense and refutation of idealism; Russell owns atomism, constructions, incomplete symbols; Wittgenstein owns picture theory and saying/showing; atomism is jointly listed and doubly meant.
- Dates for the mark: 1903 Moore · 1905 "On Denoting" · 1914 constructions · 1918 both atomisms · 1921 German, 1922 bilingual · 1925 truisms · 1939 hands.
- Achievements with their costs: burden reversed without a neutral criterion · economy without a fixed inventory · a boundary of sense that its own statement crosses.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE REVOLT

BRITISH ABSOLUTE IDEALISM (internal relations, appearance, degrees of truth)

|
v

ONE NEGATIVE THESIS: no system may overrule what we ordinarily know or say

|

---> MOORE 1903/1925/1939 compare CERTAINTIES; act != object

---> RUSSELL 1905/1914/1918 rewrite LOGICAL FORM; economise ontology

---> WITTGENSTEIN 1918/1921/1922 fix the CONDITIONS OF SENSE

|
v

SHARED INSIGHT: GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM

SHARED UNIT: the PROPOSITION, not the system

|
v

ATTRIBUTION FIREWALL: seven printed terms, three owners, one jointly listed

NOT HERE: naturalistic fallacy | verification | meaning-as-use | Strawson's positive semantics

|
v

ANSWER LINE: they agree that philosophy proceeds by analysis and disagree about what analysis reaches

SESSION 2 - MOORE'S DEFENCE OF COMMON SENSE: TRUISMS, KNOWING AGAINST ANALYSING, AND COMPARATIVE CERTAINTY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Moore says there is a set of very ordinary claims - that the earth existed for many years before he was born, that he has a body, that there are other people with bodies - which he *knows*, with certainty, to be true. Any philosophical argument that ends by denying one of them must contain a premiss he is less sure of than he is of the claim being denied; so the rational response is to reject the argument, not the claim.

Technical definition: Moore's **defence of common sense** ("A Defence of Common Sense", 1925) consists of (i) a list of ordinary propositions - his **truisms** - which he asserts he knows with certainty and which he claims are known by very many others; (ii) the distinction between **knowing that a proposition is true** and **knowing its correct analysis**; and (iii) a **comparative-certainty** principle: a philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss of the argument is more certain than the truism, and no sceptical or idealist premiss has ever met that condition. ANALYSIS: "Common sense" here is not opinion-polling, convention or majority belief; the list is philosophically contestable rather than infallible by definition.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

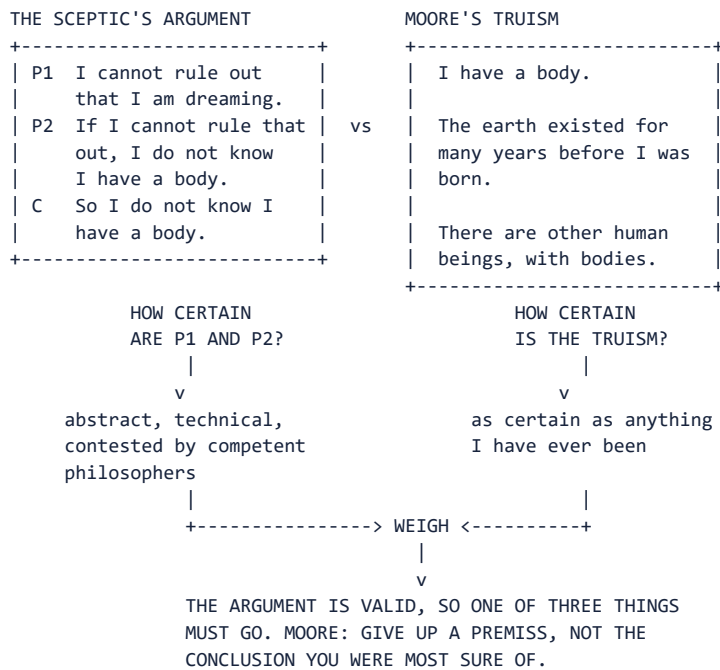
Moore's defence of common sense is not the claim that ordinary belief is beyond criticism but the far narrower and far more effective claim that no philosopher has ever produced a premiss more certain than "I have a body" - so that when a system and a truism collide, it is the system whose credentials must be re-examined first.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **truisms** - Moore's own word for the propositions on the list
- **knowing that P against knowing the analysis of P** - the distinction that does the defensive work
- **comparative certainty** - the method: weigh the premiss against the proposition it would overturn
- **reversal of the burden of proof** - the result, stated in the examiner's language
- **common-sense realism** - the label the 2019 paper uses; explain *why* it is applied
- ANALYSIS: **not a popularity claim** - say this explicitly; it pre-empts the commonest objection

How to use them: never open a Moore answer with the hands. Open with the *structure* - a list, a distinction and a comparison - because the 2019, 2021 and 2024 questions all ask for arguments, and the hands are a separate paper of 1939 answering a separate question.

Plain-language visual - the weighing scale



In simple words: a valid argument is a set of scales, not a one-way street. If the conclusion is something you are more certain is false than you are certain any premiss is true, then the argument has not proved its conclusion - it has *refuted one of its own premisses*. Moore's contribution is to insist that we actually perform the weighing instead of assuming that the philosophical premiss automatically wins because it is philosophical.

Remember first	Meaning
Truisms are known , not merely believed	Moore's claim is epistemic, and he insists on the word "know"
Knowing is not analysing	difficulty about what "material object" <i>means</i> leaves the knowledge standing
The method is comparative	it never claims the truism is self-evidently unassailable, only that it outweighs its rivals
The list is contestable	Moore offers it as what he knows, not as a definition of truth
The result is dialectical	the sceptic now owes an account of why abstract premisses beat perceptual ones

One-line memory: the argument is valid - so which end of it do you trust more?

VISUAL: VISUAL - the structure of the 1925 defence

STEP 1 THE LIST OF TRUISMS (Moore's own examples)	
+-----+	
"There exists at present a living human body, which is my	
body."	
"This body has existed continuously on or near the earth."	
"The earth has existed for many years past."	
"There have existed many other human beings, with bodies."	
"I am a human being who has had many experiences."	
AND: very many other human beings know propositions of the	
same kind about themselves.	
+-----+	
STEP 2 THE LEVEL DISTINCTION - the load-bearing move	
+-----+	
KNOWING THAT P IS TRUE	KNOWING THE ANALYSIS OF P
certain: "I have two hands"	doubtful: what IS a material
	object? sense-data? a class
pre-philosophical, secure	of appearances? a substance?
	PHILOSOPHICAL WORK PROPER,
	and it may remain unfinished
+-----+	
THE FALLACY MOORE NAMES: "you cannot know you have hands because	
you cannot analyse 'material object'" CONFUSES THE TWO LEVELS.	
STEP 3 THE COMPARATIVE-CERTAINTY PRINCIPLE	
+-----+	
For a philosophical argument to overturn a truism, EVERY	
premiss must be MORE certain than the truism it denies.	
Moore's empirical claim: no such premiss has been produced.	
Therefore the rational move is to reject a premiss.	
+-----+	
STEP 4 THE RESULT, IN THE EXAMINER'S WORDS	
+-----+	
THE BURDEN OF PROOF IS REVERSED. The realist no longer owes a	
proof of the external world from neutral ground; the sceptic	
owes an explanation of why his abstract premisses should be	
trusted more than an ordinary perceptual certainty.	
+-----+	
THE LIMIT THAT MUST BE WRITTEN	
ANALYSIS: The principle presupposes that certainty is COMPARABLE across	
ordinary and philosophical propositions, and Moore supplies NO	
NEUTRAL MEASURE for the comparison. A sceptic who simply denies	
that Moore knows the truism has not been shown to be irrational -	
he has been told that Moore is more confident.	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Steps 1-3 are what the 2021 and 2024 questions call "the arguments". Step 4 is the verdict. The bottom band is the assessment half, and the questions in 2021 and 2024 both explicitly demand it.

1. Why the list matters as a list

FACT: Moore does not argue *for* the truisms from something more basic - that would concede that they need support from outside. He **asserts** them, and asserts in addition that he knows them, and that others know propositions of the same kind. The list is therefore doing two jobs at once: it fixes what is to be defended, and it displays how enormous the sceptic's task is, since the sceptic must deny not one claim but a whole interlocking body of them.

ANALYSIS: **The second-order claim is the more interesting one.** Moore also claims to know that *other people know* such propositions. This matters because it converts the defence from a report of personal confidence into a claim about a shared epistemic position, and because it is what makes "common sense" the right name - the propositions are common to us, not merely evident to Moore.

WRONG: **What the doctrine is not.** It is not the claim that whatever most people believe is true; it is not an appeal to convention; and it is not a claim of infallibility. Moore's own list is a philosophical proposal and can be argued with. State this in one clause and the commonest objection is disarmed before it is raised.

2. The knowing/analysing distinction, and the confusion of levels it exposes

The sceptical or idealist move	Moore's diagnosis
"The analysis of 'material object' is disputed, therefore we do not know that material objects exist" FACT:	A confusion of levels : the truth of a proposition and the correct account of its constituents are different questions, established by different means
"Since sense-data are all we are directly given, ordinary claims are at best inferences" ANALYSIS:	Moore accepts a real question about how truisms relate to sense-data; he denies that leaving it open suspends the knowledge
"Ordinary language is loose, so ordinary claims are imprecise" ANALYSIS:	Imprecision in stating a proposition is not doubt about it; Moore's certainty attaches to the proposition, not to a formulation

- FACT: **Why this is the load-bearing move.** Without it, the defence would be a bare refusal to engage. With it, Moore can concede the entire difficulty of philosophical analysis - he was himself a lifelong analyst, and the paradox of analysis is *his* problem - while denying that the difficulty reaches the knowledge.
- ANALYSIS: **The honest cost.** The distinction protects the knowledge only if propositional knowledge really can be secure while its constituents are unclear. That is exactly what a sceptic about the given, or a philosopher who ties understanding to analysis, will deny.

3. The paradox of analysis - the difficulty Moore's own method creates ANALYSIS:

If the correct analysis of "X is a brother" is "X is a male sibling", then either the analysis says the very same thing as the original, in which case it is trivially uninformative; or it says something different, in which case it is not an analysis of that concept at all.

- ANALYSIS: The paradox is associated with Moore and has **no settled Moorean solution**. Fregean differences of sense or mode of presentation, and later accounts of concept-possession and synonymy, are proposed responses rather than agreed ones.
- ANALYSIS: **Owner scope.** This is **method-context, not a printed limb**. Use it for one purpose only: to show why analysis cannot be reduced to trivial verbal substitution, and therefore why Moore needed the knowing/analysing distinction in the first place. Do not build a section of an answer on it.

4. Why the label "common-sense realism" is applied - the 2019 question in one paragraph

FACT: **Common sense**, because the defended propositions are the ordinary ones and the method is comparison with them rather than derivation from a philosophical first principle. FACT: **Realism**, because the truisms include the existence of a body, of the earth before one's birth and of other human beings - that is, of things whose existence does not consist in being perceived by the person asserting them. ANALYSIS: **The qualification that earns the assessment mark:** the realism is a *consequence* of defending the truisms, not an independently argued metaphysics. Moore gives no theory of perception, does not settle whether ordinary objects are analysable into sense-data, and offers no account of the relation between the two levels. His realism is the position he ends in, not the premiss he starts from.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Moore's defence of common sense succeeds as a redistribution of dialectical burden and fails, by design, as a demonstration that scepticism is false. **Named evidence.** "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) lists truisms - that he has a body, that the earth existed for many years before his birth, that there are other human beings with bodies - asserts that he knows them, distinguishes knowing a proposition from knowing its analysis, and rests the defence on the comparison of certainties. **Analysis.** Because a valid argument transmits certainty backwards as well as forwards, an argument whose conclusion is less credible than its own premisses are is one that has refuted a premiss; Moore's contribution is to insist that the comparison actually be made, and to point out that no sceptical premiss has ever been more evident than "I have a body". **Qualification.** The method presupposes that certainty can be compared across ordinary and philosophical propositions without a neutral measure, so a sceptic who simply denies that Moore *knows* the truism has not been refuted but only outweighed - which is why Moore's own verdict is that scepticism has not been shown to be true rather than that it has been shown to be false.

Exam link

- **2019 Q3(c)** ("Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?") is answered by Section 4, with Section 1-Section 2 as the supporting structure. The question asks *why the label is applied*, so the answer must justify both words.
- **2024 Q1(c)** ("What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms...? Critically discuss.") takes Section 1-Section 3 for the arguments and the bottom band of the visual for the "critically".
- **2021 Q3(a)**, twenty marks, adds the explicit sceptical half; that question is completed in Session 3.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Answering the 1925 question with the 1939 hands	Different paper, different argument. The truisms paper contains no proof; the proof paper is a separate lecture
"Common sense means what most people believe"	It means a specific list of ordinary propositions Moore claims to know; popularity plays no role in the argument
Presenting the truisms as self-evident axioms	Moore claims to <i>know</i> them, not that they are indubitable by definition; the list is philosophically contestable
Omitting the knowing/analysing distinction	Without it the defence looks like a refusal to argue, and the answer loses its central move
Claiming Moore refutes scepticism	He shifts the burden. His own conclusion is that no sceptical premiss has been shown more certain than the truism it denies

Revision notes

- 1925 "A Defence of Common Sense": list of truisms + second-order claim that others know propositions of the same kind.
- Knowing that P is not knowing the analysis of P; the sceptic's inference from analytic difficulty to ignorance is a confusion of levels.
- Comparative certainty: an argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism.
- Result: reversal of the burden of proof; ANALYSIS: no neutral measure of certainty is supplied.
- WRONG: Not popularity, not convention, not infallibility.
- Paradox of analysis: bounded method-context, no settled Moorean solution, explains why analysis is not verbal substitution.
- "Common-sense realism": common sense from the method, realism from the content of the list; the realism is a result, not a premiss.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE DEFENCE OF COMMON SENSE

1925 "A DEFENCE OF COMMON SENSE"

```
|
+--> LIST OF TRUISMS (my body | the earth before my birth |
|   other human beings with bodies) + others know the same kind
|
+--> LEVEL DISTINCTION: knowing that P != knowing P's ANALYSIS
|   so analytic difficulty does NOT cancel knowledge
|
+--> COMPARATIVE CERTAINTY: every premiss must outweigh the
|   truism it denies - and none ever has
|
v
RESULT: THE BURDEN OF PROOF IS REVERSED
|
v
LIMIT (write it): no NEUTRAL measure of certainty is supplied; the
|   sceptic is outweighed, not shown to be irrational
|
v
LABEL: COMMON-SENSE (method) + REALISM (content of the list), and the
|   realism is a RESULT, not an independently argued metaphysics
ANSWER LINE: no philosopher has produced a premiss more certain than
|   "I have a body"
```

SESSION 3 - MOORE'S PROOF OF AN EXTERNAL WORLD: THREE CONDITIONS, TWO HANDS, AND THE SCEPTICAL REPLY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: In a 1939 British Academy lecture Moore claims to give a *strict proof* that things exist outside us. He holds up one hand and says "Here is one hand", holds up the other and says "and here is another", and points out that if that is true then at least two things exist in space - and therefore an external world exists. The point is not the theatricality; it is that Moore then states, in advance, the three conditions a rigorous proof must satisfy, and argues that his gesture satisfies all three.

Technical definition: Moore's **proof of an external world** ("Proof of an External World", 1939) is a valid argument from the premiss that two hands are present here and now to the conclusion that at least two **things met with in space** exist, and hence that an external world exists. Its philosophical content lies in Moore's **three conditions for a rigorous proof** - the premiss must be *different from* the conclusion, the premiss must be *known* and not merely believed, and the conclusion must *follow* from the premiss - and in his admission that he cannot in turn **prove the premiss**, coupled with the claim that this admission does not defeat the proof.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Moore's two hands are not a joke at the sceptic's expense but the most economical statement in modern epistemology of a question the sceptic must answer: if a valid argument from a premiss I know delivers the existence of an external world, then the demand for a *further* proof of the premiss is a demand that no proof of anything could ever satisfy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **things met with in space** - Moore's own gloss on "external"; quote it, because it is what makes the inference valid
- **three conditions for a rigorous proof** - different premiss · known premiss · valid consequence
- **proof against proving the premiss** - the distinction Moore explicitly concedes
- **question-begging objection** - the strongest reply, which must be stated
- **hinge or framework proposition ANALYSIS** - the later diagnosis, named as a comparison and *not* as Moore's own view
- **right hand first, then the left ANALYSIS** - the printed order, if you narrate the gesture at all

How to use them: the marks in this session are in the *conditions*, not the gesture. Most scripts describe the hands and stop; the strong script writes the three conditions, checks each, and then concedes exactly what Moore concedes.

Plain-language visual - what a proof is allowed to look like

```

A PROOF IS RIGOROUS WHEN THREE THINGS ARE TRUE OF IT
=====
TEST 1  THE PREMISS IS NOT THE CONCLUSION IN DISGUISE
        "Here is a hand" != "An external world exists"
        -> so the argument is NOT CIRCULAR
-----
TEST 2  THE PREMISS IS KNOWN, NOT MERELY BELIEVED OR ASSUMED
        Moore: "I did know it. It would have been absurd to suggest
        that I did not know it, but only believed it."
        -> so the argument has a GENUINE STARTING POINT
-----
TEST 3  THE CONCLUSION REALLY FOLLOWS
        A hand is a THING MET WITH IN SPACE.
        "External" just means: met with in space, not dependent on my
        being conscious of it.
        -> so the inference is VALID, not a leap
=====
AND ONE THING MOORE ADMITS HE CANNOT DO
        He cannot PROVE the premiss "Here is one hand".
        To do that he would have to prove he was not dreaming -
        "and that I cannot do."
=====
THE QUESTION THAT DECIDES THE ANSWER
        Is a proof worthless because its premiss is unproved?
        MOORE: NO. Otherwise nothing whatever could be proved,
        because every proof must start somewhere.
        SCEPTIC: YES, HERE. Because this premiss is precisely what
        was in dispute.

```

In simple words: everyone agrees you cannot prove everything - some starting point must be known without being derived from something else. The whole question is whether "here is a hand" is allowed to be such a starting point. Moore says it obviously is, because it is about as good a case of knowing as anyone can produce. The sceptic says it obviously is not, because it is exactly the sort of claim his argument targeted. Neither side is being stupid; the disagreement is about where the burden lies, and that is the honest verdict to write.

Remember first	Meaning
The paper is 1939 , and separate	the truisms paper is 1925; do not merge them
"External" is defined , not assumed	things met with in space - this is what makes the inference valid
The three conditions are Moore's own	he states them before giving the proof, which is why the proof is not naïve
He concedes he cannot prove the premiss	and argues that this does not disqualify the proof
The gesture order is right, then left	ANALYSIS: narrate it correctly or omit the detail

One-line memory: a proof needs a *known* starting point, not a *proved* one.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the proof, the objection and the two ways of answering it

THE ARGUMENT

- 1 Here is one hand. (present perceptual knowledge)
- 2 And here is another. (hands are things met with in space)
- 3 So at least two material things exist.
- 4 So an external world exists.

|
v

THE SCEPTIC'S REPLY - and it is a serious one

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+-----+
| "Premiss 1 is exactly what I put in doubt. If dreaming or |
| deception cannot be excluded, you do not KNOW premiss 1, and |
| test 2 fails. Your proof therefore BEGS THE QUESTION." |
+-----+

```

|

+-----+
|

MOORE'S OWN REPLY (1939)

I need not prove every premiss I know. And no sceptical premiss is more certain than the ordinary proposition it is used to deny.

|
v

VERDICT SPINE: the proof is FORMALLY VALID; it does not supply a NEUTRAL criterion of knowledge; and its force is comparative, which is precisely what Moore claimed for it and nothing more.

ANALYSIS: OWNER NOTE: the hinge/framework diagnosis belongs to LATER WITTGENSTEIN (Topic 08). Name it as a comparison in one clause; do not expound On Certainty inside a Moore answer.

THE DIALECTICAL DEFENCE (Pryor and others) ANALYSIS: Moore need not CONVINCE the sceptic; he needs to show that the sceptic's premisses are the weaker part of the argument.

|
v

THE LATER, DIFFERENT DIAGNOSIS (On Certainty) ANALYSIS: CAUTION: Perhaps such propositions are not ordinary knowledge-claims at all but FRAMEWORK or HINGE certainties on which doubt itself depends.

|
v

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The three columns are three *different* defences, and only the first is Moore's own. Marking the difference is what converts a description of the proof into an assessment of it.

1. What Moore is actually proving, and against whom

FACT: The lecture's target is not the general sceptic first of all but **Kant**, who had called it "a scandal to philosophy" that no satisfactory proof of the existence of things outside us had been given. Moore takes the challenge literally: he offers a proof, and to make it assessable he first defines "external to our minds" as "**things met with in space**" - things whose existence does not consist in being experienced.

ANALYSIS: **Why the definition is doing work.** Without it, the step from "here is a hand" to "an external world exists" would be an unexplained leap. With it, the step is analytic: a hand is a thing met with in space; an external thing just *is* a thing met with in space; so if there is a hand there is an external thing. **WRONG:** A script that gives the gesture and omits the gloss has left the inference unjustified and will be marked down for it.

2. The three conditions, and why Moore states them first

Condition FACT:	What it excludes	Does the hands proof meet it?
The premiss must be different from the conclusion	circular arguments in which the conclusion is smuggled into the premiss	Yes - "here is a hand" is not synonymous with "an external world exists"
The premiss must be known , not merely believed or assumed	arguments from assumptions, however plausible	Moore insists he <i>knew</i> it; CAUTION: this is precisely the contested condition
The conclusion must follow	non sequiturs and rhetorical gestures	Yes, given the gloss on "external"

- FACT: **The rhetorical point.** By stating the conditions in advance, Moore removes the option of dismissing the proof as unserious. Any critic must now say *which* condition fails, and the only candidate is the second.
- ANALYSIS: **The concession, in Moore's own terms.** He grants that he cannot prove the premiss, since doing so would require proving that he is not dreaming, "and that I cannot do". He denies that this is a defect: a proof requires a *known* premiss, not a *proved* one, and the contrary demand generates an infinite regress in which nothing is ever proved.

3. The strongest objection, and the three replies worth writing CAUTION:

The objection. The proof begs the question. The sceptic's argument was designed to show that Moore does *not* know the premiss; asserting that he does know it therefore assumes what was in dispute, and condition 2 is unmet.

1. **Moore's own reply** FACT: - the comparative one. He is not obliged to establish the premiss from neutral ground. The relevant comparison is between the certainty of "here is a hand" and the certainty of the sceptic's premisses, and the ordinary proposition wins.
2. **The dialectical reply** ANALYSIS: - associated with later defenders such as James Pryor. Moore's proof is not addressed to a sceptic who has suspended all perceptual knowledge; it is addressed to us, and it shows that the cost of scepticism is the surrender of a piece of knowledge better established than any premiss used to attack it.
3. **The later, and different, diagnosis** ANALYSIS: CAUTION: - *On Certainty* re-examines whether propositions like "here is a hand" function as ordinary knowledge-claims at all, or as **framework certainties** that make doubting possible and cannot themselves be sensibly doubted. ANALYSIS: **Boundary:** this is Wittgenstein's later work and belongs to Topic 08. Name it in a clause as the most important later assessment, and stop.
- ANALYSIS: **The verdict that a strong script writes.** The proof is valid and its premiss is as well placed as any premiss can be; what it does not supply is a *neutral criterion* by which the comparison of certainties could be adjudicated. Moore's achievement is to have made the sceptic argue for his premisses rather than assume the burden lies elsewhere.

4. How Sessions 2 and 3 combine into the twenty-mark answer

FACT: **2021 Q3(a)** asks for the arguments of the 1925 paper *and* whether they answer the sceptic. The correct architecture is therefore:

1. The **list** and the second-order claim (1925).
2. The **knowing/analysing** distinction, with the confusion of levels named.
3. The **comparative-certainty** principle stated as a principle, not an attitude.
4. The **1939 proof** as the same principle in an explicit deductive form, with the three conditions.
5. The **objection** - question-begging - and the three replies.
6. A **graded verdict**: sufficient as a redistribution of burden, insufficient as a refutation, and honest about the missing neutral measure.

ANALYSIS: Note that step 4 is where the two papers meet. They are separate texts, but they execute one strategy: *compare the credentials of the competing claims instead of assuming the philosophical claim wins.*

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Moore's proof of an external world is best read not as an attempt to convert the sceptic but as a demonstration that the sceptic's demand, pressed consistently, would make proof of anything impossible. **Named evidence.** In the British Academy lecture of 1939 Moore defines external things as "things met with in space", argues from "Here is one hand, and here is another" to the existence of at least two such things, and states three conditions of rigour - the premiss must differ from the conclusion, must be known rather than believed, and must entail it - while conceding that he cannot prove the premiss itself because he cannot prove he is not dreaming. **Analysis.** The concession is not an oversight but the point: every proof terminates in a premiss that is known without being derived, so a demand for proof of *every* premiss is a demand for an infinite regress, and the real question is only whether an ordinary perceptual claim may occupy that terminal position. **Qualification.** Because the sceptic's argument was precisely an argument that the premiss is not known, Moore's insistence that he knows it settles the dispute only for someone who already shares his ranking of certainties - which is why the later assessment of these propositions as framework certainties in *On Certainty*, though it belongs to Wittgenstein's later philosophy rather than to Moore, remains the most serious attempt to say what Moore's proof got right.

Exam link

- **2021 Q3(a)**, twenty marks, is the direct home of this session; Section 4 gives the architecture and Section 3 supplies the "sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic" half of the question.
- **2019 Q3(c)** ("common-sense realism") uses the proof as the realism half - the hands are the clearest case of a thing met with in space.

- **2024 Q1(c)** should mention the proof only in a closing clause; that question is about the 1925 arguments, and importing the whole 1939 lecture unbalances a ten-mark answer.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Narrating the hands and omitting the three conditions	The conditions are the argument. Without them the answer is anecdote
Omitting "things met with in space"	Then the inference from hands to an external world is an unexplained leap
Saying Moore proves the premiss	He explicitly says he cannot, and explains why that is not required
Treating <i>On Certainty</i> as Moore's own answer	It is later Wittgenstein, Topic 08 - a comparison in one clause, never an expansion
Reversing the gesture order	ANALYSIS: Moore's text specifies the right hand first, then the left. If unsure, write "first one hand and then the other"

Revision notes

- 1939 British Academy lecture; target is Kant's "scandal to philosophy" charge.
- "External" is glossed as **things met with in space**; this gloss makes the inference valid.
- Three conditions: premiss different from conclusion · premiss known, not believed · conclusion follows.
- Moore concedes he cannot *prove* the premiss (he cannot prove he is not dreaming) and denies that this is a defect.
- Objection: begs the question. Replies: comparative certainty (Moore) · dialectical burden-shifting (Pryor)
ANALYSIS: · hinge/framework re-description (*On Certainty*) ANALYSIS: CAUTION: Topic 08.
- Verdict: valid proof, no neutral criterion of knowledge, force is comparative - exactly what Moore claimed.
- 1925 + 1939 = one strategy in two texts: compare credentials rather than assume the philosophical premiss wins.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE PROOF OF AN EXTERNAL WORLD

KANT'S CHALLENGE: it is "a scandal" that no proof of external things exists
|
v
MOORE 1939: define EXTERNAL = THINGS MET WITH IN SPACE
|
v
1 here is one hand -> 2 and here is another -> 3 two things met with in
space exist -> 4 an external world exists
|
v
THREE CONDITIONS OF RIGOUR
[1] premiss DIFFERENT from conclusion -> not circular
[2] premiss KNOWN, not merely believed -> contested condition
[3] conclusion FOLLOWS -> valid, given the gloss
|
v
CONCESSION: cannot PROVE the premiss (cannot prove he is not dreaming)
-> a proof needs a KNOWN premiss, not a PROVED one, or nothing is
ever proved
|
v
OBJECTION: begs the question
REPLY 1 comparative certainty (Moore's own)
REPLY 2 dialectical burden-shift (Pryor) ANALYSIS:
REPLY 3 hinge/framework certainty (On Certainty) ANALYSIS: TOPIC 08 ONLY
|
v
VERDICT: formally valid | no neutral criterion supplied | comparative
force is exactly what was claimed
ANSWER LINE: the demand to prove every premiss is a demand that no proof
could ever meet

SESSION 4 - MOORE'S REFUTATION OF IDEALISM: AWARENESS, OBJECT AND THE TRANSPARENCY THESIS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Idealists had argued that to exist is to be perceived. Moore replies that every experience has two parts that must be kept apart - the *awareness*, which is the same in every experience, and the *object*, which is what makes one experience different from another. When you are aware of blue and then of green, the awareness is common and the objects differ; so the blue is not the same thing as the awareness of blue. If they are not the same thing, the idealist's identification of being with being-perceived has lost its argument.

Technical definition: Moore's **refutation of idealism** ("The Refutation of Idealism", *Mind*, 1903) targets the principle **to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)** as it functions in Berkeleyan idealism and, more broadly, the thesis that reality is mind-dependent. The argument turns on the **act/object distinction**: in every sensation there is (i) an act of awareness or consciousness and (ii) an object of which one is aware. The idealist inference requires these to be *identical* or the object to be a *constituent* of the act. Moore argues that they are distinct, since the awareness is the common element in the sensations of blue and of green while the objects differ. He explains the persistent temptation to conflate them by the **transparency** or **diaphanous** character of consciousness: attention passes through the act to the object, so the act is easily overlooked. ANALYSIS: The conclusion is deliberately narrow: it blocks one argument *for* idealism; it does not by itself establish that objects exist unperceived.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Moore's refutation of idealism is a single distinction pressed with unusual severity: if what I am aware of were the same thing as my awareness of it, the sensation of blue and the sensation of green would have nothing in common and nothing to differ in - so the very intelligibility of experience requires the act-object distinction that *esse est percipi* must deny.

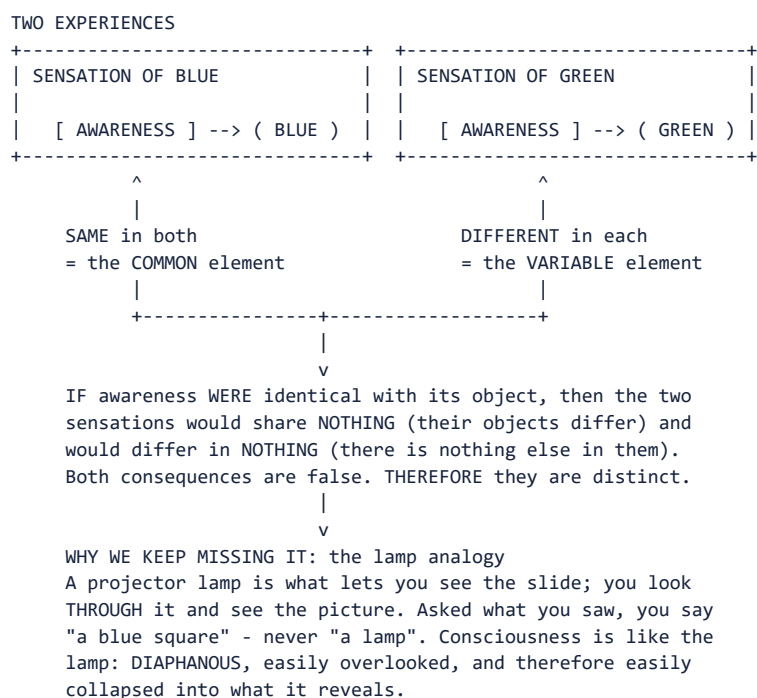
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)** - quote the Latin, then the English gloss
- **act of awareness against object of awareness** - the whole argument in five words

- **the common element and the variable element** - how the blue/green contrast is generated
- **transparency or diaphanous thesis** - why the conflation is so tempting
- **self-contradictory mistake ANALYSIS**: - Moore's own charge in the 2020 quotation; use his phrase
- **bounded conclusion** - one idealist argument blocked, mind-independence not thereby proved

How to use them: in a quotation-led question, name the paper and the year in the first line, then the target, then the distinction. The examiner is checking whether you can locate a sentence in an argument, not whether you can gloss it.

Plain-language visual - the same lamp, two slides



In simple words: if you insist that the seeing and the seen are one and the same thing, then when you look at something blue and then at something green you have not looked at two different things with one faculty - you have simply had two experiences with nothing whatever in common. But they obviously do have something in common: both are cases of *being aware*. That common element cannot be the blue, because the green case has no blue in it. So awareness is one thing and its object is another.

Remember first	Meaning
The paper is 1903 , in <i>Mind</i>	not <i>Principia Ethica</i> , published the same year
The target is esse est percipi*	the Berkeleyan equation, not idealism in every form
The argument is structural	it uses the intelligibility of comparison, not an appeal to intuition
Transparency explains the error	it is a diagnosis, not an extra premiss
The conclusion is narrow	one route to idealism is blocked; mind-independence needs more

One-line memory: what varies cannot be what stays the same.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the argument, the diagnosis and the exact boundary of the result

STEP 1 THE IDEALIST PRINCIPLE, AS MOORE STATES IT

```
+-----+
| esse est percipi - "to be is to be perceived". For the |
| inference to work, the object's BEING must be nothing over and |
| above its BEING PERCEIVED. The sensation and its object must |
| therefore be ONE THING, or the object a mere constituent of |
| the act. |
+-----+
```

STEP 2 THE DISTINCTION

```
+-----+
| ACT OF AWARENESS | OBJECT OF AWARENESS |
| consciousness; the same in | blue, green, this sound; |
| every sensation | different in each sensation |
+-----+
```

STEP 3 THE ARGUMENT FROM COMPARISON

```
+-----+
| "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and |
| consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is |
| different from either." |
| |
| If awareness = object, the two sensations share nothing; |
| if awareness = object, they differ in nothing further. |
| Both are false. Hence awareness != object. |
+-----+
```

STEP 4 THE 2020 SENTENCE - the same point in Moore's sharper form

```
+-----+
| "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same |
| thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he |
| makes a mistake and a SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY mistake." |
| |
| Why self-contradictory: the speaker asserts that the two |
| statements have the SAME content while using a distinction |
| between two items - blue and consciousness - to state the |
| second. He must have the distinction in order to deny it. |
+-----+
```

STEP 5 THE DIAGNOSIS - transparency / diaphanousness

```
+-----+
| Introspect the sensation of blue and what you find is the |
| BLUE. The act is elusive - "as if it were diaphanous". Being |
| hard to notice is not the same as not being there; the |
| idealist mistakes elusiveness for absence. |
+-----+
```

STEP 6 THE BOUNDARY - the half of the answer most scripts omit

```
+-----+
| ACHIEVED FACT: the identity route from object to act is blocked, |
| so esse est percipi is not established |
| NOT ACHIEVED ANALYSIS: that any object exists UNPERCEIVED |
| NOT ACHIEVED ANALYSIS: a positive theory of perception |
| NOT ACHIEVED ANALYSIS: a refutation of ABSOLUTE idealism, which does |
| not rest on the esse est percipi equation at all |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Steps 3 and 4 are the two quotations the 2025 and 2020 papers print. Step 6 is where the assessment marks are: an answer that claims Moore refutes idealism *tout court* has overclaimed on Moore's behalf.

1. Why the argument is stronger than an appeal to introspection

FACT: Moore does not simply report that he can detect two items. He argues that the idealist's own identification makes experience **unintelligible**: the sensations of blue and of green must have something in common, since both are sensations, and must differ in something, since they are of different colours. On the identity thesis there is only one item in each, so there is nothing available to play both roles.

ANALYSIS: This is why the argument survives the standard complaint that consciousness cannot be introspectively isolated. Moore *agrees* that it cannot easily be isolated - that is the transparency thesis - and turns the concession into an explanation of the error rather than an objection to the distinction.

2. The 2020 sentence, decoded FACT:

The printed quotation charges the idealist with "a mistake and a **self-contradictory** mistake". The self-contradiction is precise, and stating it exactly is the difference between a competent and a strong answer:

1. The claim is that "Blue exists" and "Both blue and consciousness exist" say the **same thing**.
2. But the second statement is formed by **conjoining two distinct items**, blue and consciousness.
3. To assert the identity of content, the speaker must therefore already **possess and use** the very distinction whose significance he is denying.
4. Therefore the identification is not merely false; it is unstatable without presupposing its own falsity.

ANALYSIS: **The residual**. The self-contradiction charge presses hardest against the strict identity formulation. An idealist who says instead that blue is *dependent on* consciousness without being *identical with* it has not been shown to contradict himself - he has been shown to need a different argument, since *esse est percipi* was the argument he had.

3. What "transparency" is and is not FACT:

- FACT: **It is a diagnosis** of why the act/object distinction is persistently overlooked: attention passes through the act to the object, so that when we try to attend to consciousness itself we find only what we are conscious of.
- ANALYSIS: **It is not a premiss** of the refutation. The refutation runs on the comparison argument; transparency explains the psychology of the mistake.
- CAUTION: **It is not uncontested**. Later philosophers of mind have used the same transparency observation to argue the opposite conclusion - that there is nothing to introspect *beyond* the object, and hence no separately identifiable act. Moore's reply must be that elusiveness is not non-existence, and the structural argument of Section 1 is what carries that reply.

4. The exact scope of the result - and the Berkeley/Hegel discrimination

Question	Answer
Does the paper refute the <i>esse est percipi</i> argument?	FACT: Yes - the identity it needs is denied on structural grounds
Does it prove objects exist unperceived?	ANALYSIS: No. Distinguishing the object from the act shows only that the object's being is not <i>constituted</i> by the act
Does it refute Berkeley's whole philosophy?	ANALYSIS: No. It refutes the equation on which the central argument rests; Berkeley's positive system, including God's perception, is Topic 03
Does it touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism?	FACT: No, and say so. Absolute Idealism does not argue from <i>esse est percipi</i> ; it argues from internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations
Does it supply a theory of perception?	ANALYSIS: No. Moore leaves the relation between sense-data and material objects unsettled - which is exactly the unfinished analysis Session 2 said may be left open

- ANALYSIS: **The comparative half of 2018 Q3(a)**. Moore's reaction to Berkeley is *epistemic and distinction-drawing*: he denies the identification and protects ordinary certainty. Russell's reaction is *logical and reconstructive*: he accepts that we are directly given sense-data and then rebuilds physical objects as **logical constructions** out of them, and reduces apparent names by contextual analysis. Both reject Berkeley's conclusion; only Russell offers a replacement architecture. That single sentence is the comparison the question asks for.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Moore's refutation of idealism is a bounded but decisive result: it destroys the argument from *esse est percipi* without establishing the mind-independence of anything. **Named evidence.** "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*, 1903) distinguishes the act of awareness from its object and argues that "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either"; the transparency or diaphanous character of consciousness is offered as the explanation of why the two are so persistently conflated. **Analysis.** The argument is structural rather than introspective - on the identity thesis the two sensations would share nothing and differ in nothing - and the sharper 1903 formulation quoted in 2020 shows the identification to be self-undermining, since it must deploy the distinction between blue and consciousness in order to deny that the distinction makes a difference. **Qualification.** What follows is only that the object is not constituted by the act: unperceived existence requires a further argument, no theory of perception is supplied, and Absolute Idealism, which never rested on the perceptual equation, is untouched - so the honest verdict is that Moore removed idealism's most economical argument rather than idealism itself.

Exam link

- **2025 Q3(c)** prints the blue/green/consciousness sentence and asks for an account of the refutation "with reference to this statement": name the paper and year, give the target, run the comparison argument, add transparency, then close on Step 6.
- **2020 Q2(b)** prints the "self-contradictory mistake" sentence: Section 2 is the specific decoding it demands, and the residual in Section 2 is the "critically" half.
- **2018 Q3(a)** (Empiricism-owned) asks for the Moore/Russell difference: Section 4's last bullet is the comparison.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Moore refutes idealism" without qualification	He refutes the <i>esse est percipi</i> argument. Absolute Idealism is untouched, and mind-independence is not proved
Confusing 1903 <i>Mind</i> with <i>Principia Ethica</i>	Same year, different book, different subject. The naturalistic fallacy is not in this clause
Making transparency a premiss	It diagnoses the error; the comparison argument does the refuting
Paraphrasing the printed quotation	Both 2020 and 2025 print exact sentences. Reproduce them and then explain the words <i>self-contradictory</i> , <i>common</i> and <i>different</i>
Treating the act/object distinction as proof of realism	It blocks an identification. Realism needs Moore's <i>other</i> argument, the proof of 1939

Revision notes

- "The Refutation of Idealism", *Mind*, 1903. Target: *esse est percipi*.
- Act of awareness (common element) vs object of awareness (variable element).
- Comparison argument: on the identity thesis the two sensations share nothing and differ in nothing - both false.
- 2020 sentence: the identification is a "self-contradictory mistake" because it must use the distinction to state itself.
- Transparency/diaphanousness: a diagnosis of the error, not a premiss; CAUTION: later used against Moore by defenders of a no-act view.
- Bounded result: *esse est percipi* blocked FACT: · unperceived existence not proved ANALYSIS: · no theory of perception ANALYSIS: · Absolute Idealism untouched FACT:.
- Moore vs Russell on Berkeley: distinction-drawing and epistemic defence against logical reconstruction by constructions and contextual analysis.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE REFUTATION OF IDEALISM

1903 "THE REFUTATION OF IDEALISM" (Mind)

|

v

TARGET: esse est percipi - the object's being is nothing beyond being perceived, so SENSATION and OBJECT must be ONE

|

v

ACT of awareness [COMMON] ---- vs ---- OBJECT of awareness [VARIABLE]

|

v

COMPARISON ARGUMENT: blue and green sensations must SHARE something and DIFFER in something; identity leaves neither available
"Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."

|

v

2020 SHARPENING: identifying "Blue exists" with "Both blue and consciousness exist" is a SELF-CONTRADICTION mistake - it uses the distinction it denies

|

v

DIAGNOSIS: TRANSPARENCY / DIAPHANOUSNESS - the act is looked THROUGH, so elusiveness is mistaken for absence

|

v

BOUNDARY: blocks the identity route FACT: | does NOT prove unperceived existence ANALYSIS: | no theory of perception ANALYSIS: | Absolute Idealism untouched FACT: | Berkeley's system is TOPIC 03

ANSWER LINE: what varies cannot be what stays the same

SESSION 5 - RUSSELL'S INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND THE THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Phrases like "the present King of France" or "the golden mountain" look like names. If they were names, they would have to name something, and then a sentence containing one would be about a non-existent object - or would be meaningless. Russell's answer is that such phrases are not names at all. When you write the sentence out properly, the phrase disappears and is replaced by a claim that *there is exactly one thing of a certain kind, and it has a certain property*. The sentence then turns out to be plainly false rather than meaningless or mysterious.

Technical definition: An **incomplete symbol** is an expression that has **no meaning in isolation** but contributes systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs, and which **disappears on analysis**; it is given a **contextual definition** - a rule for eliminating whole sentences containing it - rather than a definition in its own right. The paradigm case is the **definite description**, a phrase of the form "the so-and-so". Russell's **theory of descriptions** ("On Denoting", *Mind*, 1905) analyses "The F is G" into the conjunction of three claims: **existence** - there is at least one F; **uniqueness** - there is at most one F; and **predication** - that thing is G. Formally: **(Ex)(Fx & (Ay)(Fy -> y = x) & Gx]**. ANALYSIS: The theory therefore replaces a referring expression by a **quantificational** structure, which is why the failure of reference produces falsity rather than meaninglessness.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Russell's theory of descriptions is the founding demonstration that grammar can lie: "the golden mountain" wears the costume of a name, but once the sentence is written in logical notation the apparent name has vanished entirely, and with it the pressure to find something for it to designate.

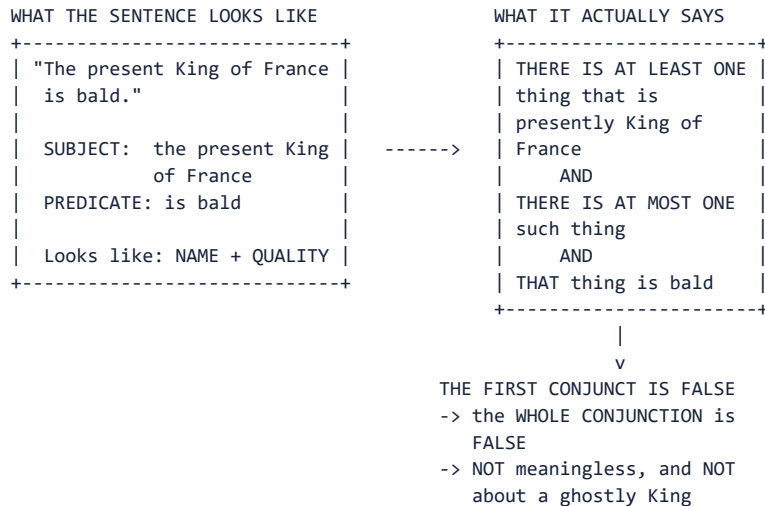
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **incomplete symbol** - no meaning in isolation; defined contextually; disappears on analysis
- **denoting phrase** - Russell's own term for "a so-and-so", "all so-and-sos", "the so-and-so"
- **existence, uniqueness, predication** - the three conjuncts; write them, in notation

- **false, not meaningless** - the result, stated in the words the examiner is looking for
- **primary and secondary occurrence** - Russell's scope terminology
- **Meinong's jungle ANALYSIS**: - the ontological inflation the theory is designed to avoid
- **grammatical form is not logical form** - the general principle the theory establishes

How to use them: in any descriptions question, produce the **notation** early. The directive decoder in this topic is unusually strict: a script that explains "the golden mountain" in words alone has not done what "discuss in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions" asks.

Plain-language visual - the costume and the body



In simple words: the sentence is wearing a costume. It is dressed as "this thing has that property", and so we go looking for the thing. Strip the costume off and what is underneath is a general claim about *how many* things of a certain kind there are and *what* they are like. Since there are none, the claim is simply untrue - in the same ordinary way that "there is exactly one unicorn in this room, and it is grey" is untrue. Nothing spooky is required.

Remember first	Meaning
The phrase is not a name	it is an incomplete symbol given a contextual definition
Three conjuncts, in order	existence · uniqueness · predication
The verdict is false	meaninglessness is what the theory <i>avoids</i>
No object is posited	ANALYSIS: this is the reply to Meinong, not a side-remark
The year is 1905 , in <i>Mind</i>	Ramsey later called it "a paradigm of philosophy"

One-line memory: "the F" is a quantifier in disguise, not a name in trouble.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the problem, the three rejected answers, and the analysis

THE PROBLEM (Russell's own setting)
"The present King of France is bald."
Grammatically impeccable. Understood by every competent speaker.
And there is no present King of France.

THREE ANSWERS RUSSELL REJECTS

```
+-----+
| (a) THE SENTENCE IS MEANINGLESS.          |
|      WRONG: But we understand it, and we can argue about it.          |
+-----+
| (b) IT IS ABOUT A NON-EXISTENT OBJECT THAT SUBSISTS.          |
|      WRONG: MEINONG's route. It populates the world with golden      |
|      mountains and round squares, and the round square              |
|      threatens the law of non-contradiction.                      |
+-----+
| (c) "THE PRESENT KING OF FRANCE" DENOTES SOMETHING ELSE.          |
|      WRONG: Then what? No candidate survives inspection.          |
+-----+
```

RUSSELL'S ANALYSIS - the phrase is eliminated, not interpreted

```
+-----+
| "The F is G"                                                     |
|      =                                                           |
| (Ex)[ Fx AND (Ay)(Fy -> y = x) AND Gx ]                          |
|      ^           ^           ^                                   |
|      |           |           |                                   |
|      EXISTENCE   UNIQUENESS   PREDICATION                       |
|      at least one at most one it is G                           |
+-----+
```

THE THREE PUZZLES THIS SOLVES

```
+-----+
| NEGATIVE      | "The present King of France does not          |
| EXISTENTIALS  | exist" = "it is NOT the case that there          |
|               | is exactly one present King of France."          |
|               | TRUE, and nothing is denoted.                  |
+-----+
| EXCLUDED MIDDLE | "is bald" is FALSE; and its negation,          |
|               | correctly parsed with WIDE scope for the          |
|               | negation, is TRUE. No violation.              |
+-----+
| SUBSTITUTIVITY | George IV wished to know whether Scott          |
| IN ATTITUDE    | was the author of Waverley. Substituting          |
| CONTEXTS       | "Scott" would make the wish trivial. But          |
|               | "the author of Waverley" is NOT a name,          |
|               | so no substitution licence exists.          |
+-----+
```

SCOPE - PRIMARY AND SECONDARY OCCURRENCE

```
+-----+
| "The King of France is not bald."                                |
| PRIMARY (wide scope for the description):                        |
|   there is exactly one King of France AND he is not bald        |
|   -> FALSE                                                        |
| SECONDARY (narrow scope; negation takes wide scope):            |
|   it is not the case that (there is exactly one King of          |
|   France and he is bald)                                         |
|   -> TRUE                                                         |
| ONE sentence, TWO logical forms. Ambiguity of SCOPE, not of    |
| meaning of the words.                                           |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The three puzzles are Russell's own advertisement for the theory: a theory that solves three independent problems with one device is not an *ad hoc* repair. Say that explicitly; it is the "why it matters" mark.

1. What makes a symbol "incomplete" - the definition and its test FACT:

- FACT: **Definition.** A symbol is incomplete when it has no meaning in isolation and is defined only through rules that give the meaning of **whole sentences** in which it occurs. Russell takes the technique from the practice of *contextual definition* in *Principia Mathematica*.
- FACT: **The test to apply in the exam.** Ask: *does the expression survive analysis as a constituent of the proposition?* If the correct analysis contains no corresponding constituent, the expression was an incomplete

symbol. "The author of *Waverley*" fails to survive; "Scott" - as a genuine name - would survive.

- **WRONG: The commonest error.** "Incomplete symbol" does **not** mean "meaningless". The phrase is systematically meaning-*contributing*; it simply has no meaning **on its own**. Write the words "in isolation" and the error is avoided.
- **ANALYSIS: Consequence for ontology.** Because the phrase contributes no constituent, the truth of a sentence containing it commits us to nothing beyond the existence of things satisfying the predicates. This is what makes the theory an instrument of **ontological economy** and connects it to Sessions 7 and 8.

2. "The golden mountain is very high" - the 2025 question, worked FACT:

1. The apparent name is "the golden mountain"; treat it as an incomplete symbol.
2. Analyse: there is at least one thing that is a golden mountain; at most one such thing; and it is very high. **(Ex)[Gx & (Ay)(Gy → y = x) & Hx]**.
3. The **existence** conjunct is false, so the conjunction is false.
4. Therefore the sentence is **false**, not meaningless, and asserting it commits us to no golden mountain, subsisting or otherwise.
5. **ANALYSIS:** Add the scope point to secure the top band: the *negation* "the golden mountain is not very high" is **false** on the primary reading and **true** on the secondary reading, so the apparent violation of excluded middle is a scope ambiguity.

ANALYSIS: Why the example was chosen by the examiner. The golden mountain is Meinong's own stock example. Naming Meinong, and saying in one clause what his position was, shows that you know what the theory was *for*.

3. The three puzzles, and what each was blocking FACT:

Puzzle	What went wrong before Russell	What the analysis delivers
Negative existentials	To deny that something exists you seem to have to refer to it first, which grants it exactly the existence you are denying	The denial becomes the negation of an existence-and-uniqueness claim; no reference is attempted, so nothing is granted
Excluded middle	If "the F is G" is neither true nor false when there is no F, bivalence appears to fail	The sentence is false; its negation, parsed with the negation taking wide scope, is true; bivalence is preserved and the appearance of failure is a scope ambiguity
Substitutivity in attitude contexts	If "the author of <i>Waverley</i> " = Scott, George IV's curiosity becomes curiosity about whether Scott is Scott	The description is not a name and denotes nothing in the required sense, so the identity does not license substitution inside the attitude context

4. The standing objection - Strawson, and how far it reaches CAUTION:

FACT: The objection. P. F. Strawson, "On Referring" (*Mind*, 1950), argues that Russell has confused a sentence with a **use** of a sentence. Someone who says "The present King of France is bald" is not *asserting* that there is exactly one King of France; he is **presupposing** it. When the presupposition fails, the question of truth or falsity **does not arise** - the utterance is not false but void.

ANALYSIS: Russell's available replies.

1. Strawson's account describes conversational expectation; Russell's account gives **truth-conditions**, and a theory of truth-conditions is what a logic requires.
2. Presupposition failure needs a semantics of its own - typically a truth-value gap - and gaps carry their own costs for classical logic.
3. The analysis is not offered as ordinary-language lexicography; it is a proposal about **logical form** for use in a scientifically regimented language.

CAUTION: The honest verdict. This is a genuine rival analysis rather than a demonstration of error. Most philosophers now accept that Strawson describes ordinary usage better and that Russell's quantificational treatment remains the more tractable account of logical form. **ANALYSIS: Owner boundary:** Strawson appears here as **one objection**; his positive theory of reference, and his descriptive metaphysics, belong to Topic 11.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The theory of descriptions works by removing a constituent rather than by interpreting one: "the F" is shown to be an incomplete symbol that disappears under analysis, and with it the demand for something for it to designate.

Named evidence. "On Denoting" (*Mind*, 1905) analyses "The F is G" as $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$, so that "The present King of France is bald" asserts existence, uniqueness and predication together, and is false because the first conjunct is false; the same device resolves negative existentials, apparent failures of excluded middle, and the failure of substitutivity in George IV's curiosity about the author of *Waverley*.

Analysis. Because the analysis is quantificational, reference-failure produces ordinary falsity rather than meaninglessness or a Meinongian object, and the apparent violation of excluded middle is exposed as an ambiguity of **scope** between primary and secondary occurrence rather than a defect in logic.

Qualification. Strawson's "On Referring" (1950) argues that existence is presupposed rather than asserted, so that the question of truth does not arise when the presupposition fails; this is a rival analysis rather than a refutation, and the durable verdict is that Russell's account of logical form has outlasted his account of ordinary use.

Exam link

- **2025 Q1(d)**, ten marks, is Section 2 exactly: notation, the false existence-conjunct, the "false not meaningless" verdict, Meinong named, and one scope sentence.
- **2023 Q4(b)**, fifteen marks, asks *why* the King-of-France proposition is "problematic": run Section 0's three rejected answers, then the analysis, then Strawson from Section 4 for the "critically".
- **2024 Q3(a)** and **2018 Q4(c)** both use this session as their first half; the second half is Sessions 7 and 8.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"The theory shows the sentence is meaningless"	It shows it is false . Meaninglessness is what the analysis avoids
"Incomplete symbol" = meaningless expression	No meaning in isolation ; it contributes systematically in context
Omitting the notation	The directive in every descriptions PYQ demands the analysis, not a paraphrase
Omitting uniqueness	Two conjuncts are not the theory. "The" carries uniqueness; "a" does not
Presenting Strawson as a refutation	It is a rival analysis about use and presupposition; Russell's logic survives it
Treating scope as a technicality	The excluded-middle puzzle is <i>solved</i> by scope; it is a marks-bearing point

Revision notes

- Incomplete symbol: no meaning in isolation · contextual definition · disappears on analysis. **WRONG**: Not "meaningless".
- "On Denoting", *Mind*, 1905. Denoting phrases: "a so-and-so", "all so-and-sos", "the so-and-so".
- "The F is G" = $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$ - existence, uniqueness, predication.
- Empty description -> false, not meaningless; no Meinongian subsisting object.
- Three puzzles: negative existentials · excluded middle (solved by scope) · substitutivity in attitude contexts (George IV and *Waverley*).
- Primary occurrence = description takes wide scope, sentence false; secondary occurrence = negation takes wide scope, sentence true.
- Strawson 1950: presupposition, not assertion; truth-value question does not arise. **CAUTION**: Rival analysis, not refutation; Topic 11 owns his positive theory.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND DESCRIPTIONS

PROBLEM: "The present King of France is bald" - meaningful, grammatical,
and there is no such King
|
+--> REJECT: meaningless (we understand it)
+--> REJECT: about a subsisting object (Meinong's jungle)
+--> REJECT: denotes something else (no candidate)
|
v
INCOMPLETE SYMBOL: no meaning IN ISOLATION | contextual definition |
DISAPPEARS on analysis
|
v
ANALYSIS: $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$
EXISTENCE + UNIQUENESS + PREDICATION
|
v
EMPTY DESCRIPTION -> first conjunct false -> WHOLE SENTENCE FALSE
(not meaningless, no ghostly object)
|
v
THREE PUZZLES SOLVED
negative existentials | excluded middle (SCOPE) | substitutivity
(George IV / the author of Waverley)
|
v
SCOPE: PRIMARY (description wide) FALSE | SECONDARY (negation wide) TRUE
|
v
OBJECTION: STRAWSON 1950 - presupposition, not assertion; truth question
does not arise. RIVAL ANALYSIS, not refutation. Topic 11 owns his system
ANSWER LINE: "the F" is a quantifier in disguise, not a name in trouble

SESSION 6 - ACQUAINTANCE AND DESCRIPTION: THE EPISTEMOLOGY THE LOGIC WAS BUILT TO SERVE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Russell divides knowledge of *things* into two kinds. Some things I meet directly - this patch of red, this feeling of hardness, my own present thought. Others I have never met and never could meet - Bismarck, the electron, the centre of mass of the solar system - and about these I know only that there is exactly one thing answering to a certain description. The theory of descriptions exists to explain how the second kind of knowledge is possible without breaking the rule that I can only understand what I am acquainted with.

Technical definition: **Knowledge by acquaintance** is direct, presentational and **non-inferential** awareness of an item, without the intermediary of any process of inference or knowledge of truths; its objects are **sense-data**, **memory data**, **introspective data** of one's own mental states, and **universals**. **Knowledge by description** is indirect and propositional: knowledge *that* there is exactly one thing answering to a description, together with whatever is inferred about it. The controlling epistemic rule is the **Principle of Acquaintance**: FACT: *"Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted"* (*The Problems of Philosophy*, 1912, Ch. 5). ANALYSIS: In Russell's austere phase only demonstratives such as "this" and "that", used for something presently given, qualify as **logically proper names**; ordinary proper names are analysed as **disguised descriptions**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The theory of descriptions is not a puzzle-solving device that happens to be useful in epistemology; it is the instrument Russell built to discharge an epistemological debt, because without it his own Principle of Acquaintance would make it impossible to understand a single proposition about Bismarck, an electron, or anything else one has never met.

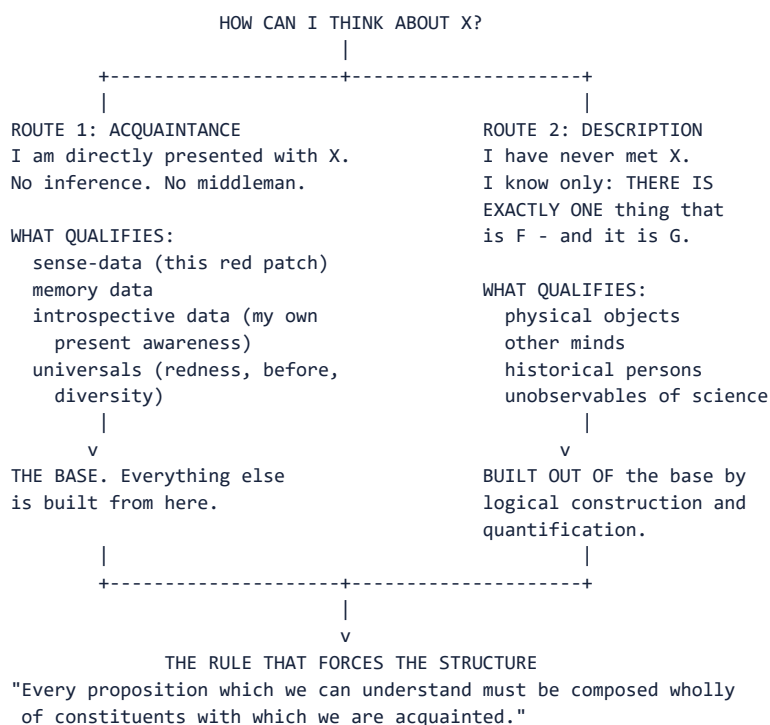
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **acquaintance** - direct, presentational, non-inferential; "without the intermediary of any process of inference"
- **knowledge by description** - the *there is exactly one F* structure
- **the Principle of Acquaintance** - quote it verbatim; it is safe from *Problems*, Ch. 5

- **sense-data** - the objects of acquaintance in this phase, along with universals
- **logically proper name** - "this", "that", used of what is presently given
- **disguised description ANALYSIS**: - the account of ordinary names that Kripke later attacks
- **the Bismarck series** - Russell's own graded example; use it, it is memorable and it is his

How to use them: any answer on descriptions that adds this session moves from competent to first-class, because it says *why the machinery was built*. State the Principle, state the problem it creates, and present descriptions as the solution.

Plain-language visual - the two routes to a thing



In simple words: you cannot think *with* something you have never encountered. So how do you manage to think about Bismarck? Not by having Bismarck in your thought, but by having in your thought only concepts you *have* encountered - being a chancellor, being German, being first - arranged into the claim that exactly one thing satisfies them. Bismarck himself never enters your mind; a description does his work.

Remember first	Meaning
Two kinds of knowledge of things	acquaintance is direct; description is propositional and indirect
Universals are objects of acquaintance	ANALYSIS: a large concession for an empiricist - say so
The Principle is a constraint on understanding	not a constraint on truth
Descriptions rescue the Principle	the constituents become universals and logical apparatus
Ordinary names are disguised descriptions	ANALYSIS: phase-specific, and the part Kripke destroys

One-line memory: I cannot think with what I have never met - so I think with a description instead.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the argument in six steps, and the two objections it must survive

THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED

- 1 To understand a proposition is to grasp its constituents.
- 2 I can grasp only what I am acquainted with.
- 3 Yet I plainly understand propositions about Bismarck, Julius Caesar and electrons - with none of which I am acquainted.
- 4 So EITHER the Principle is false, OR such propositions do not really contain those items as constituents.
- 5 THE THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS takes the second route: "the F is G" contains NO constituent "the F" at all. It unpacks into an existentially quantified sentence whose constituents are the UNIVERSALS F and G plus logical apparatus - all acquaintance items.
- 6 Therefore the Principle is preserved.

THE BISMARCK SERIES - Russell's own graded example

BISMARCK HIMSELF	acquaintance with his own self-consciousness; the constituent is given to him
SOMEONE WHO MET BISMARCK	acquaintance with sense-data he took to be of the man; the description is anchored to HIS particulars
SOMEONE WHO ONLY READ OF BISMARCK	purely descriptive: "the first Chancellor of the German Empire"
ALL OF US, OF "THE MOST LONG-LIVED OF MEN"	a description satisfied by someone we may never identify - and the proposition is still FULLY UNDERSTOOD

Russell's moral: we have MERELY DESCRIPTIVE knowledge of the so-and-so when we do not know any proposition "a is the so-and-so" where a is something with which we are acquainted.

THE TWO OBJECTIONS THAT SHAPE THE MODERN VERDICT

KRIPKE, Naming and Necessity (lectures 1970, book 1980) Ordinary proper names are NOT disguised descriptions. "Aristotle" would still name Aristotle even if every description we associate with him turned out false. Names are RIGID DESIGNATORS. RUSSELL'S RETREAT: confine the claim to LOGICALLY proper names and abandon the description theory of ordinary names. ANALYSIS: STANDARD VERDICT: the LOGIC of descriptions survives; the THEORY OF NAMES does not.	
SELLARS, "Empiricism and the Philosophy of Mind" (1956) The MYTH OF THE GIVEN: nothing is given uninterpreted, and what is given non-conceptually cannot justify beliefs. RUSSELL'S REPLY: acquaintance is presentation, not knowledge of truths. CAUTION: RESIDUAL: then how does it GROUND anything? This is the live weakness of the whole edifice.	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The six numbered steps are the answer to "why does Russell need the theory of descriptions?" The two boxes are the assessment. Note that they attack different halves - Kripke the theory of *names*, Sellars the theory of *acquaintance* - and that Russell can survive one without surviving the other.

1. What acquaintance is, exactly FACT:

- FACT: **Direct and non-inferential.** The object of acquaintance is one of which we are "directly aware... without the intermediary of any process of inference or any knowledge of truths". Acquaintance is a **relation to a thing**, not the possession of a proposition.
- FACT: **The inventory in this phase.** Sense-data; memory data; introspective data of one's own mental states; and **universals** - redness, diversity, the relation *before*.
- ANALYSIS: **The concession that must be flagged.** Admitting acquaintance with universals is a substantial **Platonic** commitment for a philosopher in the British empiricist line, and Russell accepts it openly against

Berkeley's nominalism. Marking this is the sort of one-clause discrimination that separates scripts.

- ANALYSIS: **The phase warning.** Sense-data acquaintance, the 1918 atomism and the later **neutral monism** are three different positions held at three different times. WRONG: Do not present them as one timeless Russellian doctrine.

2. Logically proper names, and why the class is so small FACT:

FACT: A **logically proper name** is a symbol that directly designates an item of acquaintance and could not fail to designate. In Russell's austere phase the only serious candidates are the demonstratives "**this**" and "**that**", used of something presently given in sense-experience.

ANALYSIS: Two consequences follow, and both are examinable.

1. Ordinary names - "Bismarck", "Socrates", "Homer" - are **disguised definite descriptions**, and sentences containing them are analysed by the theory of descriptions.
2. The set of genuine names therefore shrinks almost to nothing, and it shrinks *differently for each speaker and each moment*, since what is presently given differs. Russell was fully aware of how restrictive this is.

CAUTION: **Where it breaks.** Kripke's modal argument is decisive against the account of ordinary names: had the descriptions we associate with "Aristotle" been satisfied by someone else, the name would still have picked out Aristotle. ANALYSIS: Russell can retreat to the narrower claim about logically proper names, but the retreat is a real loss.

3. How this session changes a descriptions answer ANALYSIS:

Answer without this session	Answer with it
Descriptions solve three puzzles about denoting	Descriptions discharge an epistemological debt : they let Russell keep the Principle of Acquaintance while speaking of what he has never met
The theory is a piece of logical grammar	The theory is the junction at which Russell's logic and his epistemology meet
Strawson is the objection	Strawson attacks the semantics; Kripke attacks the theory of names and Sellars attacks the base - three different objections at three different places

ANALYSIS: **The executable verdict.** "Acquaintance and description is where Russell's logic and his epistemology meet: the theory of descriptions is the price he pays to keep the Principle of Acquaintance while speaking of what he has never met. The logical machinery has proved permanent; the epistemology it was built to serve - sense-data as bedrock, ordinary names as disguised descriptions - has not survived Sellars and Kripke. That asymmetry is the most instructive fact about Russell's philosophy."

4. The bridge forward FACT:

Acquaintance also sets up the next two sessions. If the only items I meet directly are sense-data and universals, then **physical objects** are not met directly - and the question of how I am entitled to talk about them becomes urgent. Russell's answer is the doctrine of **logical constructions** (Session 7), and the residue that analysis is supposed to leave behind is what **logical atomism** calls an atom (Session 8). The three doctrines are one programme run in three registers: epistemic, methodological and ontological.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Russell's distinction between knowledge by acquaintance and knowledge by description is not an appendix to the theory of descriptions but its motive: the logic exists to make the epistemology survivable. **Named evidence.** *The Problems of Philosophy* (1912, Ch. 5), following the 1910-11 Aristotelian Society paper, states the Principle of Acquaintance - "Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted" - and grades the Bismarck case from Bismarck's own self-consciousness, through the acquaintance of someone who met him, to the purely descriptive knowledge of a reader, and finally to "the most long-lived of men", a description whose satisfier we may never identify. **Analysis.** Since I plainly understand propositions about Bismarck without being acquainted with him, either the Principle fails or such propositions do not contain him as a constituent; the theory of descriptions takes the second route, replacing the apparent constituent with universals and logical apparatus that *are* items of acquaintance. **Qualification.** The rescue is bought at two prices that later philosophy has refused to pay - Kripke's modal argument shows that ordinary names are rigid designators rather than disguised descriptions, and Sellars's attack on the Myth of the Given asks how a non-propositional presentation could justify anything - so the durable position is that Russell's logical instrument outlived the epistemology it was designed to protect.

Exam link

- **2024 Q3(a)** and **2018 Q4(c)** are strengthened by one paragraph from this session, placed immediately after the definition of the incomplete symbol: it explains *why* Russell wanted the elimination in the first place.
- **2023 Q4(b)** and **2025 Q1(d)** can each use one sentence - the Principle of Acquaintance - as the reason the analysis is not arbitrary.
- **2018 Q3(a)** (Empiricism-owned): Russell's reaction to Berkeley is built here and in Session 7 - sense-data accepted, physical objects reconstructed.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Treating acquaintance as a kind of <i>propositional</i> knowledge	It is a relation to a thing , non-inferential and not knowledge of truths
Forgetting universals	They are objects of acquaintance, and the admission is a real break with the empiricist line
Presenting one timeless Russell	Sense-data acquaintance, 1918 atomism and later neutral monism are three phases
Making Kripke and Sellars the same objection	Kripke attacks the theory of names ; Sellars attacks the given . Different targets, different residues
Saying Kripke refutes the theory of descriptions	He refutes its extension to ordinary proper names . The analysis of definite descriptions stands

Revision notes

- Acquaintance: direct, presentational, non-inferential; objects are sense-data, memory data, introspective data and universals.
- Description: knowledge that exactly one thing is F, plus what is inferred of it; covers physical objects, other minds, history, unobservables.
- Principle of Acquaintance (*Problems*, 1912, Ch. 5), quotable verbatim.
- Six-step argument: understanding is constituent-grasping -> I grasp only what I meet -> yet I understand Bismarck-propositions -> so either the Principle fails or the constituent is absent -> descriptions remove it -> Principle preserved.
- Bismarck series: himself · one who met him · one who read of him · "the most long-lived of men".
- Logically proper names: "this", "that", of what is presently given; ordinary names are disguised descriptions
ANALYSIS:.

- Objections: Kripke 1970/1980 on rigid designation (names) · Sellars 1956 on the Myth of the Given (base). Verdict: the logic survives, the epistemology does not.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ACQUAINTANCE AND DESCRIPTION

PRINCIPLE OF ACQUAINTANCE (Problems, 1912, Ch. 5)

"Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted."

|

v

ACQUAINTANCE = direct, non-inferential presentation

sense-data | memory | introspection | UNIVERSALS (the Platonic concession)

|

v

PROBLEM: I understand propositions about BISMARCK, CAESAR, ELECTRONS - none of which I have met

|

v

DILEMMA: either the Principle is false, or those items are NOT constituents of the propositions

|

v

DESCRIPTIONS TAKE THE SECOND ROUTE -> "the F is G" has NO constituent "the F"; its constituents are UNIVERSALS + logical apparatus

|

v

BISMARCK SERIES: himself | one who met him | one who read of him | "the most long-lived of men"

|

v

LOGICALLY PROPER NAMES: "this", "that" only; ORDINARY names are DISGUISED DESCRIPTIONS ANALYSIS:

|

v

OBJECTIONS: KRIPKE (rigid designators, names) | SELLARS (Myth of the Given, base)

VERDICT: the logical machinery is permanent; the epistemology it served is not

ANSWER LINE: the theory of descriptions is the price Russell pays to keep the Principle of Acquaintance

SESSION 7 - LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS AND THE SUPREME MAXIM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: If I have never met a physical object directly - only patches of colour, shapes and feels - then saying that a table exists *behind* my experiences is an inference to something unknown. Russell proposes a different move. Instead of inferring a hidden table, define "the table" in terms of an orderly system of actual and possible appearances that I *do* meet. The table then stops being a guess and becomes a construction out of things already known.

Technical definition: A **logical construction** is an entity-talk that is given a **contextual definition** in terms of items already available, so that sentences about the apparent entity are translated into sentences about the base items and no *additional* entity is posited. The programme is governed by Russell's **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** ("The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics" and *Our Knowledge of the External World*, both 1914):

FACT: "*Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities.*"

ANALYSIS: The doctrine is a **period-specific programme** and not Russell's permanent final ontology; the later **neutral monism**, which reconceives mental and physical items in terms of neutral events, is a different position and is not a printed limb of this clause.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

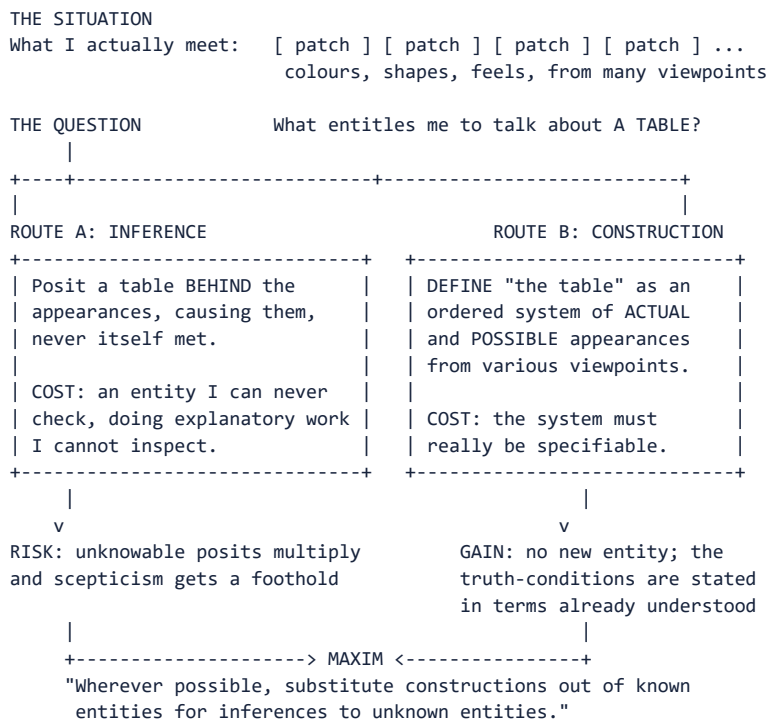
Russell's doctrine of logical constructions is Ockham's razor turned into a working procedure: wherever a philosopher is tempted to *infer* an entity he cannot meet in order to explain what he can, Russell asks him first to try *building* the explanation from what he already has - and the table, the nation, the number and the point of space all turn out to be buildable.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **the supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** - quote it; it is the whole doctrine in one sentence
- **constructions out of known entities against inferences to unknown entities** - the contrast that generates the maxim
- **contextual definition** - the technical link back to incomplete symbols
- **ontological economy** - the purpose, in the examiner's vocabulary
- **actual and possible sense-data** - the base for the physical-object construction in this phase
- ANALYSIS: **not fictions** - constructions are not pretences; true things are said about tables and nations
- ANALYSIS: **phase-specific** - do not merge the 1914 programme with later neutral monism

How to use them: state the maxim, then give **at least two examples of different types** - a physical object and a non-physical one such as a nation or a number - because the range is what shows the maxim is a general method rather than a solution to one problem.

Plain-language visual - infer, or build?



In simple words: suppose you keep receiving letters signed "the committee" and you are wondering whether there is a committee-shaped object somewhere. Russell's advice is: do not go looking for the object. Say instead what makes a sentence about the committee true - certain people meeting, deciding, signing - and you will find that everything you wanted to say can be said without any extra thing existing. That is a logical construction.

Remember first	Meaning
The maxim is methodological	it tells you what to try first, not what reality contains
Constructions get contextual definitions	the same technique as incomplete symbols
They are not fictions	"there is a nation" can be true; it just posits no extra entity
The base is phase-specific	in 1914 it is actual and possible sense-data

Remember first	Meaning
The range is wide	tables, nations, numbers, points, instants

One-line memory: build it out of what you have before you posit what you cannot meet.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the four standard constructions and the atom/construction contrast

FOUR WORKED EXAMPLES - learn at least two of different types

APPARENT ENTITY	CONSTRUCTED OUT OF
A physical object ("this table")	classes of ACTUAL and POSSIBLE sense-data from various points of view
A "nation"	patterns of behaviour of individual persons
A number	classes of equinumerous classes (the Frege-Russell definition)
A point of space	convergent classes of volumes

NOTE THE SPREAD: one perceptual, one social, one mathematical, one geometrical. That spread is the evidence that the maxim is a METHOD.

=====

LOGICAL ATOMS vs LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS - the contrast that is tested

LOGICAL ATOMS (basic)	LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS (derived)
genuinely exist as independent simples within the analysis	add NO further entity; the SYMBOLS for them are defined CONTEXTUALLY
treated as basic constituents of atomic facts	derived discourse receives a contextual construction
the GROUND of knowledge	convenient shorthand for complexes of atoms

=====

THE THREE THINGS A CONSTRUCTION IS NOT

WRONG: NOT a fiction - we say TRUE things about tables and nations

WRONG: NOT an elimination of ordinary talk - the talk is preserved and given truth-conditions

WRONG: NOT a claim that the object is "really" a bundle of experiences in some phenomenalist metaphysics that Russell held permanently -
ANALYSIS: it is a proposed reduction / structural reconstruction, and Russell's own commitments changed

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The right-hand column of the second box is the answer to "how do constructions relate to atomism?" - constructions are what analysis *removes*, atoms are what analysis is *looking for*. The two doctrines are the two ends of one procedure.

1. Why the maxim is a razor, and what kind of razor FACT:

- FACT: **Occam's razor, applied to inference rather than to entities in general.** Russell's target is a specific bad habit: explaining what we meet by positing what we cannot. The maxim does not say "there are no unknown entities"; it says that a construction, where available, is **epistemically preferable** because its adequacy can be checked.
- ANALYSIS: **What follows and what does not.** FACT: It follows that we should not *infer* a table if a construction does the same work. ANALYSIS: It does not follow that there is no table, nor that "table" is a false or empty word. Russell's claim is about the **entities our theory must posit**, not about the truth of ordinary sentences.
- FACT: **The name.** Russell himself calls it the **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising**; the phrase is safe to quote and signals that he intends a general method for philosophy modelled on scientific parsimony.

2. The connection to incomplete symbols - one technique, two applications **FACT:**

Incomplete symbols (Session 5)	Logical constructions (this session)
"The F" has no meaning in isolation and disappears on analysis	"The table" is given a contextual construction and posits no extra entity
Removes a pseudo-constituent from a proposition	Removes a pseudo-posit from an ontology
Device: quantificational paraphrase	Device: definition in terms of ordered classes of base items
Result: the sentence is false rather than meaningless when nothing satisfies	Result: the sentence is true, and its truth requires only base items

- **FACT: The unifying idea.** In both cases an expression that looks as if it must designate is given rules for the **whole sentences** in which it occurs. Russell's phrase for this in *Principia Mathematica* is contextual definition; "incomplete symbol" is the name for expressions so defined.
- **ANALYSIS: The difference that must not be blurred.** A definite description with no satisfier makes its sentence **false**. A logical construction is not a failure case at all - sentences about tables and nations are typically **true**; what is denied is only that their truth requires an additional entity.

3. The strain in the physical-object construction **CAUTION:**

FACT: The problem of possible sense-data. To construct a table Russell must appeal not only to sense-data actually occurring but to those that *would* occur from viewpoints no one occupies - "sensibilia". This is where the programme is most exposed.

Objection CAUTION:	Reply available to Russell ANALYSIS:	Residual
Possible sense-data are not <i>known</i> entities, so the construction has smuggled back the inference it was meant to avoid	The appeal is to a structural system of appearances, specifiable in general terms, rather than to a hidden particular	CAUTION: Whether a system of unrealised possibilities is genuinely more economical than one physical object is still disputed
Building the world from private sense-data invites solipsism	Constructions are public-theoretical reconstructions aimed at explanatory economy, not a denial of common objects or of science	ANALYSIS: The reply is available; it does not by itself supply an account of how different observers' bases connect
The base itself is unstable, since Russell later abandoned sense-data for neutral events	FACT: Correct, and it should be conceded: the 1914 construction is a phase	ANALYSIS: Concede it and the answer gains credit for provenance discipline rather than losing it

- **ANALYSIS: The exam-safe verdict.** The **technique** of construction is a permanent contribution to philosophical method and survives independently of the phenomenalist base; the specific **1914 construction of physical objects out of actual and possible sense-data** is strained and was not retained. Distinguishing the two is what "critically discuss" asks for.

4. Where constructions sit in Russell's programme **FACT:**

1. **Acquaintance** (Session 6) fixes what is directly available: sense-data, memory, introspection, universals.
2. **Incomplete symbols** (Session 5) supply the technique for eliminating apparent designators.
3. **Logical constructions** (this session) apply the technique to the entities of common sense and science, so that nothing unknown need be inferred.
4. **Logical atomism** (Session 8) names the residue: whatever analysis leaves standing when every construction has been removed.

ANALYSIS: The single sentence that connects them for a twenty-mark answer. "Incomplete symbols supply the scalpel, logical constructions are the operations performed with it, and logical atomism is the anatomy the surgeon expects to find - which is why Russell can be confident in the technique long before he is confident about the inventory."

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Logical constructions convert Ockham's razor from a slogan into a procedure, replacing inference to unknown entities with definition in terms of known ones. **Named evidence.** Russell's supreme maxim in scientific philosophising, stated in "The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics" and *Our Knowledge of the External World* (both 1914), is "wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities"; the worked cases run from physical objects, built from classes of actual and possible sense-data, to nations built from patterns of individual behaviour, numbers as classes of equinumerous classes, and points of space as convergent classes of volumes. **Analysis.** The device is the contextual definition already used for incomplete symbols, transferred from pseudo-constituents of propositions to pseudo-positives of ontology, so that ordinary sentences retain their truth while the theory retains only base items; the spread of examples across perception, society, mathematics and geometry shows that the maxim is a general method rather than a repair to one problem. **Qualification.** The construction of physical objects requires unrealised "possible" sense-data, which reintroduces something not straightforwardly known, and Russell's own base shifted from sense-data to neutral events in his later work - so the durable claim is for the technique of construction, not for the 1914 phenomenalist inventory it was first used to build.

Exam link

- **2024 Q3(a)** and **2018 Q4(c)** both need this session as the middle term: incomplete symbols -> constructions -> atomism is the route the questions ask you to trace.
- **2022 Q1(b)** ("Russell's method of logical analysis") should give the maxim verbatim; it is the clearest single statement of the method.
- **2018 Q3(a)** (Empiricism-owned): Russell's reply to Berkeley is exactly this - accept that we are given appearances, and then *construct* rather than *deny* the physical world.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Logical constructions = fictions"	We say true things about tables and nations; what is denied is an additional entity, not the truth of the sentences
Merging constructions with later neutral monism	1914 constructions and later neutral monism are different phases; say which you are describing
Giving only the table example	Give a second of a different type - nation, number or point - to show the maxim is general
Treating constructions and atoms as the same	Constructions are removed by analysis; atoms are what analysis is looking for
Omitting the "possible sense-data" strain	It is the standard objection and the easiest assessment mark in the session

Revision notes

- Supreme maxim (1914): "wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities".
- Sources: "The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics"; *Our Knowledge of the External World*.
- Examples: physical object <- classes of actual and possible sense-data · nation <- patterns of individual behaviour · number <- classes of equinumerous classes · point <- convergent classes of volumes.
- Device: contextual definition - the same technique as incomplete symbols, applied to ontology rather than to propositional constituents.
- Atoms vs constructions: atoms are the sought residue; constructions add no entity and are contextually defined.
- WRONG: Not fictions · WRONG: not an elimination of ordinary talk · ANALYSIS: not a permanent phenomenalist metaphysics.
- Strain: possible sense-data; solipsism worry; base later abandoned for neutral events. Verdict: technique permanent, 1914 inventory not.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS

PROBLEM: I meet appearances; I talk about TABLES, NATIONS, NUMBERS, POINTS
|
v
TWO ROUTES: INFER an unknown entity | BUILD from known entities
|
v
SUPREME MAXIM IN SCIENTIFIC PHILOSOPHISING (1914)
"Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities
for inferences to unknown entities."
|
v
DEVICE: CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION - the incomplete-symbol technique applied
to ONTOLOGY instead of to propositional constituents
|
v
WORKED CASES: table <- classes of actual + possible sense-data |
nation <- patterns of individual behaviour | number <- classes of
equinumerous classes | point <- convergent classes of volumes
|
v
CONSTRUCTIONS (derived, no new entity) vs ATOMS (sought residue)
|
v
STRAIN: "possible" sense-data are not straightforwardly KNOWN;
solipsism worry; the base later becomes NEUTRAL EVENTS
|
v
VERDICT: the TECHNIQUE is permanent; the 1914 PHENOMENALIST INVENTORY
is a phase
ANSWER LINE: build it out of what you have before you posit what you
cannot meet

SESSION 8 - RUSSELL'S LOGICAL ATOMISM: ATOMIC FACTS, TRUTH-FUNCTIONS, ISOMORPHISM AND NEGATIVE FACTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Russell thinks the world is made of *facts*, not of things - and that complicated facts are built out of simple ones. A simple, or atomic, fact is one particular thing having a quality, or a few particular things standing in a relation. Language mirrors this: an atomic sentence states one atomic fact, and every more complicated sentence is built out of atomic ones with "and", "or", "not" and "if". The job of philosophy is to take complicated sentences apart until you reach the simple ones, and thereby to see what the world must contain.

Technical definition: Logical atomism ("The Philosophy of Logical Atomism", lectures 1918, published in *The Monist* 1918-19) is the doctrine that (i) the world consists of **facts**; (ii) an **atomic fact** contains no other facts as constituents - a particular exemplifies a quality, or several particulars stand in a relation - and may therefore contain particulars and universals without being a microscopic or constituent-less object; (iii) an **atomic proposition** states such a fact, and **molecular propositions** are built from atomic ones by truth-functional operations, so that their truth-values are wholly determined by the truth-values of the atoms and the connectives; and (iv) a true proposition and the fact it states share the same structure - the **isomorphism thesis**. ANALYSIS: Russell reluctantly admits **negative facts** as truth-makers for true negative propositions, and treats the admission as a cost.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Russell's own gloss on his title is the whole doctrine and the whole defence at once: "the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are **logical** atoms and not physical atoms" - atomism here is a claim about where analysis stops, not a claim about how small things are.

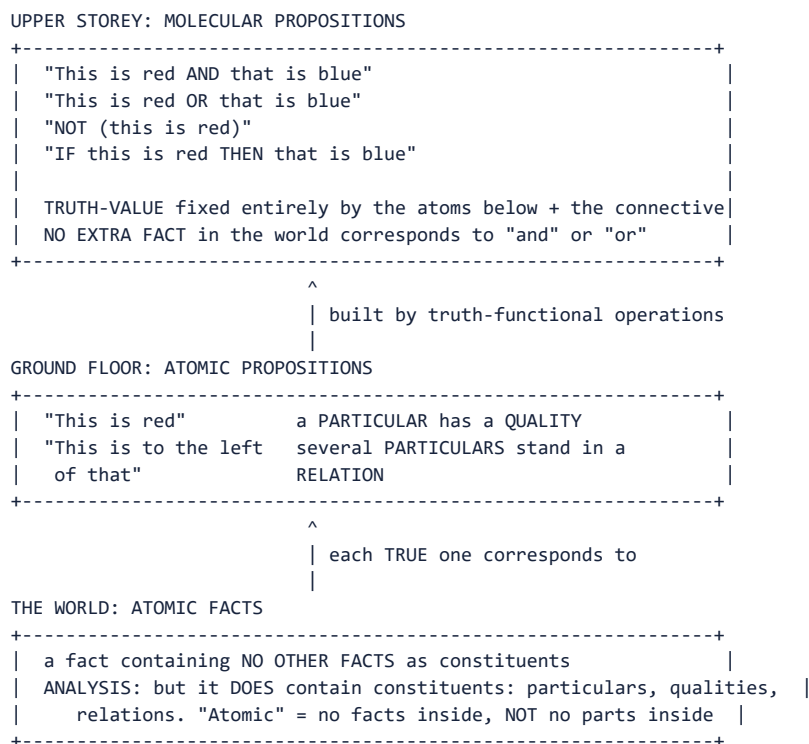
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **fact** - what makes a proposition true or false; ANALYSIS: facts are not themselves true or false
- **atomic fact** - contains no other facts as constituents; particular + quality, or particulars + relation
- **atomic and molecular propositions** - the linguistic counterparts
- **truth-functionality** - no fact corresponds to "and" or "or"

- **isomorphism** - same logical structure in the true proposition and the fact
- **logical, not physical, atoms ANALYSIS**: - the 2020 quotation, and the trap it is set to catch
- **negative facts ANALYSIS**: - admitted as a truth-making cost, and contested

How to use them: in the 2020 question the quotation *is* the thesis; start by unpacking "last residue in analysis" and "logical, not physical", then give the structure of an atomic fact, then the molecular layer, then the negative-fact cost.

Plain-language visual - the two-storey building



In simple words: think of a building with two floors. On the ground floor are the simplest statements - one thing being some way, or a few things standing in some relation to each other. Everything on the upper floor is made by joining ground-floor statements with logical words. Because of that, once you know which ground-floor statements are true, you automatically know which upper-floor ones are. And crucially, the logical words themselves do not name anything: there is no object in the world called "and".

Remember first	Meaning
The world is facts , not things	a list of objects is not a description of the world
Facts are truth-makers , not truth-bearers	ANALYSIS: a fact is not true; a proposition is
"Atomic" means no facts inside	not "no parts", and certainly not "microscopically small"
Molecular truth is determined	truth-functionality; connectives name nothing
Negative facts are a cost	admitted reluctantly, and contested

One-line memory: logical atoms are where analysis stops, not where the microscope stops.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the doctrine, the 2020 sentence and the negative-fact problem

THE 2020 QUOTATION, DECODED CLAUSE BY CLAUSE

"The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms."

```
+-----+
| "last residue in analysis" -> atomism is defined by a METHOD: |
|                               what survives when analysis has |
|                               removed every complexity        |
| "logical ... not physical"  -> the atoms are constituents of  |
|                               FACTS - particulars, qualities,  |
|                               relations - not tiny bodies     |
| "the doctrine"              -> hence an ONTOLOGY read off a  |
|                               LOGIC, not a physics             |
+-----+
```

THE STRUCTURE OF AN ATOMIC FACT

```
+-----+
| MONADIC          | a PARTICULAR exemplifies a QUALITY      |
|                  | "this is red"                            |
+-----+
| RELATIONAL       | PARTICULARS stand in a RELATION          |
|                  | "this is to the left of that"            |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: "Atomic" = CONTAINS NO OTHER FACTS. It plainly contains constituents. The commonest error is to read "atomic" as "simple in every sense".

THE ISOMORPHISM THESIS

```
+-----+
| PROPOSITION  name1  ---- relation-word ----  name2          |
|              |      |      |                  |              |
|              v      v      v                  |              |
| FACT         object1 ----- relation ----- object2        |
| SAME LOGICAL STRUCTURE. Names correspond to objects; the    |
| ARRANGEMENT of names corresponds to the ARRANGEMENT of      |
| objects.                                                |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: This is the BRIDGE between language and world in Russell's atomism - and it is the point of nearest approach to the Tractatus, which is why the two atomisms are so often merged.

THE NEGATIVE-FACT PROBLEM

```
+-----+
| "Socrates is not alive" is TRUE. What makes it true?        |
| OPTION 1  a NEGATIVE FACT - that a positive state does not  |
|           obtain. RUSSELL RELUCTANTLY ACCEPTS THIS.         |
| COST      absences are added to the inventory of the world; |
|           many philosophers find this intolerable           |
| WHY HE PAYS IT to preserve a DIRECT truth-making relation: |
|           every truth is made true by something             |
+-----+
| WITTGENSTEIN'S DIFFERENT ROUTE                               |
| obtaining elementary states constitute the world, and their |
| TOTALITY also determines which possible states do NOT obtain |
| (2.05). Negation is not a further object and the logical     |
| constants are not representatives (4.0312).                  |
| -> NO negative facts are required.                            |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The bottom two boxes are the sharpest available contrast between the two atomisms, and they are worth writing out whenever a question invites comparison: the same problem, two different solutions, and one of them costs an ontological category.

1. Facts, and why the world is not a list of things FACT:

- FACT: A **fact** is what makes a proposition true or false. Russell is explicit that facts are **not themselves true or false**: truth and falsity belong to propositions, and facts are what they answer to.
- FACT: Hence the world cannot be described by a **list of objects**. Give me a complete catalogue of every object there is and I still do not know how things stand - which of them have which qualities, and how they are related. Only facts settle that.

- ANALYSIS: **The point of contact with the Tractatus.** "The world is the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1) makes the same move. WRONG: But do not therefore write that Russell and Wittgenstein held one doctrine: they agree that the world is factual and disagree about what the constituents of facts are and how we know them.

2. Atomic and molecular, and what truth-functionality buys FACT:

Level	Character	Example	What settles its truth
Atomic FACT:	asserts one fact about one or more simples; no logical connectives	"This is red"	whether the corresponding atomic fact obtains
Molecular FACT:	built from atomic propositions with <i>and</i> , <i>or</i> , <i>not</i> , <i>if-then</i>	"This is red and that is blue"	wholly determined by the truth-values of the atoms plus the connective

- FACT: **The pay-off.** If truth-functionality holds, the connectives need no ontological counterparts: there is no conjunctive fact in addition to the two conjuncts' facts. ANALYSIS: This is a large economy, and it is why "no extra facts correspond to *and* or *or*" is worth a sentence in the answer.
- ANALYSIS: **The exposed assumption.** The programme requires that **every** proposition be a truth-function of atomic ones. Belief-contexts ("George IV believes that...") and modal contexts resist this, and Russell knows it. Concede the difficulty rather than pretending the reduction is complete.

3. Atomism and the theory of descriptions - how far the support actually goes FACT:

This is the exact question of **2018 Q4(c)** and **2024 Q3(a)**, and the discrimination is where the marks are.

- FACT: **What descriptions do supply.** Contextual analysis removes **merely apparent constituents** - "the F" is shown not to be a constituent at all - and leaves quantified structure plus genuine logical constituents. That is precisely the kind of result the atomist wants: an analysis that separates real residues from grammatical illusions.
- FACT: **The methodological continuity.** Both doctrines rest on "grammatical form is not logical form"; descriptions are the demonstration that the principle has teeth, and atomism is the ontology one reaches by applying it systematically.
- ANALYSIS: **What descriptions do not supply.** They do **not** prove that analysis **terminates**; they do not **identify** the simples; and they do not show that reality is **exhaustively** atomic. Removing one class of pseudo-constituents is not the same as reaching a base.
- ANALYSIS: **The verdict sentence.** "The theory of descriptions makes logical atomism *reasonable* and does not make it *proved*: it shows how a residue is reached in a particular case, and leaves open whether every analysis reaches one."

4. Criticisms, replies and the honest position CAUTION:

Objection	Russell's position	Residual
What <i>are</i> the simples? Sense-data? Only "this" and "that" qualify as logically proper names, which is extremely restrictive FACT:	He accepts the restriction openly; the base is what analysis would reach, not something he claims to have catalogued	ANALYSIS: The inventory was never fixed, and Russell's own candidates changed
Negative facts inflate the ontology with absences ANALYSIS:	Accepted as a cost of preserving a direct truth-making relation	CAUTION: Contested; Wittgenstein's totality account avoids the cost
Atomism is a <i>metaphysics read off a notation</i> - it assumes the world matches a particular logical symbolism CAUTION:	Russell's reply is that the notation is not arbitrary but the form any adequate analysis must take	CAUTION: This is the deepest objection and the one that later drives Quine's and Strawson's criticisms
Not every proposition is a truth-function of atomic ones (belief, modality) ANALYSIS:	Acknowledged as an unresolved difficulty	ANALYSIS: The same pressure recurs against the <i>Tractatus</i> at 5 and 5.54

- ANALYSIS: **The exam-safe closing position.** Russell's atomism should be assessed as a **programme** rather than as a completed system: the method of analysis is a permanent contribution, the ontological claim that analysis terminates in a fixed base was never established, and the negative-fact concession shows Russell himself paying visible costs rather than concealing them.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Logical atomism is an ontology defined by a method: its atoms are whatever survives complete analysis, which is why Russell insists they are logical and not physical. **Named evidence.** In the 1918 lectures Russell writes that "the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms"; an atomic fact contains no other facts as constituents - a particular exemplifying a quality, or particulars in a relation - while molecular propositions are truth-functions of atomic ones, so that no fact corresponds to "and" or "or"; and a true proposition shares the logical structure of the fact it states. **Analysis.** The theory of descriptions supports this programme by removing apparent constituents and leaving quantified structure plus genuine residues, and the truth-functional layer supplies a large economy by denying ontological counterparts to the connectives; together they make the atomist expectation reasonable. **Qualification.** The support falls short of proof - descriptions do not show that analysis terminates, identify the simples, or establish that reality is exhaustively atomic - and Russell's reluctant admission of negative facts as truth-makers for true negations, together with the resistance of belief and modal contexts to truth-functional treatment, shows the programme carrying acknowledged costs rather than closing.

Exam link

- **2020 Q2(c)** prints the "logical atoms and not physical atoms" sentence and asks for the nature of atomic facts in its light: Section 0's decoding table and Section 1-Section 2 are the answer; the negative-fact box supplies the critical close.
- **2022 Q1(b)** asks how the method of logical analysis "ultimately ends in establishing atomic theory of meaning": Sessions 5, 7 and this one in that order, with Section 3's qualification as the verdict.
- **2018 Q4(c)** and **2024 Q3(a)** are both answered by Section 3 - and both are lost by a script that claims descriptions *prove* atomism.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Atomic facts are very small physical facts"	ANALYSIS: The 2020 quotation exists to block exactly this. Atoms are logical residues
"Atomic means without constituents"	It means containing no other facts . Particulars, qualities and relations are constituents
"Facts are true"	Facts are truth- makers ; propositions are truth- bearers
"Descriptions prove atomism"	They support it by removing pseudo-constituents; they do not show that analysis terminates
Merging Russell's atoms with Tractarian objects	Russell's are epistemically identified in this phase; Wittgenstein's are postulated by conditions of sense and never exemplified
Omitting negative facts	It is the point where Russell visibly pays a price, and the easiest assessment mark in the session

Revision notes

- 1918 lectures, published *The Monist* 1918-19; Russell's preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein.
- World = facts. Facts are truth-makers, not truth-bearers. A list of objects does not describe the world.
- Atomic fact: no other facts as constituents; particular + quality, or particulars + relation.
- Atomic / molecular propositions; truth-functionality; no fact answers to "and" or "or".
- Isomorphism: true proposition and fact share logical structure; names <-> objects, arrangement <-> arrangement.
- 2020 sentence: "last residue in analysis"; logical, not physical.
- Negative facts: accepted reluctantly to preserve direct truth-making; contested. Wittgenstein's totality account (2.05, 4.0312) avoids them.
- Descriptions support but do not prove: no proof of termination, no identification of simples, no exhaustive atomism.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOGICAL ATOMISM

1918 "THE PHILOSOPHY OF LOGICAL ATOMISM" (preface credits Wittgenstein)

|

v

WORLD = FACTS, not things. FACTS are TRUTH-MAKERS, not truth-bearers

|

v

ATOMIC FACT = contains NO OTHER FACTS

monadic: particular + quality | relational: particulars + relation

ANALYSIS: it DOES have constituents; "atomic" is not "partless"

|

v

ATOMIC PROPOSITION <-> atomic fact

MOLECULAR PROPOSITION = TRUTH-FUNCTION of atomic ones

-> NO fact corresponds to "and" or "or"

|

v

ISOMORPHISM: same logical structure in true proposition and fact

|

v

2020 SENTENCE: "last residue in ANALYSIS ... LOGICAL atoms and NOT PHYSICAL atoms"

|

v

DESCRIPTIONS -> remove pseudo-constituents -> SUPPORT the atomist search

BUT do NOT prove termination | identify simples | establish exhaustive atomism

|

v

COST: NEGATIVE FACTS accepted reluctantly to keep direct truth-making

WITTGENSTEIN'S ROUTE: totality of obtaining states settles the rest; logical constants are not representatives (4.0312)

|

v

VERDICT: assess as a PROGRAMME - permanent method, unfixed inventory, visible costs

ANSWER LINE: logical atoms are where analysis stops, not where the microscope stops

SESSION 9 - THE TRACTATUS: FACTS, OBJECTS, STATES OF AFFAIRS AND THE PICTURE THEORY OF MEANING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Wittgenstein starts not from things but from *how things stand*. The world, he says, is the totality of facts, not of things. A proposition is meaningful because it works like a picture: its parts stand for objects, and the way its parts are arranged says that the objects are arranged that way too. If they are, the proposition is true; if they are not, it is false. Either way it has *sense*, because it presents a possible situation.

Technical definition: In the *Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus* (German text 1921; bilingual edition 1922), FACT: "*The world is the totality of facts, not of things*" (1.1). A **state of affairs (Sachverhalt)** is a possible combination of **objects**; the obtaining of states of affairs constitutes the facts that make up the world. A proposition is a **logical picture (Bild)** of a possible state of affairs: its elements correspond to objects, and its structure **depicts (abbildet)** a possible arrangement of them. **Pictorial form (Form der Abbildung)** is what a picture must share with reality in order to depict it in its particular medium; **logical form (logische Form)** is the form every picture of any medium must share with reality, and is therefore the form of all possible representation. ANALYSIS: Logical form is not itself a depictable fact: it **shows** itself in every meaningful proposition and cannot be **said**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The picture theory is not the observation that language resembles what it describes but the far stronger claim that resemblance of *content* is irrelevant and only shared *logical form* matters - which is why the theory ends by discovering something no proposition can ever state.

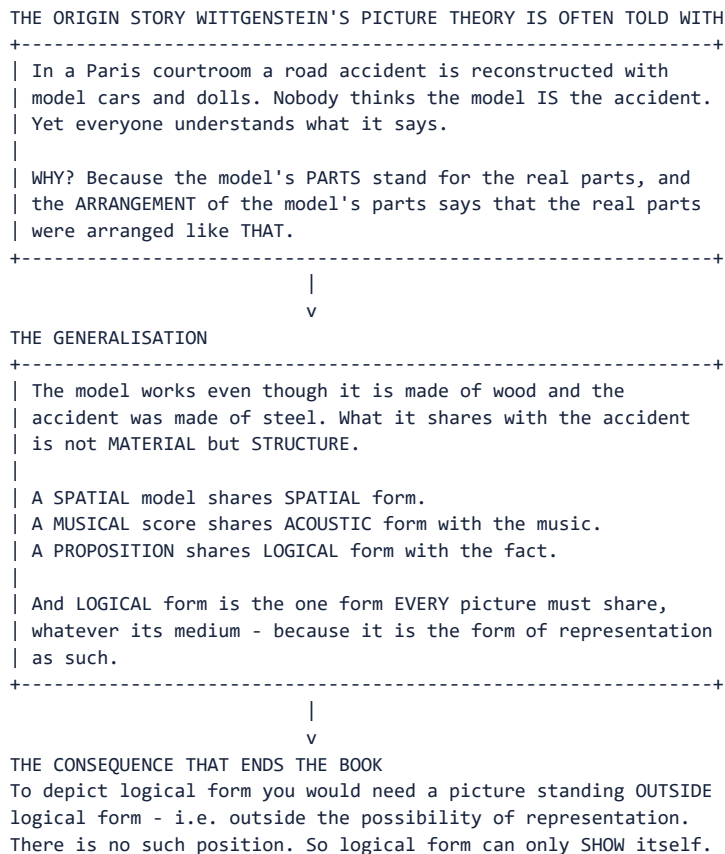
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- the world is the totality of facts, not of things - 1.1, safe verbatim in both translations

- **state of affairs (Sachverhalt) ANALYSIS**: - flag the Ogden "atomic fact" against Pears-McGuinness "state of affairs"
- **object** - a logical simple, characterised by its **possibilities of combination**, never exemplified
- **logical picture (Bild), to depict (abbilden)** - the *Bild* vocabulary; "picture theory" is the commentators' label
- **pictorial form (Form der Abbildung)** against **logical form (logische Form)** - the 2022 question in five words
- **projective relation** - the method of projection that makes a propositional sign into a proposition
- **shown, not said** - the closing move of the session, developed fully in Session 11

How to use them: 2022 Q3(c) asks a two-part question - is there a difference between pictorial and logical form, and how does logical form define the relation between language and reality? Answer the first with a contrast, the second with the *universality* of logical form, and close on showing.

Plain-language visual - the model in the courtroom



In simple words: a picture works by *sharing something* with what it pictures. A map of Delhi shares spatial arrangement with Delhi; a musical score shares a structure with the sound. Every picture, whatever it is made of, must share at least *logical* structure with what it shows - otherwise it could not represent it at all. And that is why we can never draw a picture of logical structure: any picture we drew would already have to use it.

Remember first	Meaning
Facts, not things	1.1; a catalogue of objects is not a description of the world
Objects are simples	characterised by combinatorial possibility; ANALYSIS: never exemplified in the text
A proposition depicts	its structure presents a possible arrangement of objects
Pictorial form is medium-specific	logical form is universal
Truth is comparison	"to tell whether a picture is true or false we must compare it with reality" (2.223)

One-line memory: the picture shares structure, not stuff - and the deepest structure it shares can never itself be pictured.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the ontology, the picturing relation, and the two forms

THE ONTOLOGY OF THE OPENING PROPOSITIONS

```
+-----+
| 1      The world is all that is the case.      |
| 1.1    The world is the totality of FACTS, not of THINGS. |
| 1.13   The facts in LOGICAL SPACE are the world. |
| 2      What is the case, a fact, is the existence of STATES OF |
|         AFFAIRS. |
| 2.01   A state of affairs is a combination of OBJECTS. |
| 2.013  Each thing is, as it were, in a SPACE of possible states |
|         of affairs. Possibility is built INTO the object. |
| 2.06   The existence and non-existence of states of affairs is |
|         reality. |
+-----+
```

TRANSLATION CONTROL ANALYSIS:
 Sachverhalt = "atomic fact" (Ogden/Ramsey) = "state of affairs"
 (Pears-McGuinness). CHOOSE ONE AND STAY WITH IT. And do NOT equate
 Tractarian objects with Russell's epistemically identified atoms.

THE PICTURING RELATION - three requirements

```
+-----+
| (i)    ELEMENTS of the picture (names) correspond to OBJECTS. |
| (ii)   The ARRANGEMENT of the elements depicts an arrangement |
|         of the objects. |
| (iii)  A METHOD OF PROJECTION connects sign to situation - the |
|         propositional SIGN plus its projective relation to the |
|         world is the PROPOSITION (3.11-3.12). |
+-----+
| TRUE  if the depicted state of affairs obtains |
| FALSE if it does not |
| EITHER WAY MEANINGFUL, because it depicts a POSSIBLE |
| arrangement (2.201-2.203, 2.221-2.224) |
+-----+
```

THE TWO FORMS - the 2022 question, in a table

PICTORIAL FORM (Form der Abbildung)	LOGICAL FORM (logische Form)
what a picture must share with reality to depict it AT ALL, in its own medium	the MOST ABSTRACT structural commonality - what EVERY picture, in ANY medium, must share with reality
a spatial model shares SPATIAL form; a score shares ACOUSTIC form	every meaningful proposition shares LOGICAL form with the fact it depicts
a picture can depict only what shares ITS form	a proposition can depict ANY fact whatever, because logical form is the UNIVERSAL medium

RELATION: logical form is the form pictorial forms have in common.
 Every picture is a LOGICAL picture (2.182); not every picture is a
 spatial or a musical one.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

```
+-----+
| Logical form is NOT itself a fact that can be depicted. Any |
| depiction of it would already presuppose it. It therefore |
| SHOWS itself in every meaningful proposition and cannot be |
| SAID (4.12, 4.121, 4.1212). -> SESSION 11 |
+-----+
```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The 2022 paper asks precisely for the middle table plus the bottom box. A script that gives only
 "a proposition pictures a fact" has answered neither half of the question.

1. Why the world is facts and not things FACT:

- FACT: **The argument.** A complete inventory of objects leaves everything undecided: it does not tell you which qualities they have or how they are related. What is the case is a matter of **configuration**, and a configuration is a fact. Hence 1.1.
- FACT: **Objects and their possibilities.** An object is characterised not by an intrinsic description but by the **states of affairs into which it can enter** (2.0121, 2.013). Possibility is written into the object; the space of possible configurations is fixed once the objects are fixed.
- ANALYSIS: **The honest gap.** Wittgenstein gives **no uncontested example** of a simple object or an elementary proposition. The text argues that simples are *required* - determinate sense demands a final base - rather than exhibiting them. ANALYSIS: Say this explicitly; it is a standing criticism, and pre-empting it earns the assessment mark.
- ANALYSIS: **The contrast with Russell.** Russell's atoms are identified epistemically, through acquaintance, in the 1918 phase. Wittgenstein's objects are postulated by a **condition-of-sense argument** and are never identified. Two atomisms, one word.

2. What "picture" does and does not mean FACT:

- FACT: **It is a technical notion.** A picture is anything that shares form with what it represents and whose elements are correlated with elements of the represented situation. Resemblance in the everyday sense is **irrelevant**; a musical score does not look like music.
- FACT: **The propositional sign and the method of projection.** A written or spoken sentence is a **propositional sign** - a fact in its own right, since its elements stand in a determinate relation. The sign together with its **projective relation** to the world is the **proposition** (3.11-3.12). Meaning is not a mental accompaniment; it is a projection.
- ANALYSIS: **Provenance discipline.** The label "picture theory" is the **commentators'**. Wittgenstein writes of *Bild* - picture or model - and of *abbilden*, to depict. Write "the doctrine usually called the picture theory" once, and the provenance mark is secured.
- ANALYSIS: **What the theory explains that a name-theory cannot.** How a sentence can be understood before you know whether it is true. On a naming model, an understood sentence would need an existing object to correspond to it; on the picturing model it needs only a **possible** configuration. That is why falsity is not a failure of meaning.

3. Pictorial form against logical form - the discrimination the 2022 paper wants FACT:

Question	Pictorial form	Logical form
What is it?	what a picture must have in common with reality to depict it at all in its medium	the most abstract structural commonality - what every picture shares with reality
Example	a spatial model shares spatial form; a score shares acoustic form	every proposition shares logical form with the fact it depicts
Reach	limited to what shares that medium's form	unlimited: a proposition can depict any fact whatever
Status	a feature of a kind of picture	the form of all possible representation
Can it be depicted?	FACT: a spatial form can be represented in another medium	ANALYSIS: no - any depiction would presuppose it

- FACT: **The second half of the question - how logical form defines the relation between language and reality.** Because logical form is common to proposition and fact, language and world are not two realms needing a bridge: they already share the structure that makes depiction possible. FACT: **2.18**: what a picture must have in common with reality in order to depict it at all is logical form. The relation is therefore **internal** - constitutive of the proposition - not an external correlation set up by convention or by causal contact.
- ANALYSIS: **And the price.** An internal relation cannot be described from outside. That is the transition to Session 11: the very thing that explains meaning turns out to be unsayable.

4. What the picture theory rules out - stated before Session 10 develops it FACT:

1. A proposition that depicts **no possible situation** is not false; it is **nonsensical (unsinnig)**.
2. A "proposition" that could not be false depicts no situation either; tautologies and contradictions are **senseless (sinnlos)** - well-formed but empty. (Session 10.)
3. Statements about the **relation between language and reality** attempt to depict the depicting relation itself, and fail. (Session 11.)
4. ANALYSIS: **None of this is the verification principle.** The *Tractatus* asks whether a proposition depicts a **possible fact**, not whether it can be **empirically checked**. The Vienna Circle's criterion is a later transformation of these resources and belongs to Topic 07.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The picture theory grounds meaning in shared structure rather than in reference or resemblance, and in doing so it makes falsity a normal case rather than a defect. **Named evidence.** The *Tractatus* opens by declaring that "the world is the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1) and that a fact is the existence of states of affairs, each a combination of objects (2, 2.01); a proposition is a logical picture whose elements are correlated with objects and whose arrangement depicts a possible arrangement of them, so that "in order to tell whether a picture is true or false we must compare it with reality" (2.223) and "it is impossible to tell from the picture alone whether it is true or false" (2.224). **Analysis.** Because what the picture shares with reality is form and not material, the theory explains how a sentence can be fully understood before its truth-value is known: understanding requires only that a possible configuration be presented, which is why *pictorial* form varies with the medium while *logical* form, being the form of representation as such, is shared by every picture and every fact. **Qualification.** The account is bought at the cost of two commitments the text never discharges - it supplies no uncontested example of a simple object or an elementary proposition, and it makes logical form itself indescribable, since any picture of it would already have to employ it - so the picture theory succeeds as an account of sense precisely by generating the say/show problem it ends with.

Exam link

- **2022 Q3(c)** is this session end to end: the pictorial/logical contrast table, then the "how logical form defines the relation" answer in Section 3, then one closing sentence on showing.
- **2018 Q3(c)** and **2021 Q4(c)** both need Section 2 and Section 3 as the *derivation* of the say/show distinction; without it, Session 11 reads as assertion.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (Later-Wittgenstein-owned) asks about the transition from the early to the later view; this session supplies the "from" - and the boundary note in Section 4.4 keeps the answer honest.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Language is a picture of the world" without qualification	ANALYSIS: It is a logical picture; shared form , not resemblance. The unqualified sentence is a marked error
Treating <i>Sachverhalt</i> inconsistently	Ogden: "atomic fact"; Pears-McGuinness: "state of affairs". Choose one and say which
Identifying Tractarian objects with Russell's sense-data	Wittgenstein's objects are postulated by conditions of sense and never exemplified
Conflating pictorial and logical form	Pictorial form is medium-specific; logical form is the form of all representation
Reading the theory as verificationism	It asks about depicting a possible situation, not about empirical checkability. Topic 07 owns the criterion
Dating the English text 1921	German 1921; bilingual English-German 1922, with the Latin title suggested by Moore

Revision notes

- 1.1 "The world is the totality of facts, not of things"; 1.13 facts in logical space; 2 facts are the existence of states of affairs; 2.01 a state of affairs is a combination of objects; 2.013 possibility is built into the object.

- *Sachverhalt* ANALYSIS: Ogden "atomic fact" / Pears-McGuinness "state of affairs".
- Proposition = propositional sign + projective relation (3.11-3.12); elements $\leftrightarrow$ objects; arrangement depicts arrangement.
- True if the state of affairs obtains, false if not, meaningful either way (2.201-2.224).
- Pictorial form: medium-specific. Logical form: universal, the form of all representation (2.18); every picture is a logical picture (2.182).
- Logical form is shown, not said $\rightarrow$ Session 11.
- ANALYSIS: No uncontested example of a simple object; the base is argued for, not exhibited.
- ANALYSIS: "Picture theory" is the commentators' label; Wittgenstein writes *Bild* and *abbilden*.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE PICTURE THEORY

1.1 THE WORLD IS THE TOTALITY OF FACTS, NOT OF THINGS

|
 v
 FACT = existence of STATES OF AFFAIRS (Sachverhalte) = combinations of
 OBJECTS. Possibility is built INTO the object (2.013)
 ANALYSIS: objects are never exemplified - argued for, not exhibited
 |
 v
 PROPOSITION = propositional SIGN + PROJECTIVE RELATION (3.11-3.12)
 elements $\leftrightarrow$ objects | arrangement depicts arrangement
 |
 v
 TRUE if the state of affairs obtains | FALSE if not | MEANINGFUL either
 way, because a POSSIBLE arrangement is presented (2.221-2.224)
 |
 v
 PICTORIAL FORM (medium-specific: spatial, acoustic)
 vs
 LOGICAL FORM (universal - the form of ALL representation, 2.18)
 every picture is a LOGICAL picture (2.182)
 |
 v
 HOW LOGICAL FORM DEFINES THE LANGUAGE-WORLD RELATION: it is COMMON to
 both, so the relation is INTERNAL, not an external convention
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE: logical form cannot itself be DEPICTED - any depiction
 presupposes it $\rightarrow$ IT SHOWS ITSELF (4.12-4.1212) $\rightarrow$ SESSION 11
 |
 v
 NOT VERIFICATIONISM: possible depiction, not empirical checkability
 ANSWER LINE: the picture shares structure, not stuff

SESSION 10 - BIPOLARITY, LOGICAL SPACE, THE GENERAL FORM OF THE PROPOSITION, AND THE TWO WAYS OF FAILING TO SAY ANYTHING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: For a sentence to say something, it has to be able to be true *and* able to be false. If it could not possibly be false, it is not telling you how things are - it is just spinning. Wittgenstein turns this into a whole system: every proposition marks out a place in the total space of possibilities, and every proposition whatever can be generated from a base of simplest propositions by one repeated logical operation. Sentences that fail this test fail in two different ways, and the difference between the two failures is examinable.

Technical definition: **Bipolarity** is the condition of sense: a proposition has **sense (Sinn)** only if it is capable of being true *and* capable of being false. **Logical space (logischer Raum)** is the totality of possible configurations; a proposition "determines a place in logical space" (3.4), so that understanding *p* is understanding what it excludes. The **general form of the proposition (6)** is FACT: $[p, \xi, N(\xi)]$ - the rule generating every proposition from the totality of elementary propositions by repeated application of the **N-operator**, joint negation. Two failure modes follow: a **tautology** or **contradiction** is **senseless (sinnlos)** - well-formed, but saying nothing about the world; a metaphysical

pseudo-proposition is **nonsensical (unsinnig)** - it depicts no possible situation at all.

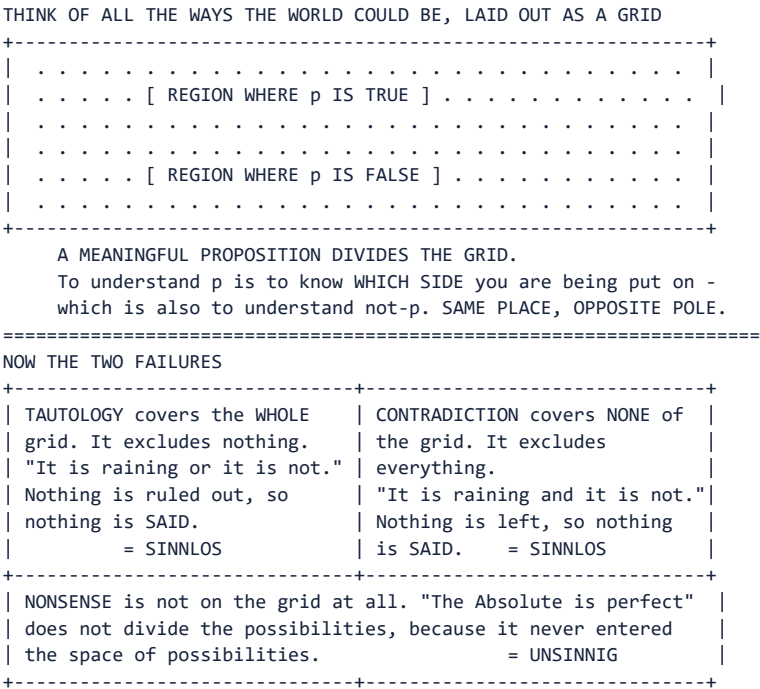
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgenstein's account of sense is a single condition worked out with unusual ruthlessness: a proposition says something only if the world could refute it - and once that is granted, logic's own truths turn out to say nothing, and metaphysics turns out not to be saying anything at all.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **bipolarity** - capable of truth **and** capable of falsity; ANALYSIS: stronger than bivalence
 - **sense (Sinn)** - what a proposition has when it presents a possible situation
 - **logical space (logischer Raum)** - the totality of possibilities; a proposition determines a **place** in it
 - **the fundamental idea (Grundgedanke)** - 4.0312, "the logical constants are not representatives"
 - **the general form of the proposition** - 6, and the informal 4.5, "this is how things stand"
 - **N-operator** - joint negation: none of these is true
 - **sinnlos against unsinnig** - the two failures; the single most tested discrimination in the *Tractatus*
- How to use them:** treat bipolarity, logical space and the general form as **one doctrine seen from three sides**, and say so. That framing alone lifts an answer, because most scripts present them as three unrelated pieces of machinery.

Plain-language visual - the map with every possible route



In simple words: a claim earns its keep by ruling something out. "It will rain tomorrow" rules out a dry tomorrow - that is what makes it informative. "It will either rain or not rain" rules out nothing at all, so although it is perfectly well-formed and certainly true, it tells you nothing. And a sentence like "the Absolute is perfect" does not even manage to rule nothing out; it never got into the business of ruling things in or out, because it does not describe any possible arrangement of anything.

Remember first	Meaning
Bipolarity is not bivalence	bivalence: it has one of two values. Bipolarity: it must be able to have either
A proposition excludes	to understand <i>p</i> is to understand $\neg p$
Logic's truths say nothing	tautologies are <i>sinnlos</i> , not <i>unsinnig</i>
Metaphysics is a different failure	<i>unsinnig</i> : no possible situation depicted

Remember first	Meaning
One operation generates everything	N, joint negation, applied repeatedly
One-line memory: if the world could not refute it, it did not tell you anything.	

VISUAL: VISUAL - the three sides of one doctrine

SIDE 1 BIPOLARITY - the CONDITION of sense

A proposition has SENSE only if it CAN be true and CAN be false.
ANCHORS 4.06 "A proposition can be true or false only by being a picture of reality"; 2.223 "to tell whether a picture is true or false we must compare it with reality"; 2.224 "it is impossible to tell from the picture alone whether it is true or false". The TERM comes from the Notes on Logic (1913).
WHY IT DOES SO MUCH WORK
1 to depict is to represent something AS being the case
2 to represent something as being the case is to allow that it might NOT be the case
3 so sense requires BOTH truth-values to be genuinely available

SIDE 2 LOGICAL SPACE - WHERE the possibilities live

ANCHORS 1.13 "the facts in logical space are the world";
2.11 "a picture presents a situation in logical space";
3.4 "a proposition determines a place in logical space";
3.41 "the propositional sign and the logical co-ordinates: that is the logical place"; 3.42 the existence of the logical place is guaranteed by the mere existence of the constituent parts.
ANALOGY logical space is to propositions what a COORDINATE SYSTEM is to points: to specify a point you need the whole grid, not just the point.
WITTGENSTEIN'S OWN IMAGE 4.463 a proposition "is like a solid body that restricts the freedom of movement of others" - a proposition is a LIMIT on how the world may be.
CONSEQUENCES
sense is HOLISTIC: to understand p is to understand not-p
NEGATION IS NOT AN OBJECT: 4.0312 "my fundamental idea is that the 'logical constants' are not representatives"
THE WORLD IS DETERMINATE: 2.013, possibility is built into the object
LIMITS OF LANGUAGE = LIMITS OF THE WORLD: 5.6

SIDE 3 THE GENERAL FORM OF THE PROPOSITION - the RULE

(a) INFORMAL, 4.5: the general form of the proposition is "THIS IS HOW THINGS STAND" (Es verhaelt sich so und so). ANALYSIS: Ogden renders it "Such and such is the case". FLAG THE RENDERING.
(b) FORMAL, 6: [p , x , N(x)]
p (p-bar) the totality of ELEMENTARY propositions
x (xi-bar) any arbitrarily selected SET of propositions already formed
N(x) the result of applying the N-OPERATOR
THE N-OPERATOR (5.502, 5.51) = JOINT NEGATION: none of the selected propositions is true.
not-p = N(p)
p or q = N(N(p,q))
p and q = N(N(p), N(q))
Quantification is handled through sets of values of propositional functions (5.52); ANALYSIS: the adequacy of the notation for infinite or multiply general cases is DISPUTED.
WHAT PROPOSITION 6 ASSERTS
1 every proposition is a TRUTH-FUNCTION of elementary propositions (5)
2 every truth-function is producible by repeated application of ONE operation, N
3 so there is ONE general form, that of a FORMAL SERIES
4 so LOGIC NEEDS NO PRIMITIVE PROPOSITIONS AND NO LOGICAL OBJECTS - the decisive break with Russell and Frege
5 so "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251) and logic's propositions are TAUTOLOGIES (6.1)
6 so whatever cannot be produced by this rule is NOT A PROPOSITION -> the general form is the CRITERION OF THE SAYABLE

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Read the three boxes as one argument: bipolarity says what sense requires, logical space says what a sense-bearing proposition *does*, and the general form says how every such proposition is built. Point 6 of the last box is the bridge to Session 11.

1. The two failure modes, side by side FACT:

Term	Status	Example	Cognitive value
Tautology - senseless (<i>sinnlos</i>) FACT:	true under every truth-condition; says nothing about the world	"It is raining or it is not raining"	logically valid but factually empty; WRONG: not nonsensical
Contradiction - senseless (<i>sinnlos</i>) FACT:	false under every truth-condition	"It is raining and it is not raining"	a limiting case that says nothing
Metaphysical pseudo-proposition - nonsensical (<i>unsinnig</i>) FACT:	fails the conditions of factual sense altogether	"The Absolute is perfect"; "There are objects"	not a truth-functional picture of any possible fact

- FACT: **Why tautologies are not nonsense.** They are perfectly well-formed and belong to the symbolism; they are the **limiting cases** of proposition-formation and they **show** the scaffolding of logic (4.461-4.4611). Wittgenstein's account of logical truth is thus that logic has no subject matter of its own.
- ANALYSIS: **Why the distinction is examinable.** The *sinnlos/unsinnig* pair is the single most frequently mishandled item in *Tractatus* answers, and it is also the point where scripts wrongly import the verification principle: the Vienna Circle's criterion tests for empirical checkability, whereas Wittgenstein's test is whether a possible situation is depicted at all.

2. Elementary propositions and their independence - the assumption under pressure ANALYSIS:CAUTION:

FACT: **The commitment.** Elementary propositions consist of names in immediate combination and are **logically independent** of one another (2.061, 4.211): no elementary proposition follows from or excludes another, so every assignment of truth-values to them represents a possible configuration. This is stronger than ordinary bipolarity and it is what makes the truth-table method exhaustive.

CAUTION: **The colour-exclusion problem.** "This patch is red all over" and "This patch is blue all over" are incompatible, yet neither looks like a truth-function of the other, and neither looks further analysable. If both are elementary, independence fails; if neither is, the text owes an analysis it does not supply.

ANALYSIS: **How to state it safely.** The case **pressures** the independence assumption and helped drive Wittgenstein's 1929 "Some Remarks on Logical Form" - the only philosophical article besides the *Tractatus* published in his lifetime, and one whose proposed analysis he quickly abandoned. WRONG: It does **not** by itself prove that no deeper analysis could preserve independence, and WRONG: it must not be used as a licence to import meaning-as-use, which belongs to Topic 08.

3. The four standing presuppositions of the whole apparatus ANALYSIS:

1. **There are elementary propositions and simple objects** - although no uncontested example is given.
2. **Elementary propositions are logically independent** - which colour exclusion seriously pressures.
3. **All propositions are truth-functions of elementary ones** - while belief-contexts and modality create difficulties. (Wittgenstein's own treatment of "A believes that p" at 5.54-5.542 is itself contested.)
4. **The N-operator can handle infinite domains** - which remains disputed.

ANALYSIS: **Write them as pressures and later developments, not as refutations conceded inside the text.** The *Tractatus* does not admit these as failures; it is later work, including Wittgenstein's own, that treats them as such.

4. Why this session is the hinge of the whole Tractatus FACT:

- FACT: **Backwards:** bipolarity is the picture theory stated as a *condition* rather than as a *model*. A picture that could not be false would not be presenting a situation at all.
- FACT: **Forwards:** the general form is simultaneously the rule that generates every proposition and the **criterion of the sayable**. Whatever the rule cannot produce is not a proposition - and that is exactly the boundary the Preface describes when it says that the limit can be drawn only *in language*, and that what lies on the other side will simply be nonsense.

- ANALYSIS: **The self-application problem is therefore built in.** Propositions 5 and 6 are not themselves truth-functions of elementary propositions. Session 11 takes up what Wittgenstein does about that.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Bipolarity, logical space and the general form of the proposition are not three doctrines but one: an account of sense as a determinate exclusion within a fixed field of possibilities. **Named evidence.** The *Tractatus* holds that a proposition can be true or false only by being a picture of reality (4.06) and that one cannot tell from the picture alone which it is (2.224); that a proposition determines a place in logical space (3.4) and is "like a solid body that restricts the freedom of movement of others" (4.463); that the logical constants are not representatives - Wittgenstein's own *fundamental idea* (4.0312); and that the general form of the proposition is $[\bar{p}, \xi, N(\xi)]$ (6), generated by repeated joint negation (5.502, 5.51). **Analysis.** Together these yield the two failure modes that any *Tractatus* answer must keep apart: a tautology or contradiction is *sinnlos*, well-formed but excluding nothing or everything, and therefore showing logic's scaffolding rather than describing the world, while a metaphysical sentence is *unsinnig* because it never entered logical space at all; and because logic needs no primitive propositions or logical objects, "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251). **Qualification.** The apparatus rests on four undischarged commitments - that there are simple objects and elementary propositions, that the latter are logically independent, that every proposition is truth-functional, and that the N-operator handles infinite domains - and colour exclusion pressures the second so directly that Wittgenstein revisited it in 1929, which is why the system is best presented as a rigorous programme with identifiable strain points rather than as a completed proof.

Exam link

- **2022 Q3(c)** is completed by this session: after the pictorial/logical form contrast, bipolarity explains *why* a proposition must be able to be false, and that is what makes the picture an account of **sense**.
- **2021 Q4(c)** and **2018 Q3(c)** need Section 1's *sinnlos/unsinnig* table before the say/show distinction can be stated accurately.
- **2023 Q4(c)** and **2025 Q3(a)** (both Later-Wittgenstein-owned) ask about the transition; Section 2 supplies the *honest* version of the pressure without importing the later doctrine.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Sinnlos = unsinnig"	ANALYSIS: The single most tested discrimination here. Tautologies are empty but well-formed; metaphysical sentences depict nothing
Treating bipolarity as bivalence	Bivalence: it has one of two values. Bipolarity: it must be able to have either
"Logical constants stand for logical objects"	4.0312 denies exactly this, and calls the denial his fundamental idea
Writing the general form without explaining N	N is joint negation : none of the selected propositions is true. Show $\neg p$, v and $\&$ derived from it
Presenting colour exclusion as a proof of failure	It is a pressure that motivated revision; do not smuggle in meaning-as-use
Attributing verificationism to 6 or to 4.5	The criterion is depicting a possible situation, not empirical checkability

Revision notes

- Bipolarity: sense requires capability of truth **and** of falsity. Term from *Notes on Logic* (1913). Anchors 4.06, 2.223, 2.224.
- Logical space: 1.13, 2.11, 3.4, 3.41, 3.42; the coordinate-system analogy; 4.463 the proposition as a solid body restricting movement.
- *Grundgedanke* 4.0312: the logical constants are not representatives; negation names nothing.

- General form: informal 4.5 "this is how things stand" ANALYSIS: (Ogden: "such and such is the case"); formal 6 [p , ξ , $N(\xi)$]; N = joint negation (5.502, 5.51); quantification via sets of values (5.52) ANALYSIS: adequacy disputed.
- Consequences: every proposition a truth-function (5) · one operation · one general form · no primitive propositions or logical objects - the break with Russell and Frege · no surprises in logic (6.1251) · logic's propositions are tautologies (6.1) · the criterion of the sayable.
- *Sinnlos* (tautology, contradiction: well-formed, empty, shows logic's scaffolding, 4.461-4.4611) vs *unsinnig* (metaphysical pseudo-proposition).
- Four presuppositions: simples · independence of elementary propositions · universal truth-functionality (belief-contexts 5.54-5.542) · N over infinite domains. Colour exclusion (1929) pressures the second.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SENSE, SPACE AND THE GENERAL FORM

BIPOLARITY: sense requires CAN-BE-TRUE and CAN-BE-FALSE (4.06, 2.224)

- 1 depicting = representing AS being the case
- 2 which allows that it might NOT be the case
- 3 so BOTH truth-values must be available

|
v

LOGICAL SPACE: a proposition DETERMINES A PLACE (3.4); it EXCLUDES

- > to understand p is to understand not- p
- > 4.0312 GRUNDGEDANKE: logical constants are NOT representatives
- > 5.6 the limits of language are the limits of the world

|
v

GENERAL FORM (4.5 informal | 6 formal): [p , x , $N(x)$]

N = JOINT NEGATION: not- p = $N(p)$ | p or q = $N(N(p,q))$ |

p and q = $N(N(p),N(q))$

- > one operation | no primitive propositions | no logical objects
- > "no surprises in logic" (6.1251); logic's propositions are TAUTOLOGIES (6.1)

-> THE CRITERION OF THE SAYABLE

|
v

TWO FAILURES

- SINNLOS tautology / contradiction - well-formed, excludes nothing or everything, SHOWS logic's scaffolding (4.461-4.4611)
- UNSINNIG metaphysical pseudo-proposition - never entered logical space at all

|
v

PRESSURES (state as pressures, not concessions): simples unexemplified |

COLOUR EXCLUSION vs independence (1929) | belief-contexts 5.54 |

N over infinite domains

ANSWER LINE: if the world could not refute it, it did not tell you anything

SESSION 11 - SAYING AND SHOWING: THE LIMIT OF LANGUAGE, THE MYSTICAL, THE LADDER AND PROPOSITION 7

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Propositions tell us how things stand. But there is something a proposition cannot tell us: what makes it capable of telling us anything at all. Its logical form, the fact that it has that form, the existence of the objects it presupposes - these are not further facts to be reported; they display themselves in the proposition. Wittgenstein calls this the difference between what can be **said** and what can only be **shown**. Because ethics, aesthetics and the meaning of life are also not facts in the world, they too fall on the showing side - and so, embarrassingly, do the sentences of the *Tractatus* itself.

Technical definition: The **saying/showing distinction** separates what a proposition **states (gesagt)** - contingent states of affairs, the propositions of natural science - from what a proposition **displays (gezeigt)** - its own logical form, the logical properties of the world, the existence of objects presupposed by significant language, and, at the limit, value. FACT: "*What can be shown, cannot be said*" (4.1212). The distinction is **forced**, not stipulated: logical form is presupposed by every depiction, so any attempted depiction of it would already employ it. The *Tractatus* therefore closes with the **ladder (6.54)** - its own propositions are recognised as nonsensical by the reader who has used them to climb beyond them - and with **proposition 7**, which is uncommented and stands alone. ANALYSIS: There is **no**

proposition 7.1.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgenstein's silence is not modesty, mysticism or reticence but the exact consequence of his own account of sense: since every proposition works by sharing logical form with a possible situation, the sharing itself can never be one more situation to be described - and what cannot be described cannot be said badly either, which is why the correct response is silence rather than caution.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **said (gesagt) against shown (gezeigt)** - the distinction, in Wittgenstein's own vocabulary
- **4.1212** - "what can be shown, cannot be said"; safe verbatim
- **the limits of my language mean the limits of my world** - 5.6; the limit is drawn **from inside**
- **the mystical (das Mystische)** - 6.522: it shows itself; ANALYSIS: not "the emotional" or "the religious" loosely
- **the ladder** - 6.54, and the self-application problem it names
- **proposition 7** ANALYSIS: - quote it *and* name the translation; there is no 7.1
- **standard ineffability against resolute/therapeutic readings** CAUTION: - the interpretive dispute, stated in one clause

How to use them: both 2018 Q3(c) and 2021 Q4(c) ask you to justify or assess. So **derive** the distinction from the picture theory before you illustrate it; a list of sayable and showable items, unaccompanied by the derivation, is the answer that loses the assessment marks.

Plain-language visual - the eye that cannot see itself

WHAT A PROPOSITION DOES	WHAT IT CANNOT DO
+-----+	+-----+
It SAYS that things stand in	It cannot SAY that it has
a certain way.	the form that lets it say
	anything at all.
"The book is on the table."	
-> a possible arrangement of	To do that it would need
objects is presented	to step OUTSIDE the form
+-----+	and look at it - i.e.
	outside the possibility
	of representation itself.
	THERE IS NO SUCH PLACE.
	+-----+
v	v
THE ANALOGY THAT MAKES IT CLICK	
+-----+	
The EYE is not part of the visual field. Nothing you see tells	
you that you are seeing it. The eye's presence is not a fact	
IN the picture; it is a condition OF there being a picture.	
Wittgenstein uses exactly this image for the metaphysical	
subject at 5.632-5.633: "the subject does not belong to the	
world; rather, it is a LIMIT of the world."	
+-----+	
v	
AND THEN THE AWKWARD QUESTION THE BOOK ASKS ITSELF	
+-----+	
Every sentence of the Tractatus is about logical form, objects	
and the limits of language. By its own test, NONE of them says	
anything. 6.54: the reader who understands them recognises	
them as NONSENSICAL, and throws away the ladder.	
+-----+	

In simple words: you can photograph everything in a room except the camera taking the photograph, and no photograph can show you the fact that it is a photograph. Wittgenstein's claim is not that logical form is a very mysterious object that we can only glimpse. It is that logical form is not an object at all - it is what makes objects representable, and so there is nothing there to be photographed.

Remember first	Meaning
The distinction is derived	it follows from the picture theory; it is not an extra doctrine
Logical form shows itself	in every meaningful proposition, and cannot be stated
The limit is drawn in language	5.6 and the Preface; there is no outside vantage point
Ethics is not false	it is not a factual proposition at all - a different verdict entirely
7 stands alone	ANALYSIS: there is no proposition 7.1; writing "7.1" is a giveaway error

One-line memory: the eye is not in the visual field.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the sayable, the shown, and the two ways to read the ending

THE TABLE THAT ANSWERS "WHAT IS THE DISTINCTION?"

CAN BE SAID (gesagt)	CAN ONLY BE SHOWN (gezeigt)
propositions of NATURAL SCIENCE - pictures of facts (6.53)	LOGICAL FORM - the structure every proposition shares with reality
CONTINGENT states of affairs	THE EXISTENCE OF OBJECTS - presupposed by significant language
	LOGICAL TRUTHS (tautologies) - they SHOW the scaffolding of the world (6.124)
	ETHICS, AESTHETICS, THE MEANING OF LIFE, THE MYSTICAL - not IN the world, hence not facts, hence not sayable (6.42, 6.421, 6.522)
	THE RELATION OF LANGUAGE TO REALITY - that a proposition pictures a fact SHOWS ITSELF in the proposition

THE DERIVATION - why the distinction is FORCED, not stipulated

1 A proposition depicts by SHARING logical form with what it depicts (Session 9).
2 To DEPICT that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form and represent it as one fact among others.
3 But any picture whatever already HAS logical form; there is no representation from outside representation.
4 A regress also threatens: each attempted statement of form would need its own form stated.
5 THEREFORE logical form is not sayable. It SHOWS itself in every proposition that has it (4.12, 4.121, 4.1212).

THE LIMIT, AND WHY IT IS DRAWN FROM INSIDE

PREFACE: the limit "can only be drawn in language, and what lies on the other side of the limit will simply be nonsense"
5.6 The limits of my language mean the limits of my world.
5.61 We cannot say what we cannot think, so we cannot say what we cannot say.
ANALYSIS: SOLIPSISM, BOUNDED: 5.62-5.641. "What the solipsist MEANS is quite correct, only it cannot be SAID: it shows itself." The metaphysical subject is a LIMIT of the world, not an object in it (5.632-5.633), and strictly maintained solipsism "coincides with pure realism" (5.64). USE THIS TO ILLUSTRATE THE SAY/SHOW BOUNDARY ONLY - it is bounded orientation here, and the private-language critique belongs to TOPIC 08.

THE ENDING, AND THE TWO READINGS OF IT CAUTION:

STANDARD / INEFFABILITY READING	RESOLUTE / THERAPEUTIC READING (Diamond, Conant)
logical form, value and the mystical MANIFEST themselves although they cannot be stated as facts	6.54 licenses NO body of ineffable truths. The apparent doctrines are ELUCIDATORY NONSENSE, meant to be discarded entirely
the book gestures at truths that language cannot carry	the book performs a THERAPY; there is nothing left over
BOTH AGREE: ethics, aesthetics and the mystical are NOT factual propositions within logical space. State the agreement,	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The derivation box is what "Is he justified?" (2018) is asking about, and the two-reading box is what "Critically discuss" (2021) is asking about. Neither question can be answered from the first table alone.

1. The three things showing covers, kept apart FACT:

1. **Logical form and logical properties.** That a proposition has the structure it has, that one proposition follows from another, that a tautology is a tautology - these show themselves in the symbolism. FACT: 6.124: the propositions of logic describe the scaffolding of the world, or rather they represent it.
2. **The existence of what significant language presupposes.** That there are objects, that the world has the general form it has - attempts to state these produce **nonsense (unsinnig)**, not falsehood. "There are objects" is Wittgenstein's own example of the failure.
3. **Value.** FACT: 6.41: the sense of the world must lie outside the world, for in the world everything is as it is and happens as it does happen, and in it there is no value. FACT: 6.42: there can be no propositions of ethics. FACT: 6.421: ethics cannot be put into words; ethics is transcendental. FACT: 6.522: "there is indeed the inexpressible; this **shows** itself; it is the mystical".

ANALYSIS: **The verdict that must accompany the third.** The *Tractatus* does **not** say that ethical and religious claims are **false**, and it does not say they are unimportant. It says they are not **factual propositions**. **WRONG:** Writing "Wittgenstein rejects ethics and religion as meaningless in the positivists' sense" fuses two different doctrines and is a marked error - the Vienna Circle drew an anti-metaphysical conclusion from a criterion Wittgenstein did not hold.

2. Proposition 7 and the ladder - the exact wording discipline FACT:

- FACT: **Ogden/Ramsey (1922):** *"Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent."*
- FACT: **Pears-McGuinness (1961):** *"What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence."*
- ANALYSIS: **Name the translation whenever you quote 7.** Both are correct; presenting one as "the" wording is not. If unsure of any *Tractatus* wording, cite the **decimal number** instead - the numbering is identical in every edition and translation.
- FACT: **6.54, Pears-McGuinness:** *"My propositions serve as elucidations in the following way: anyone who understands me eventually recognises them as nonsensical, when he has used them - as steps - to climb beyond them. (He must, so to speak, throw away the ladder after he has climbed it.)"*
- ANALYSIS: **There is no proposition 7.1.** Proposition 7 is deliberately uncommented and stands alone; the decimal system means n.1 is a comment on n, and Wittgenstein supplies none. Writing "7.1" is a giveaway error.

3. Is he justified? - the answer to the 2018 question, in five moves ANALYSIS:

The question asks how the distinction points to "a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy", and whether Wittgenstein is justified. The single way is this: **every decisive philosophical problem arises from an attempt to say what can only be shown.** Metaphysics tries to state the form of the world; epistemology tries to state the relation of thought to reality; ethics tries to state value. All three attempt to depict a condition of depiction.

1. FACT: **The strength.** The diagnosis is unified and it is *derived*, not asserted: it follows from the account of sense rather than being added to it. It also explains why philosophical problems feel intractable - they are not hard questions but malformed ones.
2. FACT: **The second strength.** It yields a genuinely new verdict on ethics. Ethical claims are not false, not confused and not unimportant; they are not in the business of stating facts at all. That is a more respectful conclusion than the positivists' later one.
3. CAUTION: **The self-application objection.** The distinction is itself stated in the *Tractatus*, in propositions that by its own test say nothing. If the book is nonsense, it cannot have established the boundary it draws.
4. ANALYSIS: **The two replies.** The **standard** reading treats 6.54 as an honest acknowledgment: the propositions are elucidations that bring the reader to a recognition which cannot be stated, and something genuinely manifests itself. The **resolute** reading denies that anything is left over: the sentences are plain nonsense, and the therapy consists in the reader's coming to see that he was never given a doctrine at all.

5. ANALYSIS: **The graded verdict.** Justified as a **diagnosis** - the reduction of a whole family of problems to one structural error is a real achievement, and the derivation is valid given the picture theory. Not fully justified as a **doctrine**, because the boundary cannot be stated without transgressing itself, and because the picture theory's own presuppositions (simples, independence, universal truth-functionality) are undischarged. ANALYSIS: The honest close is that the *Tractatus* succeeds precisely to the extent that it is read as an activity rather than as a body of theses - which is Wittgenstein's own description of philosophy at 4.112.

4. Why silence is a logical consequence - the 2021 question in one paragraph FACT:

ANALYSIS: **The question ("Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent") is usually answered as if it expressed a mood.** It does not. The "must" is not prudential and not reverent. Given the account of sense, an attempt to speak beyond the sayable does not produce a *risky* or *imprecise* statement; it produces no statement. There is therefore nothing to be cautious about and nothing to be got wrong: the alternative to silence is not error but noise.

FACT: 6.53 makes the pedagogic corollary explicit - the correct method in philosophy would be to say nothing except what can be said, and then, whenever someone tried to say something metaphysical, to demonstrate that he had failed to give a meaning to certain signs in his propositions.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The saying/showing distinction is forced on Wittgenstein by his own account of sense, which is why it delivers a unified diagnosis of philosophical problems and simultaneously undermines the book that states it. **Named evidence.** Since a proposition depicts only by sharing logical form with the situation it depicts, that sharing cannot itself be depicted - "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212) - and the same applies to the existence of objects, to the logical truths that show the scaffolding of the world (6.124), and to value, since "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41), "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42) and "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical" (6.522). **Analysis.** The limit is therefore drawn from inside language - "the limits of my language mean the limits of my world" (5.6) - so the decisive problems of philosophy turn out to share one structure: each attempts to state a condition of stating, which is why silence at proposition 7 is a logical consequence rather than a counsel of prudence. **Qualification.** The cost is self-application: the *Tractatus*'s own propositions fail its test, and 6.54 concedes as much, so the standard ineffability reading and the resolute reading of Diamond and Conant divide over whether anything remains to be shown or whether the book is elucidatory nonsense throughout - a division a strong answer states before ruling that the work succeeds as a diagnosis and an activity rather than as a stateable doctrine.

Exam link

- **2018 Q3(c)**, fifteen marks: the derivation in Section 0's box, the unified diagnosis in Section 3, then the "Is he justified?" verdict in Section 3.5.
- **2021 Q4(c)**, fifteen marks: quote 7 with the translation named, run Section 4 on why the "must" is logical, then the ladder and the two readings.
- **2022 Q3(c)** closes on showing: after the pictorial/logical form contrast, one sentence noting that logical form is shown, not said, completes the answer.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"The <i>Tractatus</i> rejects ethics and religion as false"	They are not factual propositions. That is a different verdict, and a more respectful one
Treating say/show as the easy/hard distinction	It is about logical expressibility , not about difficulty
Quoting 7 without naming the translation	Ogden and Pears-McGuinness differ. Name the rendering, or cite the number
Writing "7.1"	ANALYSIS: There is no 7.1. Proposition 7 stands uncommented and alone
Presenting the resolute reading as the settled view	CAUTION: It is one of two live readings. State both, then rule
Expanding solipsism into a section	5.62-5.641 is bounded orientation used to illustrate the boundary; the private-language critique is Topic 08
Ending with the verification principle	The <i>Tractatus</i> has no verification criterion. Topic 07 owns it

Revision notes

- Said (*gesagt*): contingent states of affairs, propositions of natural science (6.53). Shown (*gezeigt*): logical form, existence of objects, logical truths (6.124), value and the mystical, the language-world relation.
- 4.1212 "what can be shown, cannot be said" - safe verbatim.
- Derivation: depiction requires shared form -> depicting the sharing needs an outside standpoint -> none exists -> regress also threatens -> form shows itself.
- Limit drawn in language: Preface and 5.6, 5.61. ANALYSIS: Solipsism bounded: 5.62-5.641, subject as limit (5.632-5.633), strict solipsism coincides with pure realism (5.64).
- Value: 6.41 sense of the world outside the world · 6.42 no propositions of ethics · 6.421 ethics is transcendental · 6.522 the inexpressible shows itself, the mystical.
- 6.54 ladder; 7 with translation named - Ogden "Whereof one cannot speak...", Pears-McGuinness "What we cannot speak about...". ANALYSIS: No 7.1.
- CAUTION: Standard ineffability vs resolute/therapeutic (Diamond, Conant); both agree ethics and the mystical are not factual propositions.
- Verdict: justified as a derived diagnosis; not fully justified as a stateable doctrine; philosophy as an activity, 4.112.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SAYING AND SHOWING

PICTURE THEORY: a proposition depicts by SHARING LOGICAL FORM

|

v

CAN THE SHARING BE DEPICTED? -> a picture of it would need to stand
OUTSIDE logical form; no such standpoint; regress threatens

|

v

THEREFORE: LOGICAL FORM SHOWS ITSELF (4.12-4.1212)
"What can be shown, cannot be said."

|

v

WHAT ELSE FALLS ON THE SHOWING SIDE

existence of objects | logical truths / scaffolding (6.124) |
the language-world relation | VALUE: 6.41, 6.42, 6.421, 6.522

|

v

THE LIMIT IS DRAWN IN LANGUAGE (Preface; 5.6, 5.61)

ANALYSIS: SOLIPSISM BOUNDED: what the solipsist MEANS is right but cannot
be SAID (5.62); the subject is a LIMIT, not an object (5.632-3);
strict solipsism coincides with PURE REALISM (5.64)

|

v

SELF-APPLICATION: the Tractatus's own propositions fail its test

6.54 THE LADDER - recognise them as nonsensical, then throw it away
7 - Ogden "Whereof one cannot speak..." | Pears-McGuinness "What we
cannot speak about..." ANALYSIS: NAME THE TRANSLATION. NO 7.1.

|

v

TWO READINGS CAUTION: standard INEFFABILITY vs resolute THERAPEUTIC (Diamond,
Conant) - both agree ethics/mystical are not factual propositions

|

v

VERDICT: justified as a DERIVED DIAGNOSIS of one structural error;
not fully justified as a STATEABLE doctrine; 6.53 gives the method,
4.112 makes philosophy an ACTIVITY

ANSWER LINE: the eye is not in the visual field

SESSION 12 - COMPARISONS, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVES AND PROVENANCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: This session is the craft session. It puts the three thinkers side by side so that comparative questions can be answered from a fixed grid rather than improvised; it collects the standard objections and the standard replies so that "critically discuss" has content; it gives the shape of a ten-, fifteen- and twenty-mark answer in this clause; and it fixes the dates, translations and attributions that a specialist examiner checks.

Technical definition: The **comparative and evaluative apparatus** of syllabus item 6 consists of (i) an axis-by-axis comparison of the three programmes; (ii) the specific contrast between **Russell's logical atomism** and the **Tractatus's** atomism; (iii) the criticism-and-reply ledger for each thinker, with the **residual** left after each reply; (iv) the answer architectures for the three mark-values; (v) the **directive decoder** that converts a command word into a structural obligation; and (vi) the **translation, numbering and provenance discipline** required because Moore and Russell wrote in English and Wittgenstein did not.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The three founders of analytic philosophy are best compared not by what they concluded but by what each was willing to leave unfinished: Moore leaves the analysis of ordinary knowledge open, Russell leaves the inventory of simples open, and the *Tractatus* leaves its own status open - and each of those three silences is exactly where the criticism lands.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **axis first, then comparison** - the discipline that separates a comparison from two parallel descriptions
- **residual** - what survives after a reply; the word that signals a graded verdict

- **directive decoder** - matching the command word to the structural obligation
- **provenance discipline** - dates, translations and attributions, stated in a clause
- **owner boundary** - the sentence that keeps Topics 07, 08, 11 out of a Topic 06 answer

How to use them: in any "distinguish", "compare" or "do you find any difference" question, **name the axis before you compare on it.** Two parallel descriptions score as description; one axis with two positions on it scores as comparison.

Plain-language visual - the comparison grid

ASK THE QUESTION ONCE, ANSWER IT THREE TIMES

AXIS	MOORE	RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
TARGET	scepticism and idealist conflation	misleading grammar and ontological inflation	conditions and LIMITS of propositional sense
CORE TOOL	common sense + act/object distinction	logical analysis (theory of descriptions)	picture theory of propositions
ONTOLOGY	ordinary objects accepted; full perceptual theory UNDERDETERMINED	particulars, qualities / relations, facts, phase-specific constructions	facts in logical space; simple objects UNSPECIFIED
METAPHYSICS	reject conclusions less certain than truisms; analyse the commitments	eliminate pseudo-constituents; test what remains	factual propositions SAY; logic, value and metaphysics raise the SAY/SHOW problem
SELF / SUBJECT	conscious ACT distinguished from its OBJECT	acquaintance framework varies across phases	solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the LIMIT (bounded)
LEGACY	analytic / common-sense method	formal analysis and ontological economy	influences positivism, then his OWN later criticism

In simple words: a comparison is a question asked once and answered three times. Choose the question - *what were you attacking? what tool did you use? what does the world contain when you have finished?* - and give three answers. Do not write three paragraphs, one per philosopher, and hope the reader does the comparing.

Remember first	Meaning
Name the axis	otherwise you have written parallel descriptions
Every reply leaves a residual	say what survives the reply; that is the graded verdict
Provenance is cheap marks	1903/1925/1939, 1905, 1914, 1918, 1921/1922 - a clause each
The owner boundary protects you	one sentence keeps Topics 07, 08 and 11 out
The two atomisms are two	this is the single most tested comparison in the clause

One-line memory: one axis, three answers - and a residual after every reply.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the two atomisms, and the criticism ledger with residuals

RUSSELL'S LOGICAL ATOMISM vs THE TRACTATUS'S ATOMISM

	RUSSELL	WITTGENSTEIN
WHAT ARE THE "ATOMS"?	acquainted particulars plus qualities / relations in the 1918 programme; NOT physical particles	OBJECTS - logical simples whose nature is UNSPECIFIED and whose POSSIBILITIES OF COMBINATION determine logical space
EPISTEMOLOGICAL GROUND	combines logical analysis with a CHANGING acquaintance-based epistemology	primarily a CONDITION-OF-SENSE argument, not a sense-datum identification
LOGICAL INDEPENDENCE	acknowledged, somewhat loosely	STRICTLY insisted upon - elementary propositions are logically independent
NEGATIVE FACTS	RELUCTANTLY ACCEPTED as truth-makers for true negations	NOT required - the TOTALITY of obtaining states settles what does not obtain (2.05); 4.0312
PUBLISHED EXPRESSION	"The Philosophy of Logical Atomism", lectures 1918; preface CREDITS Wittgenstein	Tractatus - written 1918, German 1921, bilingual 1922

THE CRITICISM LEDGER - objection | reply | RESIDUAL

MOORE

"Here is one hand" begs the question against the sceptic

REPLY the dialectical burden shifts; abstruse premisses are less certain than perceptual knowledge (Pryor and others) ANALYSIS:

RESIDUAL no NEUTRAL measure of comparative certainty is supplied the paradox of analysis shows analysis may be uninformative

REPLY Moore never claimed analysis is easy - only that KNOWLEDGE does not wait on it ANALYSIS:

RESIDUAL the paradox itself has no settled Moorean solution the refutation targets Berkeley-style idealism, not Hegel's

REPLY FACT: correct, and Moore does not claim otherwise

RESIDUAL Absolute Idealism is simply not addressed by the paper

RUSSELL

STRAWSON 1950: presupposition, not assertion; the truth question does not arise

REPLY a theory of truth-conditions is what a logic requires; gaps carry their own costs ANALYSIS:

RESIDUAL FACT: a genuine RIVAL ANALYSIS - Topic 11 owns his system what are the logically proper names? only "this" and "that"

REPLY FACT: Russell accepts the restriction openly

RESIDUAL the class of genuine names shrinks almost to nothing negative facts inflate the ontology; the atoms are unstable

REPLY accepted as a truth-making cost; analysis is provisional

RESIDUAL no fixed final inventory was ever established

THE TRACTATUS

ethics, aesthetics and religion are not factual pictures

REPLY deliberate demarcation, not dismissal

RESIDUAL CAUTION: standard and resolute readings disagree over whether ineffable truths remain

self-application: the book's own elucidations fail its test

REPLY 6.54 acknowledges the ladder problem

RESIDUAL CAUTION: successful therapy or unstable doctrine - disputed no uncontested examples of simples or elementary propositions

REPLY simples are REQUIRED for determinate sense

RESIDUAL transcendental necessity does not identify an actual base colour exclusion resists one independent elementary base

REPLY the 1929 paper attempts a richer logical form ANALYSIS:
RESIDUAL the attempt was abandoned; meaning-as-use is TOPIC 08

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Learn the ledger by its third column. Anyone can produce an objection; the marks are in the residual, because the residual is what shows you have weighed the reply instead of reciting it.

1. Answer architecture at three mark-values FACT:

10-mark - "The golden mountain is very high", 2025 Q1(d)

Problem : the sentence seems to be ABOUT a non-existent entity. Does it commit us to golden mountains? Is it meaningless?
Analysis: "the golden mountain" is an INCOMPLETE SYMBOL - no meaning in isolation. Analysed: there is exactly one golden mountain and it is very high - $(\text{Ex})[\text{Gx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Gy} \rightarrow \text{y}=\text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Hx}]$.
Result : the existence clause is false $\rightarrow$ the whole statement is FALSE, not meaningless, and nothing need "subsist" (contra Meinong).
Point : grammatical form $\neq$ logical form; descriptions remove ontological inflation.

15-mark - Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to blue/green/consciousness, 2025 Q3(c)

Frame : the idealist claim - esse est percipi, to be is to be perceived.
Moore : in every sensation distinguish (1) the ACT of awareness and (2) the OBJECT of awareness.
Quote : "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."
Key move: consciousness is DIAPHANOUS - we look THROUGH it to the object, which tempts us to conflate act and object. But they are distinct, and the comparison argument shows why.
Result : object $\neq$ act, so esse cannot be DEFINED as percipi; one idealist argument is blocked.
Assess : Moore refutes an argument FOR idealism, not idealism; he does not prove unperceived existence, supplies no theory of perception, and does not touch Absolute Idealism. The act-object distinction nevertheless became foundational for analytic philosophy.

20-mark - Russell's incomplete symbols leading to logical atomism, 2024 Q3(a)

Frame : Russell's analytic method - reveal LOGICAL form behind GRAMMATICAL form.
Body-A : INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS - no meaning in isolation; contextual definition; disappear on analysis. Theory of Descriptions: "The present King of France is bald" $\rightarrow$ $(\text{Ex})[\text{Kx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Ky} \rightarrow \text{y}=\text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Bx}]$. Three puzzles solved: negative existentials, excluded middle (scope), substitutivity.
Body-B : LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS - "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities" (1914). Physical objects, nations, numbers, points.
Body-C : LOGICAL ATOMISM - atomic facts $\leftrightarrow$ atomic propositions; molecular = truth-functions; isomorphism; "logical atoms and not physical atoms" (1918). The description theory REMOVES pseudo-constituents and SUPPORTS the search for genuine residues; it does NOT prove that analysis terminates or identify the atoms.
Assess : strengths - Ockham's razor made operational; pseudo-problems dissolved. Weaknesses - the simples were never fixed; negative facts are a real cost; Strawson offers a rival analysis of descriptions; belief-contexts resist truth-functional treatment.
Close : incomplete symbols are the scalpel of analytic philosophy; logical atomism is the anatomy toward which the scalpel cuts - and the anatomy was never completed.

2. Directive decoder ANALYSIS: - what each command word obliges you to do here

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation in this clause	Fatal error
Discuss / explain in the context of the theory of descriptions (2025 Q1d, 2024 Q3a, 2023 Q4b)	the symbolic analysis , not a paraphrase	write the three conjuncts in notation, then the scope distinction, then the puzzle solved	explaining "the golden mountain" in words with no formalisation
Present an account of... with reference to this statement (2025 Q3c, 2020 Q2b)	locate the printed sentence inside the paper's argument	name the paper and year, the target, and the distinction the sentence turns on	a free-floating gloss on the quotation
Critically discuss the picture theory (2022 Q3c)	assessment must be visible	reconstruct via bipolarity, logical space and the general form; then colour exclusion; then rule	describing "propositions picture facts" and adding one criticism
How does he apply the distinction... Is he justified? (2018 Q3c)	show the distinction is forced , not stipulated	derive it: logical form is presupposed by all depiction, hence not depictable; then the ladder and 7; then a graded verdict	listing sayable and showable items
What does he mean by...? Critically discuss. (2021 Q4c)	translation-aware exposition plus assessment	name the rendering, explain why the "must" is logical, then the ladder, then the two readings	treating proposition 7 as an expression of mood
What arguments are offered by Moore... (2024 Q1c, 2021 Q3a, 2019 Q3c)	the structure of the reversal of burden	truisms -> knowing against analysing -> the certainty comparison -> the sceptical objection	"Moore held up his hands"
Write a note on the nature of atomic facts in the light of the above (2020 Q2c)	decode the quotation first	"last residue in analysis"; logical not physical; then structure, then the molecular layer, then negative facts	describing atomism without touching the quoted words
How is X related to Y? (2018 Q4c, 2022 Q1b)	a stated relation, with its limits	supports / makes reasonable - and does not prove; say both	asserting entailment where only support exists
Distinguish / compare	fix a criterion first	axis: are the simples epistemic (Russell) or logical posits (Wittgenstein)?	two parallel descriptions

3. Translation, numbering and provenance discipline FACT:

Moore and Russell wrote in English. Wittgenstein did not. Different disciplines apply.

Item	Correct provenance	Caution
"The Refutation of Idealism"	<i>Mind</i> , 1903	ANALYSIS: Same year as <i>Principia Ethica</i> ; do not conflate the two works
"A Defence of Common Sense"	in <i>Contemporary British Philosophy</i> , 1925	the truisms paper
"Proof of an External World"	British Academy lecture, 1939	the hands paper. ANALYSIS: Three different papers, three different arguments; merging 1925 and 1939 is the commonest error in scripts
the hands gesture	Moore's text specifies the right hand first, then the left	if unsure, write "holding up first one hand and then the other"
"On Denoting"	<i>Mind</i> , 1905	the theory of descriptions proper
"Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by Description"	<i>PAS</i> , 1910-11 ; restated in <i>The Problems of Philosophy</i> , 1912 , Ch. 5	FACT: the Principle of Acquaintance is safe to quote verbatim from <i>Problems</i>

Item	Correct provenance	Caution
"The Philosophy of Logical Atomism"	lectures 1918 , delivered in London, published in <i>The Monist</i> 1918-19	ANALYSIS: Russell's preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein; saying so earns a mark and pre-empts the "who owns atomism" trap
the supreme maxim	"Logical Atomism" (1924) / <i>Our Knowledge of the External World</i> (1914), where it is called the supreme maxim in scientific philosophising	FACT: safe to quote
Strawson's reply	"On Referring", <i>Mind</i> , 1950	ANALYSIS: not a refutation of the logic; a claim about presupposition in ordinary use
Kripke's reply	<i>Naming and Necessity</i> , lectures 1970 , book 1980	ANALYSIS: give the lecture date or the book date, not a merged one
the <i>Tractatus</i> text	written 1918; German as <i>Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung</i> in <i>Annalen der Naturphilosophie</i> , 1921 ; German-English parallel edition with the Latin title, 1922	ANALYSIS: the Latin title was Moore's suggestion . Never date the English text 1921
translations	Ogden (with Ramsey's assistance, 1922, checked by Wittgenstein) and Pears-McGuinness (1961)	ANALYSIS: they differ at exactly the most quoted points
decimal citation	1.1, 2.011-2.06, 2.11, 2.18, 2.182, 2.223, 2.224, 3.4, 3.41, 4.0312, 4.06, 4.112, 4.1212, 4.461, 4.463, 4.5, 5, 5.51, 5.6, 5.64, 6, 6.1251, 6.41, 6.42, 6.522, 6.53, 6.54, 7	FACT: identical in every edition and translation - the safest citation in the whole Western syllabus
what the decimals mean	1, 2, 3... are the seven principal propositions; n.1 comments on n; n.11 comments on n.1	ANALYSIS: there is no 7.1 ; proposition 7 is deliberately un-commented
<i>Sachverhalt</i>	Ogden/Ramsey "atomic fact"; Pears-McGuinness "state of affairs"	choose one consistently; do not identify it with Russell's sense-datum-based atoms
the general form	6: [p̄ , ξ , N(ξ)]	FACT: notation, not translation; explain N as joint negation
" <i>Es verhält sich so und so</i> "	4.5	ANALYSIS: Ogden: "Such and such is the case"; Pears-McGuinness: "This is how things stand". Flag the rendering
"picture theory"	the label is the commentators' ; Wittgenstein writes <i>Bild</i> and <i>abbilden</i>	say "the doctrine usually called the picture theory"
colour exclusion	"Some Remarks on Logical Form", <i>PAS Supp.</i> 1929	ANALYSIS: the only philosophical article besides the <i>Tractatus</i> published in his lifetime; he quickly abandoned its proposed analysis

WRONG: Never write: that the *Tractatus* was "published in English in 1921"; that Wittgenstein "said language is a picture of the world" without the *logical form* qualification; that Russell invented logical atomism unaided; or that Moore's naturalistic fallacy belongs to this clause.

4. The graded verdict bank ANALYSIS: - executable closing positions

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Defence of common sense	Moore changes the burden by claiming no sceptical premiss is more certain than the ordinary proposition denied	...the knowing/analysing distinction prevents conceptual difficulty from automatically defeating ordinary knowledge	the method weighs certainty but supplies no neutral proof of its premiss; the later hinge analysis is a relevant comparison, not owner content
Proof of an external world	the proof is valid and its premiss known, which is all a proof requires	...the question-begging objection is met dialectically rather than demonstratively	it reverses the burden without supplying a criterion of knowledge, and its deepest defence - framework certainty - comes from outside Moore
Refutation of idealism	Moore distinguishes awareness from its presented object, so <i>esse</i> cannot simply mean <i>percipi</i>	...transparency explains the temptation to conflate act and object, but introspective distinction alone may not establish mind-independence	the paper blocks one route to idealism and historically aids analytic realism; it neither refutes every idealism nor completes a theory of perception
Theory of descriptions	a description is contextually eliminated into existence, uniqueness and predication	...this handles empty descriptions, negative existentials and scope without a nonexistent denoted object	Strawson presses the account as natural-language pragmatics and presupposition; Russell's quantificational analysis remains powerful without being the only complete semantic account
Acquaintance and description	the distinction explains how discourse can concern items not directly presented	...the acquaintance principle motivates contextual analysis, but the theory also has independent logical payoffs	Russell's candidates for acquaintance and genuine names change across phases; Sellars and Kripke are bounded evaluation, and the logic outlives the epistemology
Logical constructions	contextual construction substitutes an analysed structure for an extra inferred entity	...physical-object construction is phase-specific and strained by possible sense-data	the technique establishes ontological economy; the full Carnap and Quine afterlives remain later ownership
Logical atomism	analysis seeks atomic facts and propositions, but description theory does not prove that a final base exists	...Russell identifies phase-specific particulars and universals; Wittgenstein postulates objects through combinatorial logical role	negative facts, unstable simples, colour incompatibility and non-extensional contexts pressure the two atomisms differently; do not treat them as one failed thesis
Picture theory	a proposition has sense by presenting a possible situation through shared logical form	...bipolarity, logical space and truth-functional generation form the programme	colour incompatibility and attitude and modal contexts pressure its elementary and extensional assumptions; later meaning-as-use must not be smuggled in
Saying and showing	logical form cannot be pictured as one more fact because every picture already presupposes it	...the ladder passage makes self-application deliberate rather than unnoticed	standard ineffability and resolute therapeutic readings disagree about what, if anything, remains as ineffable truth; a graded answer states both before ruling

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The comparative question in this clause is answered by fixing an axis, because the three programmes are alike in target and unlike in everything that follows from it. **Named evidence.** On the axis of what analysis reaches, Moore's 1925 distinction between knowing a proposition and knowing its analysis leaves the analysis of ordinary knowledge open; Russell's 1918 lectures seek "logical atoms and not physical atoms" as the last residue, having removed pseudo-constituents by the 1905 analysis of descriptions; and the *Tractatus* postulates simple objects because determinate sense requires them, while supplying no example of one. **Analysis.** The same axis therefore explains the criticisms: Moore is charged with begging the question because his terminal premiss is unanalysed, Russell with an unstable inventory because his residue is never exhibited, and Wittgenstein with self-refutation because the requirement for a base is itself stated in a proposition that fails his test. **Qualification.** The three failures are not the same failure, and treating them as one is the commonest way of losing the assessment mark: Moore's gap is epistemological, Russell's is ontological and Wittgenstein's is a problem about the status of philosophical discourse itself - which is why each of the three replies leaves a different residual.

Exam link

- Every fifteen- and twenty-mark part in this clause closes on the verdict bank in Section 4.
- **2018 Q3(a)** (Empiricism-owned) is answered by the top grid plus the Moore/Russell row of the criticism ledger.
- **2018 Q4(c)**, **2022 Q1(b)** and **2024 Q3(a)** are all "how is X related to Y" questions, and Section 2's row for that directive is what keeps the answer from asserting entailment.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Two parallel descriptions instead of a comparison	Name the axis first, then give the three positions on it
Objection without residual	State what survives the reply; that is what "critically" means
Merging the two atomisms	Epistemically identified particulars against unspecified logical objects; and negative facts against the totality account
Merged dates	Kripke 1970 or 1980; the <i>Tractatus</i> 1921 German or 1922 bilingual - never a blend
Letting Topics 07, 08 or 11 into the answer	One boundary sentence, then return to the owner

Revision notes

- Comparison grid axes: target · core tool · ontology · metaphysics · self/subject · legacy.
- Two atomisms: what the atoms are · epistemological ground · logical independence · negative facts · published expression.
- Criticism ledger, by residual: Moore - no neutral certainty measure · Russell - no fixed inventory, and Strawson is a rival analysis · *Tractatus* - self-application unresolved between two readings.
- Architectures: 10-mark problem->analysis->result->point; 15-mark frame->doctrine->quote->key move->result->assess; 20-mark frame->three bodies->assess->close.
- Directive decoder: notation for descriptions questions · paper-location for quotation questions · derivation for say/show questions · structure-of-reversal for Moore questions · decode-the-quotation for 2020 Q2(c) · support-not-entailment for "how is X related to Y".
- Provenance: 1903 · 1905 · 1910-11/1912 · 1914 · 1918 · 1921 German · 1922 bilingual, Latin title from Moore · 1925 · 1929 · 1939 · 1950 · 1961 · 1970/1980. No proposition 7.1.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMPARISON AND CRAFT

COMPARE BY AXIS, NOT BY PARAGRAPH
target | core tool | ontology | metaphysics | self | legacy
|
v
THE TWO ATOMISMS: acquainted particulars + qualities/relations (RUSSELL)
vs UNSPECIFIED objects fixed by combinatorial possibility
(WITTGENSTEIN); loose vs STRICT independence; NEGATIVE FACTS vs the
TOTALITY account
|
v
CRITICISM LEDGER -> always finish with the RESIDUAL
MOORE no neutral measure of comparative certainty
RUSSELL no fixed inventory; Strawson is a RIVAL analysis
TRACTATUS self-application unresolved between standard and resolute
|
v
ARCHITECTURE
10 problem -> analysis -> result -> point
15 frame -> doctrine -> quote -> key move -> result -> assess
20 frame -> A incomplete symbols -> B constructions -> C atomism ->
assess -> close
|
v
DIRECTIVE DECODER: notation | locate the sentence | derive the
distinction | structure of the reversal | decode the quotation |
support != entailment | axis before comparison
|
v
PROVENANCE: 1903 | 1905 | 1912 | 1914 | 1918 | 1921 German | 1922
bilingual (Latin title from MOORE) | 1925 | 1929 | 1939 | 1950 |
1961 | 1970/1980. NO 7.1. Name the translation.
ANSWER LINE: one axis, three answers - and a residual after every reply

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated, and no cycle such as ABCD can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Defence of Commonsense*; *Refutation of Idealism*; *Logical Atomism*; *Logical Constructions*; *Incomplete Symbols*; *Picture Theory of Meaning*; *Saying and Showing* - together with the attribution firewall, the three senses of analysis, Moore's truisms and the knowing/analysing distinction, comparative certainty, the three conditions of a rigorous proof and the gloss on "external", the act/object distinction and transparency with the exact boundary of the result, incomplete symbols, the three conjuncts of the description analysis, primary and secondary occurrence, the three puzzles, acquaintance and the Principle of Acquaintance, logically proper names, the supreme maxim and the four worked constructions, atomic facts and truth-functionality, negative facts, the ontology of 1.1 and *Sachverhalt*, and the pictorial/logical form contrast. The eight remedial drills attack the confusions that cost marks every year: *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*, bipolarity against bivalence, the general form and the N-operator, the derivation of saying/showing, the translation and numbering discipline at proposition 7, the boundary against verificationism, the attribution boundary against Moore's ethics, and the exact strength of the descriptions-to-atomism link.

MCQ 1. What the early analytic movement was revolting against

Which one of the following best identifies the doctrine that Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein were reacting against at Cambridge?

- A. The empiricism of Locke and Hume, with its derivation of all ideas from impressions of sense.
- B. The transcendental idealism of Kant, with its distinction between phenomena and the thing in itself.
- C. The scholastic metaphysics of substance and essence inherited from the Aristotelian tradition.
- D. British Absolute Idealism, with its internal relations, degrees of truth and demotion of ordinary judgement.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the British empiricists are a source the analytic writers draw on selectively - Russell inherits an interest in the given - rather than the local system they set out to dislodge.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant is a background presence, and Moore's 1939 lecture answers Kant's "scandal to philosophy" charge, but the Cambridge target was the monism of Bradley and McTaggart, not the critical philosophy.
- **C:** Incorrect: scholastic metaphysics is not the immediate opponent; the movement's polemic is directed at a living school whose members held chairs in the same universities.
- **D:** Correct: the doctrine of internal relations, degrees of truth and the treatment of the ordinary world as "appearance" is exactly what the revolt refuses.

Examiner trap 1: "Idealism" without a qualifier is fatal in this clause, because Moore's 1903 paper attacks the Berkeleyan *esse est percipi* equation while the movement's institutional opponent was Absolute Idealism. Name which idealism you mean.

MCQ 2. The three senses of "analysis"

Consider the following statements about what analysis is supposed to achieve in the three programmes.

1. In Moore, analysis clarifies what an ordinary judgement commits us to, and its incompleteness does not cancel knowledge of that judgement.
2. In Russell, analysis replaces an apparent designator by a quantified paraphrase that preserves truth-conditions without the ontological commitment.
3. In the early Wittgenstein, analysis is a method of comparing ordinary usages with one another in the language-games where they occur.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 1 is accurate, but statement 3 describes the later philosophy of the *Investigations* and is not what analysis means in the *Tractatus*.
- **B:** Correct: Moore's commitment-clarification and Russell's quantificational paraphrase are two of the three senses; the third is the resolution of propositions into truth-functions of elementary propositions.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is accurate, but pairing it with statement 3 attributes to the early Wittgenstein a method he adopted only after abandoning the *Tractatus* programme.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 2 are correct, so including statement 3 imports language-games into a topic that does not own them.

Examiner trap 2: The word "analysis" is shared by all three men and means something different in each. A script that uses it without discrimination has recorded the movement's slogan and missed its content.

MCQ 3. Knowing a proposition and knowing its analysis

Which one of the following states the distinction Moore uses to protect ordinary knowledge in "A Defence of Common Sense"?

- A. That one may know a proposition to be true with certainty while the correct philosophical analysis of it remains doubtful.
- B. That one may believe a proposition firmly while lacking the evidence that would convert the belief into knowledge.
- C. That one may understand the words of a proposition while failing to grasp the concept those words express.
- D. That one may accept a proposition on testimony while being unable to verify it through one's own experience.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the truth of "I have two hands" is certain, while what a material object ultimately is may remain an unfinished philosophical question - and the sceptic's inference from the second to a denial of the first is a confusion of levels.
- **B:** Incorrect: Moore's distinction is not between belief and knowledge at all; he insists on the word "know", and it is the *analysis*, not the epistemic status, that he allows to remain doubtful.
- **C:** Incorrect: a gap between words and concept is a problem about understanding; Moore's point concerns two different questions about a proposition that is already understood.
- **D:** Incorrect: testimony and personal verification play no part in the argument, which is about the relation between knowing a truth and analysing it.

Examiner trap 3: Candidates often render this distinction as "knowing versus believing", which destroys the argument: Moore's whole strategy depends on the analysis being doubtful while the knowledge is not.

MCQ 4. The comparative-certainty principle

Which one of the following correctly states the principle on which Moore's defence of common sense rests?

- A. A truism is immune from criticism because a sufficiently large number of competent speakers accept it without hesitation.
- B. A truism is self-evident in the strict sense, so that its denial is a formal contradiction discoverable by reflection alone.
- C. A philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss of that argument is more certain than the truism it denies.
- D. A philosophical argument overturns a truism only if it can be reconstructed as a valid deduction from premisses of natural science.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: popularity plays no role whatever. Moore's list is a philosophical proposal about what he and others know, not a survey of what people happen to believe.
- **B:** Incorrect: Moore does not claim self-evidence or formal indubitability; the truisms are contingent propositions about the world, and he claims to know them rather than to prove them.
- **C:** Correct: the argument is a weighing of credentials, and its empirical claim is that no sceptical or idealist premiss has ever met the condition.
- **D:** Incorrect: no appeal to scientific derivation appears in Moore's argument, which is conducted entirely through the comparison of certainties.

Examiner trap 4: Presenting comparative certainty as an appeal to common opinion converts a dialectical principle into a fallacy of popularity - and invites the objection Moore was careful to avoid.

MCQ 5. Moore's conditions for a rigorous proof

Consider the following as conditions Moore himself lays down for a rigorous proof in "Proof of an External World".

1. The premiss must be different from the conclusion, so that the argument is not circular.
2. The premiss must be known, and not merely believed or assumed.
3. The premiss must itself have been proved by a prior argument of the same rigour.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: condition 1 is Moore's, but condition 3 is the very requirement he rejects, since it would generate a regress in which nothing is ever proved.
- **B:** Correct: difference of premiss from conclusion and knowledge of the premiss are two of the three conditions; the third is that the conclusion must follow.
- **C:** Incorrect: condition 2 is Moore's, but attaching condition 3 makes the proof fail by a standard Moore explicitly denies is required.
- **D:** Incorrect: conditions 1 and 2 are correct, so including condition 3 misrepresents the concession that gives the lecture its philosophical interest.

Examiner trap 5: Moore concedes that he cannot prove "here is one hand" and treats the concession as harmless. A script that reports the concession as a defect has missed his argument that a proof requires a *known* premiss, not a *proved* one.

MCQ 6. Why the hands entail an external world

In Moore's proof, what makes the step from "here is one hand" to "an external world exists" a valid inference rather than a leap?

- A. The premiss is asserted with a degree of confidence that no sceptical consideration has ever been able to reduce.
- B. The premiss is confirmed by the concurring perceptual reports of the audience present at the British Academy lecture.
- C. The premiss belongs to the list of truisms already defended in the earlier paper of 1925 on common sense.
- D. The premiss concerns a hand, and Moore has glossed "external" as "met with in space", which a hand is.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: confidence is what makes the premiss *known* on Moore's account, but confidence alone cannot make an inference valid; validity requires the definitional link.
- **B:** Incorrect: no appeal to corroborating witnesses occurs, and the proof would be unaffected if Moore were alone.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two papers execute one strategy but are separate arguments; the 1939 inference works through the gloss on "external", not through membership of the 1925 list.
- **D:** Correct: "external to our minds" is explained as "things met with in space", so the existence of a hand analytically yields the existence of an external thing.

Examiner trap 6: Scripts that narrate the gesture without the gloss leave the inference unexplained. The definition is the load-bearing step, and it costs one clause.

MCQ 7. The structure of the refutation of idealism

Which one of the following reconstructs the central argument of Moore's "The Refutation of Idealism"?

- A. Since perception is causally dependent on physical stimulation of the sense organs, its objects must be physical rather than mental.
- B. Since the idealist cannot produce a coherent account of unperceived objects, the burden of proof falls on him rather than on the realist.
- C. Since the sensations of blue and green share consciousness and differ in their objects, the act of awareness cannot be identical with its object.
- D. Since ordinary language distinguishes seeing from what is seen, the idealist's usage departs from established linguistic practice.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Moore's argument is not causal and makes no appeal to physiology; it turns on what must be present in experience for two sensations to be comparable at all.
- **B:** Incorrect: burden-shifting is the strategy of the common-sense papers; the 1903 paper offers a positive structural argument rather than a redistribution of proof.
- **C:** Correct: the common element and the variable element cannot both be supplied if act and object are one, which is precisely the identification *esse est percipi* requires.
- **D:** Incorrect: an appeal to ordinary usage is a later analytic move; Moore argues from the structure of sensation, not from linguistic convention.

Examiner trap 7: The blue-green comparison is an argument, not an illustration. Reporting it as an example of the distinction, rather than as the reason for drawing it, loses the substance of the paper.

MCQ 8. The transparency or diaphanous thesis

What role does the transparency of consciousness play in Moore's refutation of idealism?

- A. It explains why the act of awareness is persistently overlooked, and so why act and object are so easily conflated.
- B. It establishes that the objects of awareness continue to exist during the intervals when nobody is perceiving them.
- C. It shows that introspection is an infallible source of knowledge concerning one's own present mental states.
- D. It demonstrates that consciousness has no intrinsic character of its own and is therefore a mere logical fiction.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: attention passes through the act to the object, so the act seems elusive - and Moore's point is that elusiveness is not absence.
- **B:** Incorrect: unperceived existence is exactly what the paper does *not* establish; the act/object distinction blocks an identification without proving independence.
- **C:** Incorrect: no claim of introspective infallibility is made, and the argument would be weakened rather than strengthened by one.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the conclusion some later philosophers of mind draw *against* Moore from the same observation; Moore holds that the act is real though hard to notice.

Examiner trap 8: Transparency is a diagnosis of the idealist's error, not a premiss of the refutation. Treating it as the argument leaves the answer resting on an introspective report Moore himself concedes is difficult.

MCQ 9. The exact scope of Moore's result

Consider the following claims about what "The Refutation of Idealism" achieves.

1. It shows that the *esse est percipi* argument does not establish idealism.
2. It shows that objects of sensation continue to exist when they are not being sensed.
3. It leaves Absolute Idealism untouched, since that doctrine does not argue from the perceptual equation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: claim 1 is right, but claim 2 overstates the result - distinguishing the object from the act does not by itself show that the object can exist unsensed.
- **B:** Correct: one argument for idealism is blocked, and Hegelian Absolute Idealism, resting on internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations, is not addressed.
- **C:** Incorrect: claim 3 is right, but claim 2 attributes to Moore a conclusion he explicitly does not draw in this paper.
- **D:** Incorrect: claims 1 and 3 are correct, so including claim 2 converts a bounded refutation into an unargued realism.

Examiner trap 9: "Moore refutes idealism" is the most frequently overclaimed sentence in this clause. He refutes an argument, and saying which argument is the difference between a competent and a strong script.

MCQ 10. What makes a symbol incomplete

Which one of the following correctly defines an incomplete symbol in Russell's sense?

- A. An expression with no meaning in isolation, defined only through rules giving the meaning of whole sentences containing it.
- B. An expression whose meaning is fixed by ostension, so that it cannot be understood without a present sample.
- C. An expression that fails to designate anything, and which therefore renders any sentence containing it meaningless.
- D. An expression whose meaning varies with the context of utterance, as with indexical and demonstrative terms.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the doctrine of contextual definition taken over from *Principia Mathematica*; the symbol contributes systematically to whole sentences and disappears on analysis.
- **B:** Incorrect: ostensive definition characterises Russell's logically proper names, which are the opposite case - symbols that *do* designate directly.
- **C:** Incorrect: an empty description makes its sentence **false**, not meaningless; avoiding meaninglessness is precisely the theory's achievement.
- **D:** Incorrect: context-sensitivity of indexicals is a different phenomenon; an incomplete symbol has no meaning of its own in any context.

Examiner trap 10: "Incomplete" is repeatedly read as "meaningless". Write the words "in isolation" and the error cannot occur.

MCQ 11. The analysis of a definite description

According to the theory of descriptions, "The F is G" asserts which combination of claims?

- A. That whatever is F is also G, and that at least one thing is G.
- B. That something is F, that something is G, and that the two are compatible.
- C. That the speaker presupposes an F and predicates G of it without asserting existence.
- D. That at least one thing is F, that at most one thing is F, and that it is G.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a universally quantified conditional with an existential rider; it drops uniqueness entirely and so cannot capture the force of the definite article.
- **B:** Incorrect: existence for each predicate separately, plus compatibility, is far weaker than the analysis and would make "The F is G" true whenever unrelated F's and G's happened to exist.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is Strawson's rival account of 1950, on which existence is presupposed rather than asserted - Russell's whole point is that it is asserted.
- **D:** Correct: existence, uniqueness and predication, conjoined - formally $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$.

Examiner trap 11: Uniqueness is the conjunct most often dropped. Without it the analysis renders "the" as "a", and the definite article's entire contribution disappears.

MCQ 12. "The golden mountain is very high"

On Russell's analysis, what is the correct verdict on the sentence "The golden mountain is very high"?

- A. It is meaningless, since its grammatical subject fails to pick out any object in the world.
- B. It is neither true nor false, since the existence it presupposes is not satisfied.
- C. It is false, since the existence conjunct of its analysis is unsatisfied.
- D. It is true of a subsisting object, since we plainly understand what the phrase refers to.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: meaningfulness is what the theory is constructed to avoid, and it conflicts with the plain fact that competent speakers understand the sentence.
- **B:** Incorrect: a truth-value gap is Strawson's position, not Russell's; on the quantificational analysis the sentence has a determinate truth-value.
- **C:** Correct: the conjunction fails at its first conjunct because nothing is a golden mountain, so the whole sentence is false, and no golden mountain need subsist for it to be understood.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is Meinong's route, and the golden mountain is his own stock example; Russell's analysis is designed precisely to avoid populating the world with such objects.

Examiner trap 12: Writing that the sentence is "meaningless" reverses the theory's headline result. The examinable formula is *false*, *not meaningless*, and *no Meinongian object*.

MCQ 13. Primary and secondary occurrence

Which one of the following correctly explains Russell's treatment of "The King of France is not bald"?

- A. On the primary occurrence the description takes wide scope and the sentence is false; on the secondary occurrence the negation takes wide scope and it is true.
- B. On the primary occurrence the sentence is true because negation removes the existence claim; on the secondary occurrence it is false because it reinstates it.
- C. On both occurrences the sentence is false, because the existence claim is unsatisfied however the negation is placed within it.
- D. On both occurrences the sentence lacks a truth-value, because scope cannot be assigned where the description is empty.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: with the description taking wide scope the sentence asserts that exactly one King of France exists and is not bald, which is false; with negation taking wide scope it denies that exactly one bald King exists, which is true.
- **B:** Incorrect: the truth-values are inverted here - it is the *secondary* occurrence, with negation outside, that yields truth.
- **C:** Incorrect: this collapses the scope distinction and therefore loses the solution to the excluded-middle puzzle, which is exactly what the distinction is for.
- **D:** Incorrect: truth-value gaps belong to the presuppositional account; on Russell's analysis every well-formed sentence receives a value.

Examiner trap 13: Scope is treated as an optional technicality and then omitted. It is the *solution* to one of Russell's three advertised puzzles, so omitting it removes a third of the case for the theory.

MCQ 14. The three puzzles

Which one of the following is **not** among the three puzzles Russell claims the theory of descriptions resolves?

- A. How a negative existential statement can be true without referring to the thing whose existence it denies.
- B. How the law of excluded middle can hold for a sentence containing a description that nothing satisfies.
- C. How a general term can apply to indefinitely many individuals without naming a universal that they share.
- D. How substitution of an identical can fail inside a report of what someone wished to know.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because negative existentials *are* one of the three; the analysis makes the denial the negation of an existence-and-uniqueness claim.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because excluded middle *is* one of the three; it is resolved by the primary/secondary scope distinction.
- **C:** Correct: the problem of universals is a separate issue in Russell's philosophy, addressed through his realism about universals, and is not one of the three puzzles of "On Denoting".
- **D:** Incorrect as an answer, because substitutivity *is* one of the three; George IV's curiosity about the author of *Waverley* is Russell's own illustration.

Examiner trap 14: The three puzzles are the theory's advertisement - one device solving three independent problems. Substituting a fourth, unrelated problem for one of them suggests the list has been half-remembered.

MCQ 15. The Principle of Acquaintance

Which one of the following states Russell's Principle of Acquaintance as given in *The Problems of Philosophy*?

- A. Every proposition that is true must correspond to some fact with which we could in principle become acquainted.
- B. Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted.
- C. Every object of knowledge must be either a sense-datum or something inferred by strict deduction from sense-data.
- D. Every name in a logically perfect language must be correlated with a particular that endures through change.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the principle constrains **understanding**, not truth, and it says nothing about what facts a true proposition must correspond to.
- **B:** Correct: this is the sentence itself, from Chapter 5, and it is the constraint that makes the theory of descriptions epistemically necessary rather than merely convenient.
- **C:** Incorrect: this describes a strict foundationalist theory of knowledge; Russell's principle is about the constituents of understood propositions, and acquaintance extends to universals as well as sense-data.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is a claim about logically proper names in an ideal notation, which is a consequence Russell draws rather than the principle he states.

Examiner trap 15: Quoting the principle as a constraint on truth rather than on understanding destroys the argument that follows, since the Bismarck problem is a problem about how a proposition can be *understood*.

MCQ 16. The objects of acquaintance

Which one of the following lists items that Russell counts among the objects of acquaintance in this phase of his philosophy?

- A. Physical objects, other minds, past events and the theoretical entities of physics.
- B. Propositions, facts, states of affairs and the logical constants that connect them.
- C. Material substances, their primary qualities and the causal powers by which they act.
- D. Sense-data, memory data, introspective data of one's own mental states, and universals.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: every item listed is known **by description** precisely because it is not directly presented; that is the contrast the distinction is built to mark.
- **B:** Incorrect: facts and states of affairs are what propositions answer to, and the logical constants are explicitly denied representative status by Wittgenstein; neither is an object of Russellian acquaintance.
- **C:** Incorrect: material substances and causal powers are inferred or constructed on Russell's account, not met without inference.
- **D:** Correct: and the inclusion of **universals** is the point worth flagging, since it is a substantial Platonic concession for a philosopher in the empiricist line.

Examiner trap 16: Omitting universals from the list makes Russell look like a strict sense-datum empiricist and removes the one item that shows where he breaks with Berkeley's nominalism.

MCQ 17. Logically proper names

Which one of the following is correct about logically proper names in Russell's austere phase?

- A. Ordinary proper names such as "Bismarck" qualify, because they are learned by direct introduction to their bearers.
- B. Definite descriptions qualify whenever they succeed in picking out exactly one object in the actual world.
- C. Only demonstratives such as "this" and "that", used of what is presently given, are serious candidates.
- D. Only the names of universals qualify, since universals alone are available to every thinker at every time.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: ordinary proper names are analysed as **disguised descriptions**, which is exactly the doctrine Kripke's modal argument later attacks.
- **B:** Incorrect: a description that uniquely applies is still contextually eliminated; success in picking something out does not convert a quantifier into a name.
- **C:** Correct: the class shrinks almost to nothing and varies with the speaker and the moment, and Russell was fully aware how restrictive this is.
- **D:** Incorrect: universals are objects of acquaintance, but Russell does not restrict genuine names to their labels; the demonstratives are his standard candidates.

Examiner trap 17: Candidates who read "logically proper name" as "genuine surname" invert the doctrine. The point is that almost no ordinary name qualifies.

MCQ 18. The supreme maxim

Which one of the following is Russell's supreme maxim in scientific philosophising?

- A. Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities.
- B. Wherever possible, replace an ambiguous ordinary sentence by a sentence of an ideal formal notation.
- C. Wherever possible, prefer the hypothesis that postulates the smallest number of unobserved causes.
- D. Wherever possible, resolve a philosophical dispute by determining how the disputed words are ordinarily used.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it is Russell's own formulation, and it converts Ockham's razor from a slogan into a working procedure applied to inference.
- **B:** Incorrect: the ideal-notation programme is a related commitment, but the maxim is specifically about substituting construction for inference, not about regimenting ambiguity.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is a general principle of theoretical parsimony about causes; Russell's maxim is about the *entities a philosophical analysis must posit*.
- **D:** Incorrect: appeal to ordinary use is the method of later ordinary-language philosophy, and it is at odds with Russell's readiness to correct ordinary grammar.

Examiner trap 18: The maxim is short, quotable and dated 1914. Paraphrasing it loosely wastes the easiest verbatim mark in the Russell half of this clause.

MCQ 19. Constructions and atoms

Which one of the following correctly contrasts logical constructions with logical atoms?

- A. Constructions are the simples that analysis discovers, while atoms are the complexes that analysis dissolves.
- B. Constructions are objects of acquaintance, while atoms are objects known only by description.
- C. Constructions are found in mathematics alone, while atoms belong to the analysis of empirical propositions.
- D. Constructions add no further entity and are contextually defined, while atoms are the residue analysis seeks.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the roles are exactly reversed; it is constructions that analysis dissolves and atoms that it is looking for.
- **B:** Incorrect: acquaintance and description classify *knowledge of things*, not the construction/atom contrast, and physical objects are constructions yet known by description.
- **C:** Incorrect: numbers are indeed constructed, but so are tables, nations and points of space; the maxim is deliberately general.
- **D:** Correct: constructions receive contextual definitions and posit nothing extra, while atoms are what would remain when every construction has been removed.

Examiner trap 19: Constructions are frequently described as "fictions". We say **true** things about tables and nations; what is denied is an additional entity, not the truth of the sentences.

MCQ 20. What "atomic" means in "atomic fact"

Which one of the following correctly explains Russell's use of "atomic"?

- A. An atomic fact is one whose constituents are too small to be perceived without instrumental assistance.
- B. An atomic fact contains no other facts as constituents, though it does contain particulars and universals.
- C. An atomic fact is one that cannot be expressed in language and can therefore only be shown.
- D. An atomic fact is one whose truth is knowable a priori and independently of all sense experience.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the physical reading the 1918 lectures explicitly disown - the atoms are the "last residue in analysis", and they are logical, not microscopic.
- **B:** Correct: a particular exemplifying a quality, or particulars standing in a relation; "atomic" marks the absence of *facts* inside, not the absence of constituents.
- **C:** Incorrect: atomic facts are precisely what atomic propositions state; the sayable/showable boundary is Wittgenstein's, and it does not classify Russell's atomic facts as unsayable.
- **D:** Incorrect: atomic facts are contingent and are known, when they are known, through experience; apriority plays no part in the definition.

Examiner trap 20: Reading "atomic" as "partless" is as damaging as reading it as "physical". An atomic fact has constituents; what it lacks is facts among them.

MCQ 21. Truth-functionality and the connectives

Which one of the following follows from Russell's claim that molecular propositions are truth-functions of atomic ones?

- A. No additional fact in the world corresponds to the connectives "and" or "or".
- B. Every molecular proposition can be shown to be either a tautology or a contradiction.
- C. Every atomic proposition can be derived from some molecular proposition by analysis.
- D. No molecular proposition can be false if all of its atomic components are true.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the truth-value of the molecule is fixed by the atoms plus the connective, so the connective needs no ontological counterpart - a substantial economy.
- **B:** Incorrect: most molecular propositions are contingent; tautology and contradiction are the limiting cases, not the general case.
- **C:** Incorrect: the direction of construction runs the other way, from atoms to molecules; atomic propositions are the base, not the derived layer.
- **D:** Incorrect: "p and not-q" is false when p and q are both true, so truth of the components does not guarantee truth of the molecule.

Examiner trap 21: The economy is the point. A script that states truth-functionality without drawing the ontological consequence has described a truth-table instead of an argument.

MCQ 22. Negative facts

Why does Russell reluctantly admit negative facts into his ontology?

- A. Because the law of excluded middle requires every proposition to have a determinate truth-value.
- B. Because negation is a logical constant that must stand for something if the notation is to be interpreted.
- C. Because sense-data are sometimes absent, and their absence must be recorded in the inventory of the world.
- D. Because a true negative proposition seems to require something in the world to make it true.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: excluded middle constrains truth-values, not truth-makers, and Russell's difficulty is specifically about what makes a true negation true.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is close to the view Wittgenstein denies at 4.0312 when he says the logical constants are not representatives; Russell's motive is truth-making, not the interpretation of a symbol.
- **C:** Incorrect: absent sense-data are an epistemological matter; the problem concerns the ontological ground of true negative propositions such as "Socrates is not alive".
- **D:** Correct: to preserve a direct truth-making relation Russell accepts that the non-obtaining of a positive state is itself something - and he treats the admission as a cost.

Examiner trap 22: Wittgenstein avoids negative facts because the **totality** of obtaining states determines which possible states do not obtain. Attributing negative facts to the *Tractatus* merges the two atomisms at exactly the point where they diverge most sharply.

MCQ 23. The opening ontology of the *Tractatus*

Which one of the following correctly reports the opening ontological claims of the *Tractatus*?

- A. The world is the totality of objects, and facts are the ways in which we describe them.
- B. The world is the totality of facts, and a state of affairs is a combination of objects.
- C. The world is the totality of propositions, and objects are what makes them meaningful.
- D. The world is the totality of sense-data, and facts are constructions out of them.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this reverses 1.1, which insists that the world is facts and **not** things, and makes facts linguistic rather than worldly.
- **B:** Correct: 1.1 and 2.01 taken together - a complete list of objects would leave undecided how things stand, and only configurations settle that.
- **C:** Incorrect: propositions depict the world; identifying the world with propositions collapses the very relation the picture theory explains.
- **D:** Incorrect: sense-data belong to Russell's phenomenalist phase; Tractarian objects are logical simples characterised by their possibilities of combination.

Examiner trap 23: ANALYSIS: *Sachverhalt* is "atomic fact" in Ogden/Ramsey and "state of affairs" in Pears-McGuinness. Alternating between the two renderings within one answer looks like uncertainty about the text.

MCQ 24. Pictorial form and logical form

Which one of the following correctly distinguishes pictorial form from logical form?

- A. Pictorial form belongs to visual representations, while logical form belongs to sentences of a written language.
- B. Pictorial form is the arrangement of names, while logical form is the arrangement of the objects named.
- C. Pictorial form is what a picture must share with reality in its own medium; logical form is shared by every picture whatever.
- D. Pictorial form is grasped by the senses, while logical form is grasped by an act of pure intellectual intuition.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: pictorial form is not restricted to the visual - a musical score shares acoustic form - and logical form is not restricted to written language.
- **B:** Incorrect: this describes the correlation of elements within a single picture, not the contrast between the two kinds of form.
- **C:** Correct: a spatial model shares spatial form, a score shares acoustic form, and every picture, in any medium, shares logical form - which is why a proposition can depict any fact whatever.
- **D:** Incorrect: no faculty psychology is involved; the distinction concerns what must be common between representation and represented, not how we come to know it.

Examiner trap 24: The 2022 paper asks both whether the two differ **and** how logical form defines the language-world relation. Answering only the first half leaves half the question untouched.

MCQ 25. Remedial - sinnlos against unsinnig

Which one of the following correctly classifies the two ways in which a sentence can fail to say something in the *Tractatus*?

- A. Tautologies and metaphysical sentences are both nonsensical, since neither states a contingent fact about the world.
- B. Tautologies are nonsensical, while metaphysical sentences are senseless but well formed within the symbolism.
- C. Tautologies are false in every possible situation, while metaphysical sentences are true in every possible situation.
- D. Tautologies are senseless but well formed, while metaphysical sentences are nonsensical and depict nothing.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it erases the distinction the text insists on - tautologies belong to the symbolism and show logic's scaffolding, whereas metaphysical sentences never enter logical space.
- **B:** Incorrect: the two labels are exchanged, and the resulting classification makes metaphysics better placed than logic.
- **C:** Incorrect: tautologies are **true** under every truth-condition, and contradictions false under every one; metaphysical sentences have no truth-conditions at all.
- **D:** Correct: *sinnlos* for tautology and contradiction, *unsinnig* for the metaphysical pseudo-proposition - the most frequently tested discrimination in the *Tractatus*.

Examiner trap 25: Treating the two words as synonyms also opens the door to the verificationist misreading, because it suggests the *Tractatus* dismisses logic and metaphysics on one and the same ground.

MCQ 26. Remedial - bipolarity against bivalence

Which one of the following states the bipolarity requirement correctly?

- A. Every proposition is either true or false, and no proposition is both true and false at once.
- B. Every proposition has a truth-value that is determined once the meanings of its constituent words are fixed.
- C. A proposition has sense only if it is capable of being true and also capable of being false.
- D. A proposition has sense only if some procedure exists by which its truth could in principle be established.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is **bivalence**, which tautologies satisfy perfectly well while still failing bipolarity, since a tautology cannot be false.
- **B:** Incorrect: this describes determinacy of sense rather than bipolarity, and it would not exclude a sentence that could not possibly be false.
- **C:** Correct: both poles must be genuinely available, which is why tautologies and contradictions are *sinnlos* and why depicting requires the possibility of misdepicting.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the verification principle of the Vienna Circle, which belongs to the next syllabus item and is not the *Tractatus*'s criterion.

Examiner trap 26: Bipolarity is the point at which a *Tractatus* answer most easily slides into Topic 07. The test is whether a possible situation is depicted, never whether it can be checked.

MCQ 27. Remedial - the general form and the N-operator

In the general form of the proposition, $[\bar{p}, \xi, N(\xi)]$, what does the N-operator do?

- A. It applies joint negation to a selected set of propositions, asserting that none of them is true.
- B. It applies material implication between two selected propositions, asserting that the first entails the second.
- C. It applies existential generalisation to a propositional function, asserting that the function has a value.
- D. It applies necessity to a selected proposition, asserting that it holds in every possible configuration.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: from joint negation alone one obtains $\neg p$ as $N(p)$, $p \vee q$ as $N(N(p,q))$ and $p \& q$ as $N(N(p),N(q))$ - a single operation generating every truth-function.
- **B:** Incorrect: implication is one of the truth-functions **derived** from N, not the operation itself.
- **C:** Incorrect: quantification is handled through sets of values of propositional functions, and the adequacy of that treatment for infinite domains is disputed; it is not what N means.
- **D:** Incorrect: modal notions are not primitive in the *Tractatus*, and treating N as a necessity operator misdescribes a truth-functional device.

Examiner trap 27: The point of proposition 6 is that logic needs **no primitive propositions and no logical objects** - Wittgenstein's decisive break with Russell and Frege. Reproducing the schema without that consequence wastes it.

MCQ 28. Remedial - why saying and showing is forced

Which one of the following gives Wittgenstein's reason for holding that logical form cannot be said?

- A. Because logical form is a fact of such generality that no finite proposition could state it completely.
- B. Because any picture of logical form would already have to possess logical form, so no depiction from outside is possible.
- C. Because logical form is known only through mystical experience, which by its nature resists linguistic formulation.
- D. Because logical form varies from one language to another, so no single statement of it could be universally correct.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the obstacle is not the size or generality of the task but the structural impossibility of a standpoint outside representation.
- **B:** Correct: depiction presupposes shared form, so the sharing cannot itself be depicted, and a regress threatens any attempt to state it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the mystical shows itself (6.522), but it is a **consequence** of the boundary rather than the ground of it; the argument is logical, not experiential.
- **D:** Incorrect: logical form is precisely what is **not** language-relative - it is the form of all possible representation.

Examiner trap 28: "Is he justified?" asks about the derivation. A script that lists sayable and showable items without deriving the distinction has answered a question about content with a question about inventory.

MCQ 29. Remedial - proposition 7 and the numbering

Which one of the following is correct about proposition 7 of the *Tractatus*?

- A. It is rendered identically in the Ogden and the Pears-McGuinness translations, so no attribution is needed.
- B. It is elaborated in a series of subordinate remarks numbered 7.1 to 7.4 that qualify its scope.
- C. It stands uncommented and alone, and its two standard translations differ, so the rendering should be named.
- D. It states that propositions about ethics and religion are false, since they fail to describe any fact.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Ogden gives "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent" and Pears-McGuinness "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence"; the difference is exactly why the rendering must be flagged.
- **B:** Incorrect: there is no proposition 7.1. The decimal system means n.1 comments on n, and Wittgenstein deliberately supplies no comment on 7.
- **C:** Correct: it is the single uncommented proposition of the book, and naming the translation is the cheapest provenance mark available in this clause.
- **D:** Incorrect: ethical claims are not factual propositions at all, which is a different and more respectful verdict than declaring them false.

Examiner trap 29: Writing "7.1" is an immediate signal to a specialist examiner that the text has not been handled directly. When unsure of any wording, cite the decimal number instead of the sentence.

MCQ 30. Remedial - the *Tractatus* and the verification principle

Which one of the following correctly states the relation between the *Tractatus* and the verification principle?

- A. The *Tractatus* states the verification principle and the Vienna Circle merely restated it in a clearer form.
- B. The *Tractatus* asks whether a proposition depicts a possible situation, while verificationism asks whether it can be empirically checked.
- C. The *Tractatus* rejects the verification principle by name and offers meaning as use in its place.
- D. The *Tractatus* accepts the verification principle for empirical statements and rejects it for mathematical ones.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Circle drew an empiricist criterion of significance out of Tractarian resources; the transformation is theirs, and attributing it to the text is a marked error.
- **B:** Correct: possible depiction and empirical checkability are different tests, and the difference is why "The Absolute is perfect" and "there is an undetectable object" fail for different reasons in the two systems.
- **C:** Incorrect: meaning as use belongs to the *Philosophical Investigations* and to Topic 08, and the *Tractatus* nowhere discusses the Circle's principle.
- **D:** Incorrect: no such split appears; mathematical propositions are treated as equations that show rather than say, not as exceptions to a verification criterion.

Examiner trap 30: This is the single most common way of ending a Topic 06 answer inside Topic 07. Draw the boundary in one sentence and stop.

MCQ 31. Remedial - the attribution boundary

Which one of the following belongs to this syllabus clause rather than to another owner?

- A. Moore's act/object distinction, which blocks the identification of a sensation with its object.
- B. Moore's naturalistic fallacy, which charges that goodness has been identified with a natural property.
- C. Wittgenstein's family resemblance, which explains how a general term can apply without a common essence.
- D. Strawson's theory of persons, which treats the concept of a person as logically primitive.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it is the instrument of "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903), a printed limb of this clause, and it is also what Russell takes over for sense-data.
- **B:** Incorrect: the naturalistic fallacy belongs to *Principia Ethica* (1903) and to ethics - same author, same year, different subject, and not printed in this clause.
- **C:** Incorrect: family resemblance is a doctrine of the later philosophy and belongs to Topic 08, along with language-games and the private-language argument.
- **D:** Incorrect: Strawson's persons belong to Topic 11; he appears here only as the author of one objection to the theory of descriptions.

Examiner trap 31: This clause names three thinkers and seven doctrines, which makes attribution itself examinable. Losing a mark by importing Moore's ethics is avoidable in a single clause of scope-setting.

MCQ 32. Remedial - how far descriptions support atomism

Which one of the following correctly states the strength of the link between the theory of descriptions and logical atomism?

- A. The theory of descriptions entails logical atomism, since eliminating a description exhibits an atomic fact.
- B. The theory of descriptions is independent of logical atomism, since the two belong to different phases of Russell's work.
- C. The theory of descriptions refutes logical atomism, since contextual definition shows that no expression designates a simple.
- D. The theory of descriptions supports logical atomism by removing pseudo-constituents, without proving that analysis terminates.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: eliminating an apparent constituent shows what is *not* there; it neither exhibits a simple nor demonstrates that a final base exists.
- **B:** Incorrect: the two are closely connected - 1905 supplies the technique that the 1918 programme applies - and both questions in 2018 and 2024 turn on that connection.
- **C:** Incorrect: contextual definition applies to incomplete symbols, not to genuine names, so it leaves the possibility of designating simples entirely open.
- **D:** Correct: it separates grammatical subjects from genuine logical constituents and so makes the atomist search reasonable, while leaving termination, identification and exhaustiveness unproved.

Examiner trap 32: Both 2018 Q4(c) and 2024 Q3(a) ask *how* the one leads to the other. Asserting entailment is the standard overclaim; "supports but does not prove" is the sentence that earns the assessment mark.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answers for Philosophy Paper I. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the printed anomalies the repository ledger flags. The 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below - including the three supporting parts owned by other topics - follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger. Moore and Russell are cited by **paper and year**; the *Tractatus* is cited by **decimal proposition number**, and where a translation is quoted the translator is named. Interpretive disputes - the standard ineffability reading against the resolute reading of 6.54, whether logical constructions are genuine phenomenalist reductions, whether the theory of descriptions is a quantificational device or a deeper account of apparent names - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **14 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus - **joint-highest** with Rationalism and Existentialism - and it owns **at least one part in every year**. All fourteen are solved in full below, followed by **three supporting routed parts** that name the trio but are owned by Topics 03 and 08, and **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the exam: **Moore** owns five parts, **Russell** owns six, and **early Wittgenstein** owns three, so a candidate who prepares only the *Tractatus* has prepared roughly a fifth of the clause.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does he apply... Is he justified?" - an application followed by an explicit verdict with reasons
Core issue	That one structural error generates the whole family of philosophical problems
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: derive the distinction, apply it to three problem-families, then assess
Ideal thesis	Every decisive philosophical problem is an attempt to say what can only be shown
Non-negotiables	The derivation from the picture theory; 4.1212; the ladder at 6.54; the two readings; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

Thesis. The distinction is not one doctrine among others in the *Tractatus* but a diagnostic instrument: applied across philosophy, it reveals that the decisive problems share a single structure - each attempts to state a condition of stating.

The derivation. A proposition depicts by sharing logical form with a possible situation. To depict that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form; but every picture already has logical form, and a regress threatens any attempt. Hence "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212).

The application, in three families. *Metaphysics* tries to state the form of the world - "there are objects" - and produces nonsense (*unsinnig*) rather than falsehood. *Logic* tries to state its own truths as substantive claims, whereas tautologies are senseless (*sinnlos*) and show the scaffolding of the world (6.124). *Ethics and aesthetics* try to state value, which lies outside the world (6.41-6.421); "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical" (6.522).

The single way. Each family attempts the same illegitimate move, so the correct method is not to answer these questions but to show that the questioner has given no meaning to certain signs (6.53).

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Justified as a diagnosis, because it is derived rather than stipulated and unifies problems previously treated as unrelated. CAUTION: Not fully justified as a doctrine, since the *Tractatus*'s own propositions fail its test - 6.54 concedes the ladder - and the standard ineffability reading and the resolute reading of Diamond and Conant still divide over whether anything remains to be shown.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question contains the word "single", so the answer must produce a *unification*, not three separate applications.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis two lines; derivation four; three families six; single way two; verdict four.

- **Structure:** derive -> apply across three families -> state the unification -> grade the verdict.
- **Doctrine:** logical form as presupposed by all depiction; *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*; value outside the world.
- **Evidence:** 4.1212, 6.124, 6.41-6.421, 6.522, 6.53, 6.54.
- **Distinction:** nonsense is not falsehood, and senselessness is not nonsense.
- **Criticism:** self-application, with the two readings named rather than merged.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2018 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: How is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How is X related to Y... give reasons" - a stated relation, defended, and bounded
Core issue	Whether descriptions support, entail or merely accompany atomism
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the technique, the ontological pay-off, and the exact limit of the support
Ideal thesis	Descriptions make atomism reasonable by removing pseudo-constituents; they do not prove it
Non-negotiables	The three conjuncts; "genuine constituent" as the operative notion; the 1918 residue; the honest limit

Independent model answer

Thesis. The theory of descriptions is the working demonstration that analysis can remove an apparent constituent of a proposition; logical atomism is the ontology one is entitled to expect if that removal can be carried out systematically. The relation is therefore **evidential support**, not entailment.

The technique. "The F is G" is analysed as $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$. The phrase "the F" is an **incomplete symbol**: it has no meaning in isolation, is given a contextual definition, and disappears under analysis. What remains are universals and logical apparatus.

The bridge to atomism. Atomism holds that the world consists of facts, that atomic facts contain no further facts as constituents, and that analysis terminates in **logical, not physical, atoms** - "the last residue in analysis" (1918). Descriptions supply the method by which a residue is reached in a particular case: they separate grammatical subjects from **genuine logical constituents**, which is exactly the discrimination atomism needs.

Why the support falls short of proof. ANALYSIS: Removing one class of pseudo-constituents does not show that every analysis terminates, does not identify the simples, and does not establish that reality is exhaustively atomic. Russell's own inventory shifted, and he admitted negative facts as a truth-making cost.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Descriptions are the scalpel; atomism is the anatomy the surgeon expects to find. The instrument has proved permanent; the anatomy was never completed - which is why the honest answer states support and withholds entailment.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "give reasons" converts this from a description into an argument about strength of connection. Naming the connection *support*, *not entailment* is the marks-bearing move.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis three lines; technique four; bridge five; limit four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** state the relation -> the technique -> the bridge -> the limit -> the verdict.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; contextual definition; atomic facts; logical residues.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" (1905); the 1918 lectures and the "last residue" formulation.
- **Distinction:** genuine constituent against grammatical subject.
- **Criticism:** no proof of termination; unfixed simples; the negative-fact cost.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2019 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why is it called..." - justify a label, both halves of it
Core issue	What is <i>common-sense</i> about the method and what is <i>realist</i> about the content
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the method, the content, and what the label does not license
Ideal thesis	The label is earned by a method of comparison and by the content of the truisms, not by an independently argued metaphysics
Non-negotiables	The truisms; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; the hands proof; the qualification that realism is a result

Independent model answer

Thesis. Both halves of the label are earned, but by different things: "common sense" describes Moore's **method**, and "realism" describes the **content** of what that method defends.

Why "common sense". In "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore lists ordinary propositions - that he has a body, that the earth existed for many years before his birth, that there are other human beings with bodies - and claims to *know* them, adding that very many others know propositions of the same kind. He then separates **knowing that a proposition is true** from **knowing its correct analysis**, so that unresolved difficulty about what a material object is cannot be used to deny that we know we have hands. The method is comparison: a philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies.

Why "realism". The propositions defended include the existence of a body, of the earth before one's birth and of other human beings - items whose existence does not consist in being perceived. The 1939 lecture makes this explicit by glossing "external" as "things met with in space" and proving that at least two such things exist.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The realism is a **result**, not a premiss: Moore offers no theory of perception, leaves the relation between sense-data and material objects unsettled, and supplies no neutral measure by which the comparison of certainties could be adjudicated. WRONG: Nor is "common sense" an appeal to popular opinion - the list is a philosophical proposal and is contestable.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The label is accurate provided both qualifications are stated; without them it suggests a systematic realist metaphysics that Moore never wrote.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "why is it called" question is a definition question in disguise. Justify each word of the label separately, then say what the label does not license.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis two lines; common sense six; realism four; qualification four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** split the label -> method -> content -> qualification -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** truisms; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; things met with in space.
- **Evidence:** 1925 and 1939 papers, kept separate.
- **Distinction:** popularity against ordinary knowledge; result against premiss.
- **Criticism:** no neutral measure of certainty; no theory of perception.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2020 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically discuss the following statement by Moore: "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically discuss" a quotation - locate it, decode it, then assess
Core issue	Why the identification is not merely false but self-contradictory
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: paper and target, the decoding of "self-contradictory", the act/object argument, the residual
Ideal thesis	The idealist must deploy the very distinction he claims makes no difference
Non-negotiables	1903 <i>Mind</i> ; <i>esse est percipi</i> ; act and object; transparency; the bounded conclusion

Independent model answer

Location. The sentence is from "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*, 1903), and its target is the equation **to be is to be perceived (*esse est percipi*)** as it functions in Berkeleyan idealism.

Why the mistake is a mistake. The idealist inference requires that a sensation and its object be one thing. Moore argues that they cannot be: the sensations of blue and of green must have something **in common**, since both are sensations, and must **differ**, since their objects differ. On the identity thesis there is only one item in each, so nothing is available to play both roles. Hence "consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either".

Why it is self-contradictory. The claim is that "Blue exists" and "Both blue and consciousness exist" say the same thing. But the second statement is formed by **conjoining two distinct items**. To assert that the two statements have the same content, the speaker must already possess and use the distinction whose significance he denies. The identification therefore cannot be stated without presupposing its own falsity.

The diagnosis. Consciousness is **transparent** or diaphanous: attention passes through the act to the object, so the act seems elusive. **ANALYSIS:** Elusiveness is not absence, and the argument above does not depend on isolating the act introspectively.

Assessment. **ANALYSIS:** The charge bites hardest against a strict **identity** formulation. An idealist who claims that blue is *dependent on* consciousness without being identical with it has not been convicted of contradiction - he has been deprived of the argument he had. **ANALYSIS:** And the distinction, once drawn, shows only that the object is not constituted by the act; unperceived existence needs a further argument.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the examiner has printed a specific charge - *self-contradictory* - and the answer must explain that word, not merely paraphrase the sentence.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: location two lines; the mistake five; the self-contradiction five; diagnosis two; assessment four.

- **Structure:** locate -> the structural argument -> decode "self-contradictory" -> transparency -> residual.
- **Doctrine:** act/object; common and variable elements; diaphanousness.

- **Evidence:** *Mind*, 1903; the blue-green-consciousness sentence.
- **Distinction:** identity against dependence.
- **Criticism:** the dependence formulation survives; unperceived existence is not established.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2020 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: "The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of the above statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Write a note... in the light of the above statement" - the quotation controls the structure
Core issue	What an atomic fact is, once "atomic" has been defined by analysis rather than by size
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: decode the quotation, give the structure of atomic facts, the molecular layer, the cost
Ideal thesis	Atomism is a claim about where analysis stops, not about how small things are
Non-negotiables	"Last residue in analysis"; particular + quality or particulars + relation; truth-functionality; negative facts

Independent model answer

Decoding the quotation. Three phrases carry the doctrine. "Last residue **in analysis**" makes atomism a claim about a **method**: an atom is whatever survives when analysis has removed every complexity. "**Logical**... not physical" locates the atoms among the constituents of facts - particulars, qualities and relations - not among small bodies. And "my doctrine" signals an ontology read off a **logic**, not off a physics.

The structure of an atomic fact. An atomic fact contains **no other facts as constituents**. It is either monadic - a particular exemplifies a quality, as in "this is red" - or relational, as in "this is to the left of that". ANALYSIS: It plainly *has* constituents; what it lacks is facts among them, and reading "atomic" as "partless" is as damaging as reading it as "microscopic".

Fact and proposition. Facts are **truth-makers**, not truth-bearers: a fact is not true, a proposition is. A true atomic proposition corresponds to an atomic fact, and the two share logical structure - names correspond to objects and the arrangement of names to the arrangement of objects. Molecular propositions are **truth-functions** of atomic ones, so no fact in the world answers to "and" or "or".

The cost. ANALYSIS: True negations such as "Socrates is not alive" appear to require something to make them true, and Russell reluctantly admits **negative facts**. The admission adds absences to the inventory, and he accepts it to preserve a direct truth-making relation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Atomic facts are the logical terminus of a method rather than an inventory Russell claims to have completed; the programme's method is durable, its base was never fixed, and the negative-fact concession shows the price being paid openly.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a quotation-controlled question is graded on whether the quoted words are actually used. Decode the phrases before expounding the doctrine.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: decoding five lines; structure four; fact and proposition four; cost three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** decode -> structure of the atomic fact -> the language-world correspondence -> cost -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** analysis-relative atomism; monadic and relational facts; isomorphism; truth-functionality.
- **Evidence:** the 1918 lectures and the quoted sentence.
- **Distinction:** truth-maker against truth-bearer; logical against physical; atomic against partless.
- **Criticism:** negative facts; unfixed simples.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2021 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: What are the main arguments put forward by Moore in his paper "A Defence of Common Sense" to prove that there are possible propositions about the world that are known to be true with certainty? Do you think Moore's arguments provide a sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic against the possibility of knowledge? Give reasons in support of your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: expound the arguments, then rule on sufficiency with reasons
Core issue	Whether a comparison of certainties can answer a sceptical argument
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: three arguments, the deductive form of 1939, the objection, three replies, a graded verdict
Ideal thesis	Sufficient as a redistribution of burden, insufficient as a refutation
Non-negotiables	The list; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; the three conditions of proof; the question-begging objection

Independent model answer

The three arguments of the 1925 paper. *First*, the **list of truisms**: that there exists a living human body which is his body, that it has existed continuously on or near the earth, that the earth existed for many years before he was born, that there have existed many other human beings with bodies. Moore asserts not merely that these are true but that he **knows** them, and adds the second-order claim that very many others know propositions of the same kind - which converts the defence from a report of personal confidence into a claim about a shared epistemic position.

Second, the **level distinction**: knowing that a proposition is true is one question, and knowing its correct **analysis** is another. Whether a material object is a substance, a class of appearances or something else may remain unsettled without disturbing the knowledge that one has two hands. The sceptic who argues from analytic difficulty to ignorance commits a confusion of levels.

Third, the **comparison of certainties**: since an argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards, a valid argument whose conclusion is less credible than its premisses are is one that has refuted a premiss. Moore's claim is that no sceptical premiss has ever been more certain than the truism it is used to deny.

The 1939 continuation. "Proof of an External World" turns the same strategy into an explicit deduction, with three stated conditions - the premiss must differ from the conclusion, must be known rather than believed, and must entail it - while conceding that the premiss cannot itself be *proved*.

The sceptic's objection. The proof begs the question: the second condition is exactly what the sceptical argument denied.

Three replies, and the verdict. Moore's own reply is comparative: he need not establish the premiss from neutral ground, only show that it outweighs its rivals. **ANALYSIS:** A dialectical reply, developed by later defenders, holds that the proof shows the *cost* of scepticism. **ANALYSIS:** **CAUTION:** A third and different diagnosis - that such propositions function as framework certainties rather than ordinary knowledge-claims - belongs to *On Certainty* and to Wittgenstein's later philosophy, not to Moore.

Verdict. **ANALYSIS:** **Sufficient** as a redistribution of dialectical burden: the sceptic must now defend his premisses instead of assuming that abstract premisses defeat perceptual ones. **Insufficient** as a refutation: no neutral measure of comparative certainty is supplied, so a sceptic who denies that Moore knows the truism has been outweighed rather than shown to be irrational.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question says "arguments", plural, and then asks a yes-or-no question. Three named arguments and an explicitly graded verdict are what the wording demands.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: three arguments twelve lines; the 1939 continuation three; objection two; replies four; verdict four.

- **Structure:** three arguments -> the deductive form -> objection -> three replies -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** truisms and the second-order claim; the level distinction; comparative certainty; the three conditions.
- **Evidence:** 1925 and 1939 papers, correctly separated.
- **Distinction:** outweighing an argument against refuting it.
- **Criticism:** the missing neutral measure, stated as the reason for the "insufficient" half.
- **Owner control:** *On Certainty* named in a clause and left to Topic 08.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2021 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement - "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"What does he mean... critically discuss" - exposition with translation discipline, then assessment
Core issue	Why the "must" is a logical consequence and not a counsel of prudence or reverence
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the translation, the derivation, what falls silent, the ladder, the two readings
Ideal thesis	Silence follows from the account of sense; the alternative to silence is not error but noise
Non-negotiables	Naming the translation; 4.1212; 6.53; 6.54; the standard/resolute split; no proposition 7.1

Independent model answer

The sentence. This is proposition 7, in the Ogden translation; Pears-McGuinness render it "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence". ANALYSIS: Proposition 7 is uncommented and stands alone - there is no 7.1 - and naming the rendering matters because the two differ.

What it means. The "must" is **logical**, not prudential. A proposition has sense by depicting a possible situation through shared logical form. Where there is no possible situation to depict, an utterance does not become risky or imprecise; it fails to be a proposition at all. There is therefore nothing to be careful about and nothing to get wrong.

What falls on the silent side. Logical form itself, since any depiction of it would presuppose it - "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212). The existence of objects. The propositions of logic, which are senseless (*sinnlos*) and show the scaffolding of the world. And value: "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41); "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42); "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical" (6.522).

The method that follows. 6.53 states the corollary: say nothing except what can be said, and whenever someone attempts a metaphysical statement, demonstrate that he has given no meaning to certain signs.

Critical discussion. ANALYSIS: The doctrine is not a dismissal: ethical claims are not declared **false**, and they are not declared unimportant. CAUTION: But it is self-applying. The *Tractatus*'s own sentences fail its test, and 6.54 concedes it - the reader who understands them recognises them as nonsensical and throws away the ladder. The **standard** reading treats this as an honest acknowledgment that something manifests itself; the **resolute** reading of Diamond and Conant denies that any ineffable truth remains. ANALYSIS: The graded verdict is that silence is correctly derived, while the status of the derivation itself remains the book's unresolved problem.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: most scripts treat proposition 7 as a mood. Establishing that the "must" is logical is the single move that separates a strong answer from a competent one.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: sentence and translation three lines; meaning four; what falls silent five; method two; criticism five.

- **Structure:** name the translation -> derive the "must" -> list the silent side -> 6.53 -> the ladder and the two readings.
- **Doctrine:** sense as depiction; showing; value outside the world.
- **Evidence:** 4.1212, 6.41, 6.42, 6.522, 6.53, 6.54, 7.

- **Distinction:** not-sayable against false; *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*.
- **Criticism:** self-application, with both readings named and a ruling given.

Solved PYQ 8 · 2022 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: What is Bertrand Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it ultimately end in establishing atomic theory of meaning? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part in ten marks: state the method, then trace its terminus
Core issue	How a method of paraphrase generates an ontology and a theory of meaning
Scope boundary	Ten marks: method in three moves, terminus in two, one qualification
Ideal thesis	The method is the exposure of logical form; its terminus is the atomic base it presupposes
Non-negotiables	Grammatical against logical form; descriptions; constructions; atomic and molecular propositions; the honest limit

Independent model answer

The method. Russell's logical analysis rests on one principle: **grammatical form need not be logical form**. It proceeds in three moves. First, **contextual elimination** - a definite description is an incomplete symbol and is replaced by existence, uniqueness and predication, so that "The F is G" becomes $(Ex)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$. Second, **construction** - where a philosopher would infer an unknown entity, Russell substitutes a construction out of known ones, following his supreme maxim of 1914. Third, **resolution** - every remaining complex proposition is exhibited as a truth-function of simpler ones.

The terminus. Applied without remainder, the method must stop somewhere. Its stopping point is the **atomic proposition**, which states an **atomic fact** containing no other facts as constituents - a particular exemplifying a quality, or particulars in a relation. Meaning is therefore atomistic: the significance of any sentence is fixed by the atomic propositions into which it resolves and the truth-functional operations applied to them, since the connectives name nothing.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The method makes this terminus reasonable rather than proved: Russell never identified the simples, admitted negative facts as a truth-making cost, and found belief-contexts resistant to truth-functional treatment.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the words "ultimately end in establishing" invite an overclaim. The mark is earned by tracing the route *and* refusing the entailment.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: method five lines; terminus four; qualification two.

- **Structure:** principle -> three moves -> terminus -> limit.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; constructions; truth-functional resolution.
- **Evidence:** 1905, 1914 and 1918.
- **Distinction:** meaning fixed by atoms against meaning conferred by connectives.
- **Criticism:** unidentified simples; negative facts; belief-contexts.

Solved PYQ 9 · 2022 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: a yes/no on the difference, then an explanation of a relation
Core issue	That logical form is the universal case of which pictorial forms are the species
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the ontology in brief, the contrast, the relation, and the consequence
Ideal thesis	Logical form is what every picture must share with reality; it therefore makes the language-world relation internal
Non-negotiables	1.1 and the states-of-affairs ontology; 2.18 and 2.182; the medium/universal contrast; showing

Independent model answer

Yes - the two differ, and the difference is one of generality. In the *Tractatus* the world is "the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1); a fact is the existence of states of affairs, each a combination of objects. A proposition is a **logical picture**: its elements are correlated with objects, and its arrangement depicts a possible arrangement of them, so it is true if the situation obtains and false if it does not - meaningful either way, because a **possible** configuration is presented.

Pictorial form (Form der Abbildung) is what a picture must share with reality in order to depict it **in its own medium**. A spatial model shares spatial form with what it models; a musical score shares acoustic form with the music. Such a picture can depict only what shares its particular form.

Logical form (logische Form) is the most abstract structural commonality - what **every** picture, in any medium, must share with reality (2.18). Every picture is therefore a **logical** picture (2.182), though not every picture is spatial or musical, and a proposition can depict **any** fact whatever because logical form is the universal medium of representation.

How logical form defines the relation. Because logical form is common to the proposition and to the fact, language and world are not two domains needing an external bridge. The relation is **internal**: sharing form is constitutive of the proposition's being a picture at all, rather than a correlation set up by convention or causation.

The consequence. ANALYSIS: Logical form is not itself a depictable fact - any picture of it would already employ it. It therefore **shows** itself in every meaningful proposition and cannot be **said** (4.1212), which is where the picture theory hands over to the saying/showing distinction.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the second half of the question is a separate demand. An answer that contrasts the two forms and stops has answered half the paper.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: ontology and picturing five lines; pictorial form three; logical form four; the relation three; consequence three.

- **Structure:** ontology -> picturing -> pictorial form -> logical form -> internal relation -> showing.
- **Doctrine:** correlation of elements; depiction of a possible situation; universality of logical form.
- **Evidence:** 1.1, 2.18, 2.182, 4.1212.
- **Distinction:** medium-specific against universal; internal against external relation.
- **Criticism:** the indescribability of logical form, stated as a consequence rather than a defect.

Solved PYQ 10 · 2023 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

Question: Why according to Russell is the proposition - "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why is it problematic... critically discuss" - state the problem, the solution, then the rival
Core issue	That an apparently referring subject-term has nothing to refer to
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: three rejected options, the analysis, the puzzles, Strawson
Ideal thesis	The sentence is false, not meaningless, because the analysis is quantificational
Non-negotiables	The three rejected answers; the three conjuncts; scope; Strawson 1950 with a ruling

Independent model answer

The problem. The sentence is grammatically impeccable and is understood by every competent speaker, yet there is no present King of France. If its subject-term is a **name**, then either the sentence is meaningless, or it is about a non-existent object, or the name denotes something unidentifiable. Russell rejects all three: we plainly understand the sentence; Meinong's subsisting objects inflate the ontology and, in the case of the round square, threaten non-contradiction; and no alternative denotatum survives inspection.

The solution. "The present King of France" is an **incomplete symbol** - no meaning in isolation, given a contextual definition, and eliminated on analysis. The sentence asserts $(\text{Ex})[\text{Kx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Ky} \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ \text{Bx}]$: at least one present King of France, at most one, and he is bald. The **existence** conjunct is false, so the whole conjunction is **false** - not meaningless, and committed to no ghostly monarch.

What this also solves. *Negative existentials*: "the present King of France does not exist" is the denial of an existence-and-uniqueness claim and needs no denotation. *Excluded middle*: "the King of France is not bald" is **false** when the description takes wide scope (**primary occurrence**) and **true** when the negation does (**secondary occurrence**), so the apparent failure is a scope ambiguity.

The rival. CAUTION: Strawson's "On Referring" (*Mind*, 1950) holds that a speaker **presupposes** rather than asserts existence, so that when the presupposition fails the question of truth or falsity does not arise. ANALYSIS: Russell can reply that a logic requires truth-conditions and that truth-value gaps carry their own costs. The durable verdict is that Strawson describes ordinary **use** better and Russell describes **logical form** better; the two are rival analyses rather than a refutation.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question asks *why it is problematic*, so the three rejected options must appear before the analysis; otherwise the solution has no problem to solve.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: problem five lines; solution four; further puzzles four; rival four.

- **Structure:** problem and three rejected answers -> analysis -> puzzles -> rival -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; existence, uniqueness, predication; scope.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" 1905; Strawson 1950.
- **Distinction:** false against meaningless; assertion against presupposition.
- **Criticism:** Strawson, with an explicit ruling instead of a bare mention.

Solved PYQ 11 · 2024 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms, knowledge of which is a matter of common sense? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Arguments plus assessment, in ten marks
Core issue	The structure of the 1925 defence, compressed
Scope boundary	Ten marks: three arguments in outline, one qualification, one verdict
Ideal thesis	The arguments establish a burden-shift, not a refutation of scepticism
Non-negotiables	The list; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; WRONG: not popularity

Independent model answer

Three arguments. *First*, the **list**: in "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore sets out ordinary propositions - that he has a body, that the earth existed for many years before his birth, that there are other human beings with bodies - asserts that he **knows** them, and adds that very many others know propositions of the same kind. *Second*, the **level distinction**: knowing that a proposition is true is a different question from knowing its correct **analysis**, so unresolved difficulty about what a material object is cannot be converted into ignorance that one has hands. *Third*, the **comparison of certainties**: a philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies, and Moore claims none has ever been.

Critical assessment. WRONG: The doctrine is not an appeal to majority belief; the list is a philosophical proposal and is contestable. ANALYSIS: More seriously, the comparison presupposes that certainty can be weighed across ordinary and philosophical propositions without a neutral measure, which Moore does not supply. The arguments therefore shift the burden of proof onto the sceptic without demonstrating that he is irrational.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: ten marks and two demands. Three named arguments in outline, then one real criticism, is the correct allocation; the 1939 proof belongs in a closing clause at most.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: three arguments eight lines; assessment four.

- **Structure:** list -> level distinction -> comparative certainty -> assessment.
- **Doctrine:** truisms; knowing against analysing.
- **Evidence:** the 1925 paper, kept separate from 1939.
- **Distinction:** ordinary knowledge against popular opinion.
- **Criticism:** the missing neutral measure.

Solved PYQ 12 · 2024 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Explain Russell's notion of incomplete symbols. Also explain how this notion leads to the doctrine of logical atomism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two explanations, the second a route rather than a claim of entailment
Core issue	How a semantic device becomes an ontological programme
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the notion, the worked case, constructions, atomism, assessment
Ideal thesis	Incomplete symbols supply the technique; constructions apply it; atomism names the expected residue
Non-negotiables	Definition and test; the three conjuncts; the supreme maxim; atomic facts; the honest limit

Independent model answer

The notion. An **incomplete symbol** has **no meaning in isolation** but contributes systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs, and it **disappears on analysis**. It is defined **contextually** - by rules giving the meaning of whole sentences containing it - a technique Russell takes from *Principia Mathematica*. The test is simple: does the expression survive analysis as a constituent of the proposition? WRONG: "Incomplete" does not mean "meaningless"; that is the misreading the theory exists to prevent.

The worked case. "The F is G" is analysed as $(\text{Ex})[\text{Fx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Fy} \rightarrow \text{y} = \text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Gx}]$ - existence, uniqueness, predication. "The present King of France is bald" is therefore **false**, not meaningless, and no subsisting object is required. Three puzzles fall together: negative existentials, the apparent failure of excluded middle, which is resolved as a **scope** ambiguity between primary and secondary occurrence, and the failure of substitutivity in George IV's curiosity about the author of *Waverley*.

The first extension: constructions. The same contextual technique is applied to ontology. Russell's **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** (1914) directs us to "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities". Physical objects become classes of actual and possible sense-data; nations become patterns of individual behaviour; numbers become classes of equinumerous classes; points become convergent classes of volumes. Nothing extra is posited, and ordinary sentences remain true.

The second extension: atomism. If pseudo-constituents can be removed and inferred entities replaced, what remains when analysis is complete? Russell's answer is **atomic facts** - containing no other facts as constituents, structured as a particular with a quality or particulars in a relation - stated by **atomic propositions**, with all other propositions their truth-functions. The atoms are "the last residue in analysis", and they are **logical, not physical**.

Assessment. FACT: The route is genuine: one technique, applied to propositions and then to ontology, generates the whole programme. ANALYSIS: But it is support, not entailment. The analysis does not prove that every analysis terminates, does not identify the simples, and does not establish exhaustive atomism; negative facts are admitted as a cost; belief-contexts resist truth-functional treatment; and Strawson offers a rival account of descriptions. Incomplete symbols are the scalpel; logical atomism is the anatomy the scalpel was cutting toward - and the anatomy was never completed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "leads to" is the examiner's word, and it is deliberately weaker than "entails". Trace the route in stages and then say precisely how strong the link is.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: notion five lines; worked case five; constructions five; atomism five; assessment six.

- **Structure:** notion -> worked case -> constructions -> atomism -> graded assessment.
- **Doctrine:** contextual definition; the three conjuncts; the supreme maxim; atomic facts and truth-functions.
- **Evidence:** 1905, 1914, 1918; George IV and *Waverley*.
- **Distinction:** incomplete symbol against meaningless expression; support against entailment.

- **Criticism:** unfixed simples, negative facts, belief-contexts, Strawson.

Solved PYQ 13 · 2025 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss in the context of the theory" - the formal analysis is obligatory
Core issue	Whether an empty description makes a sentence meaningless or false
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the problem, the notation, the verdict, one scope remark
Ideal thesis	False, not meaningless, and with no Meinongian object
Non-negotiables	Incomplete symbol; the three conjuncts in notation; Meinong named; the scope point

Independent model answer

The problem. The sentence appears to be **about** something - a golden mountain - and nothing answers to that phrase. If the phrase were a name, the sentence would either be meaningless or would commit us to a non-existent object of the kind **Meinong** admitted; the golden mountain is his own stock example.

The analysis. "The golden mountain" is an **incomplete symbol**: it has no meaning in isolation and disappears on analysis. The sentence asserts $(\text{Ex})[\text{Gx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Gy} \rightarrow \text{y} = \text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Hx}]$ - there is at least one golden mountain, at most one, and it is very high.

The verdict. The existence conjunct is **false**, so the whole conjunction is **false**. The sentence is therefore neither meaningless nor about a subsisting entity, and asserting it commits us to nothing.

Scope. ANALYSIS: "The golden mountain is not very high" is **false** on the **primary occurrence**, where the description takes wide scope, and **true** on the **secondary occurrence**, where the negation does - so the apparent conflict with excluded middle is an ambiguity of scope rather than a defect in logic.

Point. Grammatical form is not logical form: the apparent name was a quantifier in disguise, and analysing it removes an ontological commitment we never had reason to accept.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: this is the clearest case in the clause where the directive **requires notation**. A purely verbal treatment is marked down however fluent it is.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: problem four lines; analysis three; verdict two; scope two; point two.

- **Structure:** problem -> notation -> verdict -> scope -> general point.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; existence, uniqueness, predication.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" 1905; Meinong named as the target.
- **Distinction:** false against meaningless.
- **Criticism:** implicit in the scope remark, which pre-empts the excluded-middle objection.

Solved PYQ 14 · 2025 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Present an account... with reference to this statement" - the quotation must organise the answer
Core issue	How the act/object distinction blocks <i>esse est percipi</i>
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: paper and target, the comparison argument, transparency, the bounded result
Ideal thesis	The identification of act with object is what idealism needs and what the comparison denies
Non-negotiables	1903 <i>Mind</i> ; <i>esse est percipi</i> ; common and variable elements; diaphanousness; the four-part boundary

Independent model answer

Location and target. The sentence is from "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*, 1903). Its target is the principle **to be is to be perceived (*esse est percipi*)**, which requires that the object's being be nothing over and above its being perceived - and therefore that the sensation and its object be one thing.

The argument the sentence states. Every sensation contains an **act of awareness** and an **object of awareness**. The quoted sentence identifies which is which: blue and green are the **objects**, and consciousness is what "both sensations have in common". If awareness were identical with its object, then the sensations of blue and of green would share **nothing**, since their objects differ, and would differ in **nothing further**, since there is nothing else in them. Both consequences are false, so awareness and object are distinct.

The diagnosis. Consciousness is **transparent** or diaphanous: when we introspect the sensation of blue what we find is the blue, and the act is looked *through* rather than at. ANALYSIS: This explains why the conflation is so tempting; it is not itself a premiss of the refutation, and the argument above does not require isolating the act introspectively.

The result, exactly bounded. FACT: *Esse est percipi* is not established, because the identity it requires has been denied on structural grounds. ANALYSIS: It does **not** follow that any object exists unperceived: distinguishing object from act shows only that the object is not **constituted** by the act. ANALYSIS: No theory of perception is offered - Moore leaves the relation between sense-data and material objects unsettled. FACT: And **Absolute Idealism is untouched**, since it argues from internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations, not from the perceptual equation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Moore removes idealism's most economical argument rather than idealism itself; the act/object distinction nevertheless became foundational for analytic philosophy, and Russell took it over for sense-data.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "with reference to this statement" means the quotation must do structural work. Use it to name the common and the variable element, then build the argument from that naming.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: location three lines; argument six; diagnosis three; boundary five; verdict two.

- **Structure:** locate -> target -> comparison argument -> transparency -> four-part boundary -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** act and object; common and variable elements; diaphanousness.
- **Evidence:** *Mind* 1903 and the printed sentence.
- **Distinction:** blocking an argument against proving a metaphysics; Berkeleyan against Absolute idealism.
- **Criticism:** the four things the paper does not achieve, stated as the boundary rather than as a complaint.

SUPPORTING ROUTED PARTS THAT NAME THE TRIO BUT ARE OWNED ELSEWHERE

ANALYSIS: These three parts are **not** counted among the fourteen owned questions. Each names Moore, Russell or Wittgenstein while being routed by the repository ledger to another syllabus item. They are given here with the **contribution this clause makes** and an explicit boundary, so that a candidate can supply the Topic 06 material without answering the wrong question.

Routed part 1 · 2018 · Q3(a) · 20 marks · owned by Empiricism (Topic 03)

Question: How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real? How do Moore and Russell react to Berkeley's view in this regard? Do you find any difference between Moore's reaction and Russell's one? Discuss.

What Topic 03 owns: Berkeley's own establishment of immaterialism - the attack on abstract ideas, the collapse of the primary/secondary distinction, *esse est percipi*, and the role of God's perception.

What this clause contributes - the comparative half. ANALYSIS: **Moore's reaction is epistemic and distinction-drawing.** In "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903) he denies the identification of the act of awareness with its object, so that *esse* cannot be defined as *percipi*; and in the common-sense papers he protects ordinary certainty by comparing credentials rather than by constructing a rival system. He offers no replacement theory of perception. ANALYSIS: **Russell's reaction is logical and reconstructive.** He accepts that what is directly given is sense-data, and then **rebuilds** the physical world as a **logical construction** out of actual and possible sense-data, under the supreme maxim of 1914; and he removes apparent names by **contextual analysis**, so that ontological commitment is decided by logical form rather than by grammar. He also breaks with Berkeley's nominalism by admitting acquaintance with **universals**.

The difference, in one sentence. ANALYSIS: Both reject Berkeley's conclusion, but Moore blocks the argument and leaves the analysis open, whereas Russell concedes the starting point and supplies a replacement architecture - which is why Moore's answer is a refutation of an inference and Russell's is a reconstruction of the world.

Boundary. WRONG: Do not expound Moore's or Russell's systems at length in an answer whose principal demand is Berkeley's establishment of immaterialism; the comparative half is one substantial paragraph.

Routed part 2 · 2023 · Q4(c) · 15 marks · owned by Later Wittgenstein (Topic 08)

Question: What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.

What Topic 08 owns: meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance, forms of life, the private-language argument, and the positive account that replaces the *Tractatus*.

What this clause contributes - the "from". FACT: An accurate statement of what was abandoned: sense as the depiction of a possible situation through shared logical form; **bipolarity**; the postulation of simple objects and logically independent elementary propositions; the claim that every proposition is a truth-function of elementary ones; and the general form of the proposition at 6. ANALYSIS: It also contributes the **internal pressures** that are honestly locatable inside the early programme: the **colour-exclusion** problem - "this patch is red all over" and "this patch is blue all over" are incompatible although neither appears to be a truth-function of the other - which Wittgenstein addressed in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (*PAS Supp.*, 1929) and whose proposed analysis he quickly abandoned; the absence of any uncontested example of a simple object; and the resistance of belief-contexts to truth-functional treatment.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: Colour exclusion diagnoses a pressure; it does **not** by itself establish meaning as use. WRONG: Do not import language-games into a Topic 06 answer, and do not present the *Tractatus* as having anticipated its own replacement.

Routed part 3 · 2025 · Q3(a) · 20 marks · owned by Later Wittgenstein (Topic 08)

Question: "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. **Printed wording:** the unmatched opening quotation before **logical structure** is visible in the official English line and is retained.

What Topic 08 owns: the later account of meaning, and the assessment of whether the transition is an improvement.

What this clause contributes - an accurate portrait of the "ideal language" being rejected. FACT: The *Tractatus* does not propose an ideal language as a reform of ordinary language; it holds that "all the propositions of our everyday language, just as they stand, are in perfect logical order", and that analysis would **reveal** a structure ordinary language already has. ANALYSIS: Stating this prevents the commonest distortion in transition answers - that early Wittgenstein wanted to replace ordinary language with a calculus. What he held was that sense requires a determinate underlying logical form, that the general form of the proposition fixes the limits of the sayable, and that what falls outside is nonsense.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: The printed quotation is a summary of the later position, not a sentence of Wittgenstein's *Tractatus*. WRONG: Do not attribute it to the early work, and do not let a Topic 08 answer become a Topic 06 exposition; two paragraphs of accurate early doctrine are the correct contribution.

Six original questions in the UPSC idiom - two at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20 - with complete model answers inside the declared bands. These are learner practice, not past papers.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain what Russell means by calling a definite description an "incomplete symbol", and state the test by which such a symbol is identified. Discuss.

Independent model answer

The notion. A symbol is **incomplete** when it has **no meaning in isolation** yet contributes systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs, and when it **disappears** once the sentence is correctly analysed. Such a symbol is never defined in its own right; it is given a **contextual definition** - a rule that supplies the meaning of whole sentences containing it. Russell takes the technique from the practice of contextual definition in *Principia Mathematica*.

The test. Ask whether the expression survives analysis **as a constituent of the proposition**. "The author of *Waverley*" does not: the analysed sentence contains existence, uniqueness and predication, and no corresponding constituent. A genuine name would survive.

The consequence. Because no constituent corresponds to the phrase, a sentence containing it commits us only to whatever satisfies its predicates. That is why an empty description yields **falsity** rather than meaninglessness, and why the device is an instrument of ontological economy.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: "Incomplete" must never be read as "meaningless": the phrase is meaning-contributing in every context and meaningless only on its own - a distinction on which the entire theory depends.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between senseless (*sinnlos*) and nonsensical (*unsinnig*) propositions in the *Tractatus*, and explain why the distinction matters. Discuss.

Independent model answer

Senseless (*sinnlos*). Tautologies and contradictions are **well formed** and belong to the symbolism, but they say nothing about the world. A tautology is true under every truth-condition and excludes nothing; a contradiction is false under every truth-condition and excludes everything. They are the **limiting cases** of proposition-formation, and they **show** the scaffolding of logic (4.461-4.4611, 6.124).

Nonsensical (*unsinnig*). A metaphysical pseudo-proposition - "the Absolute is perfect", "there are objects" - fails the conditions of sense altogether. It does not depict any possible situation, so it never entered logical space and there is nothing for it to exclude.

Why the distinction matters. ANALYSIS: First, it fixes the status of logic: logical truth is not a body of very general facts but an absence of factual content, which is why "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251). ANALYSIS: Second, it prevents the commonest misreading of the *Tractatus*. If the two labels were synonyms, Wittgenstein would appear to dismiss logic and metaphysics on one and the same ground, and his position would collapse into the Vienna Circle's verificationism - a criterion he did not hold, since his test is whether a possible situation is depicted, not whether a statement can be empirically checked.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Both are ways of failing to say something, and they fail at different points: one inside the symbolism, one before it.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "Moore's method protects ordinary knowledge at the cost of leaving philosophy without a criterion." Examine this statement.

Independent model answer

What the statement gets right. Moore's defence rests on a **comparison of certainties**: an argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies. That is a genuinely protective device, and it is effective because a valid argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards. But the comparison requires a scale, and Moore supplies none. He tells us that "I have a body" is more certain than any sceptical premiss; he does not tell us how the comparison is conducted or what would settle a dispute about it. The 1939 lecture concedes the point in its own way by admitting that the premiss cannot be **proved**, only known.

What the statement understates. ANALYSIS: Two things. First, Moore's method is not merely defensive: the **knowing/analysing distinction** is a substantive epistemological thesis - that propositional knowledge can be secure while the analysis of its constituents is unfinished - and it has to be argued against, not merely disliked. Second, the absence of a criterion is partly the point. Moore's target is precisely the assumption that a philosophical premiss automatically outranks a perceptual one, and demanding a neutral criterion for the comparison would reinstate the priority he is challenging.

The residual. CAUTION: The dispute cannot be closed from within Moore's resources. Later work re-describes propositions like "here is a hand" as **framework certainties** on which doubt itself depends rather than as ordinary knowledge-claims - a diagnosis that vindicates Moore's practice while abandoning his description of it, and one that belongs to Wittgenstein's later philosophy rather than to Moore.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The statement is accurate as a description of what Moore does not provide and misleading as an account of what he was trying to provide: he offers a rule of precedence rather than a criterion of knowledge, and the honest assessment is that the rule works dialectically while remaining unjustified by anything more basic.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Assess the claim that Russell's logical constructions reduce the physical world to sense-data.

Independent model answer

The claim as usually stated. On the strong reading, Russell's 1914 programme is a **phenomenalist reduction**: a physical object simply *is* a class of actual and possible sense-data, so that talk of tables is, at bottom, talk of appearances.

What supports it. The **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** directs us to "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities", and Russell's worked case is precisely the construction of a physical object out of classes of sense-data from various points of view. Since acquaintance in this phase reaches sense-data, memory data, introspective data and universals - and not physical objects - the base is unavoidably phenomenal.

What tells against it. ANALYSIS: Three things. First, the maxim is **methodological**: it says what to try before positing, not what reality contains. Second, Russell's parallel constructions are not phenomenal at all - nations from patterns of individual behaviour, numbers from classes of equinumerous classes, points from convergent classes of volumes - which shows the technique to be general rather than a doctrine about perception. Third, the construction requires **possible** sense-data, and unrealised possibilities are not "known entities" in the sense the maxim demands, so the reduction does not straightforwardly succeed on its own terms.

The provenance point. ANALYSIS: Russell's base did not stay fixed. Later **neutral monism** reconceives mental and physical items in terms of neutral events, and it is not a printed limb of this clause. Reading the 1914 constructions as Russell's permanent metaphysics conflates two phases.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The claim is defensible about the **1914 construction of physical objects** and indefensible about **logical constructions as such**. The durable contribution is the technique of contextual construction and the ontological economy it delivers; the phenomenalist inventory was a phase, and its strain point - possible sense-data - was visible from the beginning.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "The *Tractatus* is a book that succeeds by failing." Critically examine this claim with reference to the doctrine of saying and showing.

Independent model answer

The claim, stated precisely. The *Tractatus* offers an account of the conditions under which a sentence has sense, derives from it a boundary around the sayable, and then discovers that its own sentences lie outside that boundary. The claim under examination is that this is the book's method rather than an accident: it succeeds as an elucidation precisely by failing as doctrine.

The derivation that produces the failure. A proposition depicts only by sharing **logical form** with a possible situation. To depict that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form; but every picture already has logical form, and each attempted statement of form would need its own form stated. Hence "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212). The result extends to the existence of objects, to the logical truths that show the scaffolding of the world (6.124), and to value, since "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41) and "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42).

Why this convicts the book. Every sentence of the *Tractatus* is about logical form, objects, the general form of the proposition and the limits of language. None depicts a contingent state of affairs, so by its own criterion none says anything. Wittgenstein does not conceal this: **6.54** states that anyone who understands him recognises his propositions as nonsensical, having used them as steps to climb beyond them, and must then throw away the ladder.

The two ways of reading the outcome. CAUTION: On the **standard ineffability** reading the failure is productive: something genuinely manifests itself - logical form, value, the mystical - which no proposition could carry. On the **resolute or therapeutic** reading of Diamond and Conant, no ineffable truths remain; the sentences are plain nonsense, and the therapy is the reader's coming to see that he was never given a doctrine.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The claim is largely correct, with one refinement. As a **diagnosis** the book succeeds: it unifies metaphysics, logic and value under one structural error - the attempt to state a condition of stating - and 6.53 converts that diagnosis into a method. As **doctrine** it fails, and the failure is self-inflicted rather than imposed by critics. What the slogan obscures is that "succeeding by failing" is intelligible on only one of the two readings: the standard reading can say what survives, whereas the resolute reading must say that nothing does.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The *Tractatus* succeeds as an activity - philosophy as clarification, 4.112 - and fails as a set of theses; an honest answer names the reading it relies on before calling the failure fruitful.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the logical atomism of Russell with that of the early Wittgenstein, and assess whether the two should be treated as one doctrine.

Independent model answer

Why the comparison is necessary. The syllabus prints "Logical Atomism" once, and both men held a doctrine of that name in the same years - Russell's lectures were delivered in 1918, the *Tractatus* manuscript was completed in 1918, and Russell's own preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein. The temptation to treat them as one doctrine is therefore built into the material, and resisting it is where the marks are.

Axis 1 - what the atoms are. For Russell the atoms are **particulars together with qualities and relations**, identified in this phase through **acquaintance**, with sense-data as the standard case. For Wittgenstein the atoms are **objects**: logical simples whose intrinsic nature is never specified and which are characterised entirely by their **possibilities of combination**, which in turn fix logical space (2.013).

Axis 2 - how they are reached. Russell's programme is simultaneously logical and **epistemological**: analysis is guided by what we can be acquainted with, which is why the theory of descriptions is needed to preserve the Principle of Acquaintance. Wittgenstein's argument is **transcendental-logical**: simples are required because determinate sense requires a final base, and no example is offered because none is needed for the argument.

Axis 3 - independence. Russell acknowledges the logical independence of atomic propositions somewhat loosely. Wittgenstein insists on it **strictly** (2.061, 4.211), because the truth-table method must be exhaustive - and it is exactly this strict commitment that **colour exclusion** later pressures.

Axis 4 - negative facts. Russell reluctantly admits **negative facts** as truth-makers for true negations, treating the ontological cost as the price of a direct truth-making relation. Wittgenstein needs no such category: the **totality** of obtaining states of affairs also determines which possible states do not obtain (2.05), and the logical constants are not representatives (4.0312).

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The two share a form of words and a historical moment, and they share the thesis that the world is factual and that analysis reveals a base. They differ on what the base contains, on how it is reached, on how strictly independence is held, and on whether negation requires an ontological correlate. ANALYSIS: The practical consequence is that the standard criticisms do not transfer: an objection to sense-data does not touch Tractarian objects, and colour exclusion presses on Wittgenstein's strict independence rather than on Russell's looser version.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: They should be treated as **two atomisms with a common ancestry**, not as one doctrine held by two men. A script that merges them will attribute negative facts to the *Tractatus* or sense-data to Wittgenstein's objects - and either error is immediately visible to a specialist examiner.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Prerequisite check before using this block

ANALYSIS: Nothing below is needed to write a complete answer to any of the fourteen routed questions. Use this block only after the Basic sessions and the practice sections are secure, and then only for a **single closing clause** in a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer. The material is drawn from the Advanced dossier's three optional depth modules for this clause, together with the two pieces of technical background that the owner file classes as **optional orientation unless a question explicitly asks for them**.

A1. Descriptions after the textbook solution CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Is Russell's theory of descriptions merely a quantificational trick that happens to dispose of empty subject-terms, or a deeper account of how apparent names disappear under analysis?
- **Competing interpretations.** The **orthodox quantificational** reading takes the analysis at face value as a contribution to logical form. A **denoting-complex resistance** reading holds that something in the original phrase is lost when it is dissolved into quantifiers. A later **neo-Russellian** reading stresses logical **scope** and ontological economy as the theory's permanent contributions, independently of the account of names.
- **Extra objection.** Propositional-attitude cases and negative existentials continue to create pressure even after the analysis: the scope apparatus multiplies readings, and it is not obvious that ordinary speakers have the ambiguity the theory attributes to them.
- **Counter-reply.** Even with leftover problems, the theory decisively handles existence and uniqueness puzzles without populating the world with nonexistent objects, which was the task it was set.
- ANALYSIS: **Safe 15/20 use.** One evaluative sentence after the standard "present King of France" analysis: *the machinery of scope has outlived the account of names it was first used to defend*.
- WRONG: **What not to over-study.** Do not turn a Russell answer into symbolic logic beyond the level needed to display structure.
- ANALYSIS: **Promotion trigger.** If a future question asks directly whether descriptions **are** names, or whether Russell's solution **fully** resolves denoting problems, this module becomes core.

A2. Logical constructions or phenomenal reduction? CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Are Russell's logical constructions genuine reductions of physical objects to sense-data, or methodological devices for a safer ontology?
- **Competing interpretations.** A **strong phenomenalist** reading takes the construction literally. An **epistemic-structural** reading holds that what is preserved is structure rather than material. A **logical-housekeeping** reading treats the maxim as advice about theoretical commitment, avoiding any claim about what tables ultimately are.
- **Extra objection.** Building the world from private sense-data invites **solipsism**, since each construction is anchored in one perceiver's base.
- **Counter-reply.** Russell can answer that constructions are public-theoretical reconstructions aimed at explanatory economy, not a denial of common objects or of science.
- ANALYSIS: **Safe 15/20 use.** Only where a question links constructions to atomism or to knowledge of the external world; one clause, not a paragraph.
- WRONG: **What not to over-study.** Do not import the whole history of phenomenalism or the sense-datum debates of the mid-century.
- ANALYSIS: **Promotion trigger.** A future question asking explicitly whether Russell is a phenomenalist, or how constructions avoid solipsism.

A3. What "showing" finally means CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Are logical form, ethics and the mystical **ineffable truths** that can somehow be grasped, or does Wittgenstein mean that such sentences are to be discarded as ladder-like nonsense?
- **Competing interpretations.** The **standard ineffability** reading; the **resolute or therapeutic** reading of Cora Diamond and James Conant; and a **mixed** reading on which "showing" marks conditions of sense without converting them into additional facts.
- **Extra objection.** If the book's own theses are nonsense, it self-destructs and cannot have established the boundary it draws.
- **Counter-reply.** That self-undermining is either deliberate ladder-work or a method for forcing the reader to see the limit between a meaningful proposition and what can only be manifested.
- ANALYSIS: **Safe 15/20 use.** One closing paragraph in a saying/showing answer; do not let it swamp the picture theory, which is what the question usually rewards.
- WRONG: **What not to over-study.** Do not overplay mystical readings unless the question invites them.
- ANALYSIS: **Promotion trigger.** A future question asking directly whether the *Tractatus* is self-refuting, or what Wittgenstein means by "showing".

A4. Russell's paradox and the theory of types ANALYSIS: - background, not a printed limb

- **What it is.** The class of all classes that are not members of themselves both is and is not a member of itself. Russell's response is a **theory of types**: expressions are stratified so that a class cannot significantly be said to belong to itself, and a sentence violating the stratification is not false but **ill-formed**.
- **Why it appears here at all.** It supplies the intellectual habit behind the doctrine of incomplete symbols: a symbol may be **eliminable** rather than referential, and a well-formed-looking string may fail to express a proposition. The technique of **contextual definition** in *Principia Mathematica* is the same technique the theory of descriptions applies to "the F".
- ANALYSIS: **Owner boundary.** The owner file classes Russell's paradox, the theory of types, logicism and later neutral monism as **optional orientation unless a question explicitly asks for them**. They are **not** printed limbs of item 6. One sentence of background is the maximum a Topic 06 answer should spend.
- WRONG: **Never** substitute a discussion of types for the analysis of descriptions in a question about incomplete symbols.

A5. Solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the limit ANALYSIS:

- **What the text says.** "The limits of my language mean the limits of my world" (5.6). "What the solipsist *means* is quite correct, only it cannot be *said*: it shows itself" (5.62). The subject "does not belong to the world; rather, it is a limit of the world" (5.632), and the eye is not in the visual field (5.633). Strictly maintained, "solipsism coincides with pure realism" (5.64).
- **Why it is here.** It is the most vivid illustration of the say/show boundary: an apparently metaphysical thesis is neither affirmed nor denied but relocated to the side of what shows itself.
- ANALYSIS: **Owner boundary.** The owner file treats solipsism and the metaphysical subject as **optional** in this clause. Use them to illustrate the boundary; do not build a section on them. **WRONG:** The critique of the private language argument belongs to Topic 08 and must not be retrojected into the *Tractatus*.

A6. Moore's naturalistic fallacy - named here only to be excluded WRONG:

- **What it is.** In *Principia Ethica* (1903) Moore argues that goodness is a simple, unanalysable, non-natural property, and that any definition of "good" in natural terms commits the **naturalistic fallacy**; the **Open Question Argument** is the test - for any proposed natural definition, "but is that good?" remains an open question.
- **WRONG: Why it is not owned here.** It belongs to **ethics**, and the owner file states explicitly that it is not printed in this clause. Same author, same year as "The Refutation of Idealism", entirely different subject.
- ANALYSIS: **The only legitimate use.** A single clause of scope-setting in an answer on Moore, distinguishing the epistemological Moore of this syllabus item from the ethical Moore of *Principia Ethica*. Anything more is answering a question the paper did not ask.

Conceptual links - not current-affairs items

ANALYSIS: This clause has **no live current-affairs linkage**, and manufacturing one would be a fault rather than a merit. Its live connections are conceptual and internal to the syllabus: forward to **Logical Positivism** (Topic 07), which transforms Tractarian resources into an empiricist criterion of significance that the *Tractatus* does not contain; forward to **Later Wittgenstein** (Topic 08), which criticises the early programme from inside; sideways to **Quine and Strawson** (Topic 11), where Strawson's presuppositional account of reference and Quine's holism press on the analytic assumptions of the whole movement; and backwards to **Empiricism** (Topic 03) and **Hegel** (Topic 05), which supply the two idealisms the revolt distinguishes between.

Source trail for this block

Advanced dossier Section 6, optional depth modules 1-3 (descriptions after the textbook solution; logical constructions against phenomenal reduction; what "showing" means), with the short source trail naming Stephen Neale, Peter Hylton, David Pears, P. M. S. Hacker, Cora Diamond and James Conant; the owner file's "Cross-owned or optional" list for Russell's paradox, the theory of types, logicism and neutral monism, for Moore's naturalistic fallacy and Open Question Argument, and for the bounded treatment of solipsism and the metaphysical subject.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Compressed revision notes for the complete topic. They cover every subtopic in the Basic block and preserve the Basic / Optional-Advanced distinction; they do not repeat the teaching introductions. Read them after the sessions, not instead of them. The complete ASCII master flow diagram closes the package.

A. Attribution map - who owns what, and what is not owned at all

- **Seven printed terms, three owners.** Defence of Commonsense - **Moore**, "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925). Refutation of Idealism - **Moore**, *Mind* (1903). Logical Atomism - **Russell** (1918 lectures) **and distinctly Wittgenstein** (*Tractatus*). Logical Constructions - **Russell** (1914). Incomplete Symbols - **Russell**, "On Denoting" (1905) and *Principia Mathematica*. Picture Theory of Meaning - **early Wittgenstein**. Saying and Showing - **early Wittgenstein**, 4.12-4.1212, 6.522, 6.54, 7. The paper prints "Saying and Showing"; retain that wording only when quoting the syllabus.
- MEMORY: **Mnemonic:** Moore **DEFENDS**, Russell **DISSECTS**, Wittgenstein **PICTURES**.
- **Three senses of "analysis":** commitment-clarification (Moore) · quantificational paraphrase (Russell) · resolution into truth-functions of elementary propositions (early Wittgenstein). The word is shared; the method is not.
- WRONG: **Not owned:** the verification principle and the rejection of metaphysics as doctrine (Topic 07) · meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance, private language (Topic 08) · Strawson's positive semantics and theory of persons (Topic 11) · Berkeley's immaterialism as doctrine (Topic 03) · Hegel's Absolute Idealism as doctrine (Topic 05) · **Moore's naturalistic fallacy and Open Question Argument** (ethics) · Russell's logicism, paradox, theory of types and later neutral monism as systems.
- **The target: British Absolute Idealism** - internal relations, degrees of truth, the ordinary world as "appearance" (Bradley, McTaggart). ANALYSIS: Moore's 1903 paper attacks the **Berkeleyan** *esse est percipi* equation, not Absolute Idealism; say which idealism you mean.

B. Chronology and provenance - examiner-checked

- **1893** Bradley, *Appearance and Reality* - the target in place. **1903** Moore, "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*) **and** *Principia Ethica* - same year, different subjects. **1905** Russell, "On Denoting" (*Mind*). **1910-11** "Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by Description" (*PAS*). **1910-13** *Principia Mathematica* - contextual definition. **1912** *The Problems of Philosophy*, Ch. 5 - the Principle of Acquaintance. **1914** *Our Knowledge of the External World* and "The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics" - the supreme maxim. **1918** Russell's lectures (published *The Monist* 1918-19) **and** the completed *Tractatus* manuscript. **1921** German *Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung*. **1922** bilingual *Tractatus*, Latin title suggested by **Moore**, Ogden translation with Ramsey's assistance, checked by Wittgenstein. **1925** "A Defence of Common Sense". **1929** "Some Remarks on Logical Form" - colour exclusion. **1939** "Proof of an External World". **1950** Strawson, "On Referring". **1961** Pears-McGuinness translation. **1970/1980** Kripke, *Naming and Necessity*.
- ANALYSIS: **Three separate Moore papers, three separate arguments** - merging 1925 and 1939 is the commonest error in scripts.
- ANALYSIS: **Never** date the English *Tractatus* 1921. ANALYSIS: **Never** say Russell invented logical atomism unaided - his own 1918 preface credits Wittgenstein.
- ANALYSIS: **Decimal citation is the safest citation in the Western syllabus:** the numbering is identical in every edition and translation. **There is no proposition 7.1.**
- ANALYSIS: **Translation flags:** *Sachverhalt* = "atomic fact" (Ogden) / "state of affairs" (Pears-McGuinness). Proposition 7 = "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent" (Ogden) / "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence" (Pears-McGuinness). 4.5 = "Such and such is the case" (Ogden) / "This is how things stand" (Pears-McGuinness). "Picture theory" is the commentators' label; Wittgenstein writes *Bild* and *abbilden*.

C. Moore - the defence of common sense

- **1925: the list of truisms** - a living human body which is his body; its continuous existence on or near the earth; the earth's existence for many years past; other human beings with bodies - asserted as **known**, plus the second-order claim that many others know propositions of the same kind.
- **Knowing that P is not knowing the analysis of P.** Analytic difficulty about "material object" cannot be converted into ignorance that one has hands: that is a **confusion of levels**.
- **Comparative certainty:** an argument overturns a truism only if **every** premiss is more certain than the truism denied; none has ever been. **Result:** the burden of proof is reversed.
- WRONG: Not popularity, not convention, not infallibility. The list is a philosophical proposal and is contestable.

- ANALYSIS: **Paradox of analysis** (bounded orientation): an analysis is either trivially uninformative or not an analysis of the same concept. No settled Moorean solution; Fregean sense and later accounts of concepts are proposed responses. Use it only to show why analysis is not verbal substitution.
- ANALYSIS: **Limit**: no **neutral measure** of comparative certainty is supplied.

D. Moore - the proof of an external world

- **1939 British Academy lecture**, answering Kant's "scandal to philosophy" charge. **"External" = things met with in space** - the gloss that makes the inference valid.
- **The argument**: here is one hand -> and here is another -> at least two things met with in space exist -> an external world exists. ANALYSIS: The printed order is **right hand first, then left**.
- **Three conditions of a rigorous proof**: premiss **different** from the conclusion · premiss **known**, not merely believed · conclusion **follows**.
- **The concession**: he cannot **prove** the premiss, because he cannot prove he is not dreaming - and a proof requires a *known* premiss, not a *proved* one, or nothing is ever proved.
- **Objection**: begs the question. **Replies**: comparative certainty (Moore's own) · dialectical burden-shift ANALYSIS: · framework or hinge certainty ANALYSIS: CAUTION: - the last from *On Certainty*, **Topic 08**, named in a clause and no more.
- **Verdict**: valid proof, no neutral criterion of knowledge, comparative force - exactly what was claimed.

E. Moore - the refutation of idealism

- **1903, Mind**. Target: **to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)**, which requires sensation and object to be one.
- **Act of awareness** (the **common** element) against **object of awareness** (the **variable** element). On the identity thesis the sensations of blue and green would share nothing and differ in nothing - both false.
- FACT: **The 2025 sentence**: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."
- FACT: **The 2020 sentence**: identifying "Blue exists" with "Both blue and consciousness exist" is a "mistake and a **self-contradictory** mistake" - the speaker must use the distinction he denies.
- **Transparency / diaphanousness**: a **diagnosis** of why the act is overlooked, not a premiss. CAUTION: Later philosophers of mind use the same observation against Moore.
- **Bounded result**: *esse est percipi* blocked FACT: · unperceived existence **not** proved ANALYSIS: · no theory of perception ANALYSIS: · **Absolute Idealism untouched** FACT: · Berkeley's positive system is Topic 03.
- **Moore against Russell on Berkeley**: Moore **blocks the argument** and leaves the analysis open; Russell **concedes the given** and rebuilds the physical world as a logical construction, breaking with Berkeley's nominalism by admitting acquaintance with universals.

F. Russell - incomplete symbols and the theory of descriptions

- **Incomplete symbol**: no meaning in isolation; **contextual definition**; **disappears** on analysis. WRONG: Not "meaningless". **Test**: does the expression survive analysis as a constituent?
- **"On Denoting", Mind, 1905**. (Ex)[Fx & (Ay)(Fy -> y = x) & Gx] - **existence · uniqueness · predication**.
- **Empty description -> the sentence is FALSE**, not meaningless, and no Meinongian object subsists. The **golden mountain** is Meinong's own example.
- **Three puzzles**: negative existentials · excluded middle · substitutivity in attitude contexts (George IV and the author of *Waverley*).
- **Scope: primary occurrence** - description wide, "the King of France is not bald" is **false**; **secondary occurrence** - negation wide, it is **true**.
- CAUTION: **Strawson, "On Referring", 1950**: existence is **presupposed**, not asserted, so the truth question does not arise. A **rival analysis**, not a refutation; Topic 11 owns his positive theory.
- **The general principle established**: grammatical form is not logical form.

G. Russell - acquaintance, description and logical constructions

- **Acquaintance:** direct, presentational, **non-inferential** awareness - sense-data, memory data, introspective data, and **universals** ANALYSIS: (a Platonic concession against Berkeley's nominalism).
- **Knowledge by description:** knowledge *that* exactly one thing is F, plus what is inferred - physical objects, other minds, historical persons, unobservables.
- FACT: **Principle of Acquaintance** (*Problems*, 1912, Ch. 5): "Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted."
- **Six-step argument:** understanding is constituent-grasping -> I grasp only what I meet -> yet I understand propositions about Bismarck -> so either the Principle fails or the item is not a constituent -> descriptions take the second route -> the Principle is preserved. **Bismarck series:** himself · one who met him · one who read of him · "the most long-lived of men".
- **Logically proper names:** only "this" and "that", of what is presently given. ANALYSIS: Ordinary names are **disguised descriptions** - the part **Kripke** destroys (rigid designation).
- FACT: **Supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** (1914): "wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities."
- **Four constructions:** physical object <- classes of actual and possible sense-data · nation <- patterns of individual behaviour · number <- classes of equinumerous classes · point <- convergent classes of volumes.
- WRONG: Constructions are **not fictions**; true things are said about tables and nations. **Strain:** "possible" sense-data are not straightforwardly known; solipsism worry; the base later becomes **neutral events** ANALYSIS: (a different phase, not a printed limb).
- CAUTION: **Sellars, 1956:** the Myth of the Given. **Verdict:** the logical machinery is permanent; the epistemology it served is not.

H. Russell - logical atomism

- **1918 lectures**, published *The Monist* 1918-19; Russell's preface credits the ideas to **Wittgenstein**.
- **World = facts.** ANALYSIS: Facts are **truth-makers**, not truth-bearers; a list of objects does not describe the world.
- **Atomic fact:** contains **no other facts** as constituents - monadic (particular + quality) or relational (particulars + relation). ANALYSIS: It *does* have constituents; "atomic" is not "partless" and not "microscopic".
- FACT: **The 2020 sentence:** "the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of **last residue in analysis** are **logical** atoms and not **physical** atoms."
- **Atomic <-> molecular:** molecular propositions are **truth-functions** of atomic ones, so **no fact answers to "and" or "or"** - the economy that is the point of truth-functionality.
- **Isomorphism:** the true proposition and the fact share logical structure; names <-> objects, arrangement <-> arrangement.
- ANALYSIS: **Negative facts** accepted reluctantly, to preserve a direct truth-making relation; contested. Wittgenstein's **totality** account (2.05) with 4.0312 avoids them.
- ANALYSIS: **Descriptions support atomism without proving it:** no proof of termination, no identification of the simples, no exhaustive atomism. Assess atomism as a **programme**.

I. Early Wittgenstein - ontology and the picture theory

- **1.1** "The world is the totality of facts, not of things." **1.13** the facts in logical space are the world. **2** a fact is the existence of states of affairs. **2.01** a state of affairs is a combination of objects. **2.013** possibility is built into the object. ANALYSIS: *Sachverhalt*: choose Ogden's "atomic fact" or Pears-McGuinness's "state of affairs" and stay with it.
- **Objects** are logical simples characterised by their possibilities of combination; ANALYSIS: **no uncontested example is given** - they are argued for, not exhibited.
- **Proposition = propositional sign + projective relation** (3.11-3.12). Elements <-> objects; arrangement depicts arrangement. **True** if the state of affairs obtains, **false** if not, **meaningful either way** (2.201-2.224).

- **Pictorial form (Form der Abbildung)** - medium-specific: spatial models share spatial form, scores share acoustic form. **Logical form (logische Form)** - universal, the form of **all** representation (2.18); **every picture is a logical picture** (2.182).
- **How logical form defines the language-world relation:** it is **common** to proposition and fact, so the relation is **internal**, not an external convention or causal link.
- ANALYSIS: **Consequence:** logical form is not depictable; it **shows** itself (4.12-4.1212).
- ANALYSIS: "Picture theory" is the commentators' label. WRONG: Never write "language is a picture of the world" without the **logical form** qualification.

J. Early Wittgenstein - sense, logical space and the general form

- **Bipolarity:** sense requires capability of truth **and** of falsity. ANALYSIS: Stronger than **bivalence**. Anchors 4.06, 2.223, 2.224; the term is from *Notes on Logic* (1913).
- **Logical space:** 1.13, 2.11, **3.4** a proposition determines a place, 3.41, 3.42; **4.463** a proposition is "like a solid body that restricts the freedom of movement of others". To understand p is to understand $\neg p$.
- FACT: **4.0312, the fundamental idea (Grundgedanke):** "the logical constants are not representatives". Negation names nothing.
- **General form:** informal **4.5** "this is how things stand" ANALYSIS: (Ogden: "such and such is the case"); formal **6:** [$\bar{p}, \xi, N(\xi)$]. **N = joint negation** (5.502, 5.51): $\neg p = N(p)$; $p \vee q = N(N(p, q))$; $p \& q = N(N(p), N(q))$. Quantification through sets of values of propositional functions (5.52) ANALYSIS: adequacy for infinite domains disputed.
- **What 6 asserts:** every proposition is a truth-function of elementary ones (5) -> one operation generates them all -> one general form -> **logic needs no primitive propositions and no logical objects**, the break with Russell and Frege -> "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251), logic's propositions are tautologies (6.1) -> the **criterion of the sayable**.
- ANALYSIS: **Sinnlos** (*tautology, contradiction - well formed, empty, showing logic's scaffolding, 4.461-4.4611*) **against unsinnig** (metaphysical pseudo-proposition - depicting nothing). **The most tested discrimination in the Tractatus.**
- ANALYSIS: **Four presuppositions:** simples exist · elementary propositions are logically independent (2.061, 4.211) · all propositions are truth-functions (belief-contexts 5.54-5.542) · N handles infinite domains. **Colour exclusion** (1929) pressures the second.

K. Early Wittgenstein - saying, showing and the ladder

- **Said (gesagt):** contingent states of affairs; the propositions of natural science (6.53). **Shown (gezeigt):** logical form; the existence of objects; logical truths and the scaffolding of the world (6.124); the language-world relation; **value**.
- FACT: **4.1212** "What can be shown, cannot be said."
- **The derivation, in five steps:** depiction requires shared logical form -> depicting the sharing needs a standpoint outside logical form -> every picture already has it -> a regress threatens each attempted statement -> therefore form **shows** itself.
- **The limit is drawn in language:** Preface; **5.6** "the limits of my language mean the limits of my world"; 5.61.
- ANALYSIS: **Solipsism, bounded:** 5.62 what the solipsist means is correct but cannot be said; 5.632-5.633 the subject is a **limit** of the world, and the eye is not in the visual field; 5.64 strict solipsism coincides with **pure realism**. Illustration only; the private-language critique is Topic 08.
- **Value:** 6.41 the sense of the world lies outside the world · 6.42 there can be no propositions of ethics · 6.421 ethics is transcendental · **6.522** "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical".
- **6.53** the correct method in philosophy. **6.54** the **ladder**. **7** - name the translation. ANALYSIS: **No 7.1.**
- CAUTION: **Standard ineffability** against **resolute/therapeutic** (Diamond, Conant). Both agree ethics and the mystical are not factual propositions. WRONG: The *Tractatus* does not declare them **false**, and it contains **no verification principle**.

L. Comparisons and the criticism ledger

- **Comparison axes:** target · core tool · ontology · metaphysics · self and subject · legacy. **Name the axis before comparing**, or the answer is two parallel descriptions.
- **The two atomisms.** *Atoms:* Russell - acquainted particulars plus qualities and relations; Wittgenstein - unspecified objects fixed by combinatorial possibility. *Ground:* Russell - logic plus a changing acquaintance epistemology; Wittgenstein - a condition-of-sense argument. *Independence:* loose against **strict**. *Negation:* **negative facts** against the **totality** account. *Expression:* 1918 lectures against the *Tractatus*. ANALYSIS: **Two atomisms with a common ancestry, not one doctrine.**
- **Criticism ledger, by residual.** **Moore** - question-begging; replies comparative and dialectical; **residual: no neutral measure of certainty**. **Russell** - Strawson's presupposition; the vanishing class of logically proper names; negative facts; **residual: no fixed inventory, and a genuine rival analysis of descriptions**. *Tractatus** - ethics not factual; self-application; no exemplified simples; colour exclusion; **residual: the standard/resolute split remains open.**
- **Three different failures.** Moore's gap is **epistemological**, Russell's is **ontological**, and Wittgenstein's concerns the **status of philosophical discourse** itself. Treating them as one failure is the commonest way of losing the assessment mark.

M. Exam craft - directives, architecture, traps and the answer spine

- **Directive decoder:** descriptions questions demand **notation** · quotation questions demand that you **locate the sentence in its paper** · saying/showing questions demand the **derivation** · Moore questions demand the **structure of the reversal** · the 2020 atomism question demands that the **quoted phrases be decoded** · "how is X related to Y" demands **support, not entailment** · comparison demands an **axis**.
- **Architectures.** *10 marks:* problem -> analysis -> result -> point. *15 marks:* frame -> doctrine -> quote -> key move -> result -> assess. *20 marks:* frame -> incomplete symbols -> constructions -> atomism -> assess -> close.
- **Ten-line trap sheet:** "incomplete symbol" is not "meaningless" · the empty description makes the sentence **false** · uniqueness is a conjunct, not decoration · *sinnlos* is not *unsinnig* · bipolarity is not bivalence · "atomic" is neither "physical" nor "partless" · facts are truth-makers, not truth-bearers · Moore refutes an **argument**, not idealism · the *Tractatus* has **no** verification principle · there is **no proposition 7.1**.
- **WRONG: Never write:** that the *Tractatus* was published in English in 1921 · that Wittgenstein said language is a picture of the world without the logical-form qualification · that Russell invented logical atomism unaided · that Moore's naturalistic fallacy belongs to this clause · that Kripke's book appeared in 1970 and his lectures in 1980.
- **Memory chain:** the revolt against Absolute Idealism -> Moore's truisms and the knowing/analysing distinction -> comparative certainty and the two hands -> the act/object distinction and transparency -> incomplete symbols and the three conjuncts -> acquaintance and the Principle -> constructions and the supreme maxim -> atomic facts, truth-functions and negative facts -> facts, objects and the picture theory -> bipolarity, logical space and the general form -> saying, showing, the ladder and silence -> comparison, criticism and craft.
- **Qualified conclusion.** ANALYSIS: The three programmes of this clause are one method used for three incompatible purposes, and each ends by leaving something deliberately unfinished. Moore protects ordinary knowledge by comparing certainties and leaves the analysis of that knowledge open; Russell secures ontological economy by exposing logical form and leaves the inventory of simples open; early Wittgenstein fixes the conditions of sense with a rigour neither of the others attempted and leaves the status of his own book open. Their permanent achievements are correspondingly precise: the burden of proof in epistemology was redistributed, the quantificational analysis of definite descriptions became a permanent instrument, and the account of sense as determinate exclusion within a field of possibilities set the agenda for a century of philosophy of language. Their permanent costs are equally precise: no neutral measure of certainty, no completed base, and no consistent way of stating the boundary the *Tractatus* draws. An answer that states an achievement and its matching cost in the same sentence has understood the clause; an answer that merges the three men has not.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/28: Central claim, the seven printed terms and the one-line answer

CENTRAL CLAIM: A PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEM IS SETTLED BY EXAMINING THE PROPOSITION THAT STATES IT - WHAT IT COMMITS US TO, WHAT ITS LOGICAL FORM ACTUALLY IS, AND WHETHER IT HAS SENSE AT ALL. ANALYSIS REPLACES SYSTEM-BUILDING.

THE THREE GREATS		
G. E. MOORE	B. RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
1873-1958	1872-1970	1889-1951
DEFENDS	DISSECTS	PICTURES
Defence of Commonsense	Logical Atomism	Picture Theory of Meaning
Refutation of Idealism	Logical Constructions	Saying and Showing
	Incomplete Symbols	

SEVEN PRINTED TERMS, THREE OWNERS, ONE JOINTLY LISTED

Defence of Commonsense	MOORE, 1925
Refutation of Idealism	MOORE, Mind 1903
Logical Atomism	RUSSELL 1918 *and distinctly* WITTGENSTEIN, Tractatus
Logical Constructions	RUSSELL 1914
Incomplete Symbols	RUSSELL 1905, Principia Mathematica
Picture Theory of Meaning	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
Saying and Showing	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN, 4.12-4.1212, 6.522, 6.54, 7

THE ONE SHARED INSIGHT, USED THREE DIFFERENT WAYS

GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM	
MOORE	the ordinary judgement is safe; its ANALYSIS is hard, and analytic difficulty does not cancel KNOWLEDGE
RUSSELL	the ordinary sentence misleads; QUANTIFIED form dissolves the pseudo-entity
WITTGENSTEIN	the sentence has sense only by SHARING logical form with a possible situation - and that sharing can never be stated

ANSWER LINE (opens any comparative part):

"The three programmes agree that philosophy proceeds by analysis and disagree about what analysis reaches."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/28: Syllabus verbatim, owner scope and the boundary firewall

SYLLABUS (verbatim, Paper I, Section A, item 6):

"Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein : Defence of Commonsense; Refutation of Idealism; Logical Atomism; Logical Constructions; Incomplete Symbols; Picture Theory of Meaning; Sying and Showing."
NOTE the printed "Sying" - retain when quoting the syllabus, then use the correct doctrine-name SAYING and SHOWING.

OWNS (marks-essential)

Moore: truisms | knowing vs analysing | comparative certainty | hands proof + three conditions | act/object | transparency | the bounded anti-idealist result

Russell: incomplete symbols | descriptions (existence, uniqueness, predication) | three puzzles | primary/secondary occurrence | acquaintance/description + the Principle | logical constructions + the supreme maxim | atomic facts | truth-functions | isomorphism | negative facts | "logical not physical atoms"

Early Wittgenstein: facts not things (1.1) | objects and states of affairs | picture theory | pictorial vs logical form | bipolarity | logical space | general form of the proposition (6) | sinnlos vs unsinnig | saying/showing | ladder (6.54) | 7

ALL FOURTEEN routed 2018-2025 parts

BOUNDED ORIENTATION (only to the depth a printed limb or a PYQ needs)

Moore's paradox of analysis | Russell's negative facts and
universals | colour exclusion (1929) as an internal pressure |
solipsism and the metaphysical subject at 5.62-5.641 |
the standard-vs-resolute reading of 6.54

|
v

NOT OWNED HERE (cross-owned; one bounded clause at most)
verification principle, rejection of metaphysics TOPIC 07
meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance,
private language TOPIC 08
Strawson's positive semantics and persons TOPIC 11
Berkeley's immaterialism as doctrine TOPIC 03
Hegel's Absolute Idealism as doctrine TOPIC 05
NATURALISTIC FALLACY, OPEN QUESTION ARGUMENT MOORE'S
ETHICS (Principia Ethica 1903) - NOT this clause
Russell's logicism, paradox, theory of types, later
neutral monism OPTIONAL

|
v

FIREWALL SENTENCE: this is the only Western clause in which ATTRIBUTION
is itself examinable. A script that writes "Moore and Russell held
that..." without a discriminating clause has already lost a mark.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/28: Chronology rail - the minimum that prevents anachronism

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1893 BRADLEY, Appearance and Reality the target in place
|
1903 MOORE, "The Refutation of Idealism", Mind ACT/OBJECT
1903 MOORE, Principia Ethica SAME YEAR, DIFFERENT SUBJECT
the naturalistic fallacy lives HERE, in ethics
1905 RUSSELL, "On Denoting", Mind DESCRIPTIONS BEGIN
1910-11 Russell, "Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by
Description", Proceedings of the Aristotelian Society
1910-13 Whitehead and Russell, Principia Mathematica - the technique
of CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION that "incomplete symbol" names
1912 Russell, The Problems of Philosophy, Ch. 5 PRINCIPLE OF
ACQUAINTANCE (safe to quote verbatim)
1914 Russell, Our Knowledge of the External World +
"The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics" ... LOGICAL
CONSTRUCTIONS + the SUPREME MAXIM
|
1918 RUSSELL, "The Philosophy of Logical Atomism" - London lectures,
published in The Monist 1918-19. THE PREFACE CREDITS THE IDEAS
TO WITTGENSTEIN. Say so in the exam.
1918 WITTGENSTEIN completes the Tractatus manuscript
1921 GERMAN text: Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung, in Annalen der
Naturphilosophie
1922 BILINGUAL German-English edition, Latin title Tractatus Logico-
Philosophicus - THE TITLE WAS MOORE'S SUGGESTION. Ogden
translation, assisted by Ramsey, checked by Wittgenstein.
NEVER date the English text 1921.
|
1925 MOORE, "A Defence of Common Sense" THE TRUISMS PAPER
1929 Wittgenstein, "Some Remarks on Logical Form", PAS Supp. -
COLOUR EXCLUSION; the only philosophical article besides the
Tractatus published in his lifetime; analysis soon abandoned
1939 MOORE, "Proof of an External World", British Academy HANDS
|
1950 STRAWSON, "On Referring", Mind presupposition
1953 Philosophical Investigations, posthumous TOPIC 08
1956 SELLARS, "Empiricism and the Philosophy of Mind" .. THE GIVEN
1961 PEARLS-McGUINNESS translation of the Tractatus
1970/1980 KRIPKE, Naming and Necessity - lectures 1970, book 1980;
give ONE date, never a merged one
|
v

THREE CHEAP MARKS: the 1903/1925/1939 separation | Russell's 1918
attribution to Wittgenstein | the 1921 German / 1922 bilingual split

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/28: The target, and the three senses of "analysis"

=====

BRITISH ABSOLUTE IDEALISM (Bradley, McTaggart; Hegelian inheritance)
INTERNAL RELATIONS: nothing could be what it is if its relations
were different
DEGREES OF TRUTH: ordinary claims are true only in a degraded sense
APPEARANCE: the world of separate things in space and time is

demoted

|

THE PROVOCATION: if ordinary claims are appearance, a system may correct them WHOLESALE

|

v

+-----+-----+-----+		
MOORE	RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
the order of	internal	the system's own sentences
CONFIDENCE is	relations are	fail the test any sentence
backwards	an artefact of	must pass to have SENSE
	subject-	
	predicate form	
+-----+-----+-----+		

|

v

THREE SENSES OF "ANALYSIS" - the distinction most scripts miss

INPUT	OUTPUT	SUCCESS WHEN
MOORE an ordinary judgement already KNOWN	what the judgement commits us to	the commitments are clear; if not, the KNOWLEDGE stands
RUSSELL a sentence whose surface suggests a suspect entity	a quantified paraphrase in which the apparent name disappears	truth-conditions are preserved and the commitment removed
WITTG. any proposition whatever	resolution into truth-functions of ELEMENTARY propositions	the base of logically independent elementary propositions is reached - a base the text never EXHIBITS

|

v

CONSEQUENCE: the three men can share a slogan and disagree about everything that matters. Russell's descriptions do NOT vindicate Moore's truisms; Moore never accepted that ordinary objects are constructions; Wittgenstein's objects are NOT Russell's sense-data.

|

v

INFLUENCE RUNS BOTH WAYS: Moore's act/object distinction is taken over by Russell for sense-data; Wittgenstein takes variable and quantifier from Russell and Frege and removes their central mistake (4.0312); Russell's 1918 preface credits atomism to Wittgenstein.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/28: Moore 1925 - the list of truisms and the second-order claim

=====

"A DEFENCE OF COMMON SENSE" (in Contemporary British Philosophy, 1925)

|

v

THE LIST (Moore's own examples)

"There exists at present a living human body, which is my body."
"This body has existed continuously on or near the earth."
"The earth has existed for many years past."
"There have existed many other human beings, with bodies."
"I am a human being who has had many experiences."

|

v

THE TWO CLAIMS MADE ABOUT THE LIST

[1] FIRST-ORDER I KNOW these propositions - not believe, KNOW
[2] SECOND-ORDER very many other human beings KNOW propositions of the SAME KIND about themselves
-> the second converts a report of personal confidence into a claim about a SHARED epistemic position, and it is what makes "COMMON sense" the right name

|

v

WHAT THE DOCTRINE IS NOT

NOT the claim that whatever most people believe is true
NOT an appeal to convention
NOT a claim of infallibility - the list is a philosophical proposal and is CONTESTABLE

|

v

WHY A LIST RATHER THAN AN ARGUMENT

Moore does not argue FOR the truisms from something more basic - that would concede they need support from outside. He ASSERTS them, and the size of the list displays how enormous the sceptic's task is:

he must deny not one claim but a whole interlocking body of them.

|

v

ANSWER LINE: "Moore's list is not a survey of opinion but an inventory of what a sceptical argument would have to overturn."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/28: Moore - knowing against analysing, and the paradox of analysis

=====

THE LEVEL DISTINCTION - the load-bearing move of the 1925 paper

+-----+-----+	
KNOWING THAT P IS TRUE	KNOWING THE ANALYSIS OF P
CERTAIN: "I have two hands"	DOUBTFUL: what IS a
pre-philosophical, secure	material object? sense-data?
	a class of appearances? a
	substance? Philosophical
	work proper - MAY REMAIN
	UNFINISHED
+-----+-----+	

|

v

THE FALLACY MOORE NAMES: "you cannot know you have hands because you cannot analyse 'material object'" CONFUSES THE TWO LEVELS

|

v

THREE SCEPTICAL MOVES AND MOORE'S DIAGNOSIS

"the analysis is disputed, so we do not know" confusion of levels

"sense-data are all we are given, so ordinary claims are at best inferences" a real question; it does not SUSPEND the knowledge

"ordinary language is loose, so ordinary claims are imprecise" imprecision in STATING is not doubt ABOUT

|

v

WHY MOORE NEEDED THE DISTINCTION - THE PARADOX OF ANALYSIS (bounded)

If the analysis of "X is a brother" is "X is a male sibling", then EITHER it says the same thing -> trivially uninformative

OR it says something different -> not an analysis of that concept
NO SETTLED MOOREAN SOLUTION. Fregean sense / mode of presentation, and later accounts of concepts and synonymy, are PROPOSED responses.
USE ONLY to show why analysis is not verbal substitution.

OWNER STATUS: method-context, NOT a printed limb.

|

v

HONEST COST: the distinction protects knowledge only if propositional knowledge can be secure while its constituents are unclear - which a sceptic about the given, or anyone who ties understanding to analysis, will deny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/28: Moore - comparative certainty and the reversal of the burden

=====

THE PRINCIPLE

A philosophical argument overturns a truism ONLY IF every premiss of that argument is MORE CERTAIN than the truism it denies.

Moore's empirical claim: NO SUCH PREMISS HAS EVER BEEN PRODUCED.

|

v

THE LOGIC BEHIND IT - a valid argument is a SET OF SCALES

A valid argument transmits credibility BACKWARDS as well as forwards.

If the conclusion is less credible than the premisses are credible, the argument has REFUTED A PREMISS rather than proved its conclusion.

|

THE SCEPTIC'S ARGUMENT

P1 I cannot rule out dreaming
P2 if not, I do not know I have
a body

C so I do not know
abstract | technical | contested

THE TRUISM

"I have a body."

"The earth existed for many
years before I was born."
as certain as anything I have
ever been

|

v

RESULT: THE BURDEN OF PROOF IS REVERSED

The realist no longer owes a proof of the external world from neutral ground; the SCEPTIC owes an explanation of why abstract premisses should be trusted more than ordinary perceptual certainty.

|

v
 THE LIMIT THAT MUST BE WRITTEN
 The principle presupposes that certainty is COMPARABLE across ordinary and philosophical propositions, and Moore supplies NO NEUTRAL MEASURE. A sceptic who simply denies that Moore KNOWS the truism has been OUTWEIGHED, not shown to be irrational.
 |
 v
 LABEL EXPLAINED (2019 Q3(c)): COMMON SENSE from the METHOD; REALISM from the CONTENT of the list - body, earth before my birth, other human beings. THE REALISM IS A RESULT, NOT A PREMISS.

 ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/28: Moore 1939 - the proof, the gloss and the three conditions
 =====
 TARGET: KANT'S CHARGE that it is "a scandal to philosophy" that no satisfactory proof of things outside us has been given
 |
 v
 THE GLOSS THAT MAKES THE INFERENCE VALID
 "EXTERNAL to our minds" = "THINGS MET WITH IN SPACE" - things whose existence does not consist in being experienced
 |
 v
 THE ARGUMENT
 1 Here is one hand. (present perceptual knowledge)
 2 And here is another.
 3 So at least two material things exist.
 4 So an external world exists.
 NOTE: the printed order is RIGHT hand first, THEN left. If unsure, write "holding up first one hand and then the other".
 |
 v
 MOORE'S OWN THREE CONDITIONS FOR A RIGOROUS PROOF
 [1] the premiss must be DIFFERENT from the conclusion
 "here is a hand" != "an external world exists" -> NOT CIRCULAR
 [2] the premiss must be KNOWN, not merely believed or assumed
 "I did know it. It would have been absurd to suggest that I did not know it, but only believed it." -> THE CONTESTED CONDITION
 [3] the conclusion must FOLLOW
 hands are things met with in space -> VALID, given the gloss
 |
 v
 THE CONCESSION, AND WHY IT IS NOT A DEFECT
 Moore CANNOT PROVE the premiss - to do so he would have to prove he is not dreaming, "and that I cannot do".
 A proof requires a KNOWN premiss, not a PROVED one; the contrary demand generates an INFINITE REGRESS in which nothing is proved.
 |
 v
 ANSWER LINE: "The demand to prove every premiss is a demand that no proof of anything could ever meet."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/28: Moore - the question-begging objection and three replies
 =====

THE OBJECTION (and it is serious)

Premiss 1 is exactly what the sceptic put in doubt. If dreaming or deception cannot be excluded, Moore does not KNOW premiss 1, condition [2] fails, and the proof BEGS THE QUESTION.

REPLY 1 - MOORE'S OWN	REPLY 2 - DIALECTICAL	REPLY 3 - THE LATER DIAGNOSIS
He need not prove every premiss he knows. No sceptical premiss is more certain than the ordinary proposition it is used to deny.	The proof is not addressed to a sceptic who has already suspended perceptual knowledge; it shows the COST of scepticism. (Pryor and others)	On Certainty asks whether such propositions are ordinary knowledge-claims at all, or FRAMEWORK / HINGE certainties on which doubt itself depends.
		OWNER NOTE: this is LATER

		WITTGENSTEIN,
		TOPIC 08. One
		clause, never an
		expansion.

-----+

|

v

VERDICT SPINE

FORMALLY VALID yes

NEUTRAL CRITERION OF KNOWLEDGE none supplied

FORCE COMPARATIVE - which is exactly
what Moore claimed for it, and nothing more

|

v

1925 + 1939 = ONE STRATEGY IN TWO TEXTS: compare the credentials of the
competing claims instead of assuming the philosophical claim wins.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/28: Moore 1903 - the target and the act/object distinction
=====

"THE REFUTATION OF IDEALISM", Mind, 1903

|

v

TARGET: ESSE EST PERCIPI - "to be is to be perceived"

For the idealist inference to work, the object's BEING must be
nothing over and above its BEING PERCEIVED. The sensation and its
object must therefore be ONE THING, or the object a mere constituent
of the act.

|

v

THE DISTINCTION

ACT OF AWARENESS	OBJECT OF AWARENESS
consciousness	blue, green, this sound
THE SAME in every sensation	DIFFERENT in each sensation
= THE COMMON ELEMENT	= THE VARIABLE ELEMENT

-----+

|

v

THE IDEALIST'S ERROR: conflating [1] and [2] - treating the object as
IDENTICAL with, or CONSTITUTED BY, the act of awareness.
If the sensation of blue IS just the blue, then blue cannot exist
unperceived -> idealism.

|

v

WHY THE DISTINCTION IS NOT MERELY INTROSPECTIVE

Moore does not simply report detecting two items. He argues that the
identification makes EXPERIENCE UNINTELLIGIBLE: two sensations must
have something IN COMMON (both are sensations) and must DIFFER in
something (their objects differ). On the identity thesis there is
only ONE item in each, so nothing is available to play both roles.

|

v

ANSWER LINE: "What varies cannot be what stays the same."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/28: Moore - the two printed sentences, decoded
=====

THE 2025 SENTENCE (Q3(c))

"Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and
consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different
from either."

READ IT AS A LABELLING OF THE ARGUMENT:

"blue ... green" THE VARIABLE ELEMENT = the OBJECTS

"which both sensations have in common" THE COMMON ELEMENT =
consciousness

"is different from either" .. THE CONCLUSION: act != object

|

v

THE 2020 SENTENCE (Q2(b))

"If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as
to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake
and a SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY mistake."

|

WHY SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY - four steps, and this decoding is the mark

[1] the claim is that the two statements say the SAME THING

[2] the second statement is formed by CONJOINING TWO DISTINCT ITEMS,
blue and consciousness

[3] to assert the identity of content, the speaker must already
POSSESS AND USE the very distinction whose significance he denies
[4] therefore the identification is not merely false; it CANNOT BE
STATED without presupposing its own falsity

|
v

THE RESIDUAL - state it, and the "critically" half is done
The charge bites hardest against a strict IDENTITY formulation. An
idealist who says instead that blue is DEPENDENT ON consciousness
without being IDENTICAL with it has not been convicted of
contradiction - he has been DEPRIVED OF THE ARGUMENT HE HAD.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/28: Moore - transparency, and the exact boundary of the result

=====

TRANSPARENCY / DIAPHANOUSNESS

Introspect the sensation of blue and what you find is THE BLUE. The
act is elusive - "as if it were diaphanous". Attention passes
THROUGH the act to the object.
ROLE: a DIAGNOSIS of why the conflation is tempting.
NOT A PREMISS of the refutation - the comparison argument does the
refuting.
CONTESTED: later philosophers of mind use the same observation to
argue that there is NOTHING beyond the object to introspect. Moore's
reply must be that ELUSIVENESS IS NOT ABSENCE.

|
v

THE BOUNDARY - the half of the answer most scripts omit
ACHIEVED the IDENTITY route from object to act is BLOCKED, so
esse est percipi is NOT ESTABLISHED
NOT ACHIEVED .. that any object exists UNPERCEIVED
NOT ACHIEVED .. a positive THEORY OF PERCEPTION - the relation
between sense-data and material objects is left open
NOT ACHIEVED .. a refutation of ABSOLUTE IDEALISM, which rests on
internal relations and the incompleteness of finite
determinations, NOT on the perceptual equation
NOT ACHIEVED .. a refutation of Berkeley's whole philosophy - his
positive system is TOPIC 03

|
v

MOORE vs RUSSELL ON BERKELEY (the comparative half of 2018 Q3(a))
MOORE epistemic and DISTINCTION-DRAWING: denies the
identification, protects ordinary certainty, offers NO
replacement theory of perception
RUSSELL logical and RECONSTRUCTIVE: accepts that what is given is
sense-data, rebuilds physical objects as LOGICAL
CONSTRUCTIONS, removes apparent names by CONTEXTUAL
ANALYSIS, and breaks with Berkeley's NOMINALISM by
admitting acquaintance with UNIVERSALS
ONE-SENTENCE DIFFERENCE: Moore blocks the argument and leaves the
analysis open; Russell concedes the starting point and supplies a
replacement architecture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/28: Russell - incomplete symbols and contextual definition

=====

DEFINITION

An INCOMPLETE SYMBOL has NO MEANING IN ISOLATION, contributes
systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs,
and DISAPPEARS on analysis. It is given a CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION -
a rule supplying the meaning of WHOLE SENTENCES containing it.
SOURCE OF THE TECHNIQUE: contextual definition in Principia
Mathematica (1910-13).

|
v

THE TEST TO APPLY IN THE EXAM
Does the expression SURVIVE ANALYSIS as a CONSTITUENT of the
proposition?
"the author of Waverley" does NOT survive -> incomplete
"Scott", as a genuine name would survive

|
v

THE COMMONEST ERROR
"INCOMPLETE" DOES NOT MEAN "MEANINGLESS". The phrase is
systematically meaning-CONTRIBUTING; it has no meaning ON ITS OWN.
Write the words "in isolation" and the error cannot occur.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE FOR ONTOLOGY

Because the phrase contributes NO CONSTITUENT, the truth of a sentence containing it commits us to nothing beyond the existence of things satisfying the PREDICATES. This is what makes the device an instrument of ONTOLOGICAL ECONOMY, and it is the bridge to CONSTRUCTIONS (panel 19) and ATOMISM (panels 20-22).

|
v

OPTIONAL BACKGROUND ONLY: Russell's PARADOX and the THEORY OF TYPES supply the habit behind the doctrine - a symbol may be ELIMINABLE rather than referential, and a well-formed-looking string may fail to express a proposition. NOT a printed limb. One sentence maximum.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/28: Russell - the theory of descriptions, in notation

=====

THE PROBLEM: "The present King of France is bald."

Grammatically impeccable. Understood by every competent speaker.
And there is no present King of France.

|

THREE ANSWERS RUSSELL REJECTS

- (a) THE SENTENCE IS MEANINGLESS but we understand it, and we can argue about it
- (b) IT IS ABOUT A NON-EXISTENT OBJECT THAT SUBSISTS MEINONG's route; it populates the world with golden mountains, and the ROUND SQUARE threatens non-contradiction
- (c) THE PHRASE DENOTES SOMETHING ELSE no candidate survives

|
v

THE ANALYSIS - the phrase is ELIMINATED, not interpreted

"The F is G"

=

(Ex)[Fx AND (Ay)(Fy -> y = x) AND Gx]

EXISTENCE UNIQUENESS PREDICATION
at least one at most one it is G

|
v

WORKED CASE - "THE GOLDEN MOUNTAIN IS VERY HIGH" (2025 Q1(d))

(Ex)[Gx & (Ay)(Gy -> y=x) & Hx]

The EXISTENCE conjunct is FALSE -> the whole conjunction is FALSE
-> NOT meaningless, and NO golden mountain need subsist
The golden mountain is MEINONG'S OWN STOCK EXAMPLE - name him.

|
v

UNIQUENESS IS THE CONJUNCT MOST OFTEN DROPPED. Without it the analysis renders "the" as "a", and the definite article's entire contribution disappears.

|
v

THE GENERAL PRINCIPLE ESTABLISHED

GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM. The task of philosophy is to reveal the logical form hidden by language.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/28: Russell - the three puzzles, and what each was blocking

=====

PUZZLE	WHAT WENT WRONG BEFORE	WHAT THE ANALYSIS GIVES
NEGATIVE EXISTENTIALS "The present King of France does not exist"	to deny that something exists you seem to have to REFER to it first, which grants the very existence you deny	the denial is the NEGATION of an existence-and-uniqueness claim; no reference is attempted, so nothing is granted. TRUE.
EXCLUDED MIDDLE	if "the F is G" is neither true nor false when there is no F, bivalence appears to fail	it is FALSE; and its negation, parsed with the NEGATION taking wide scope, is TRUE. The appearance of

		failure is a	
		SCOPE AMBIGUITY.	
+-----+-----+-----+			
SUBSTITUTIVITY IN	if "the author of	the description	
ATTITUDE CONTEXTS	Waverley" = Scott, then	is NOT A NAME	
George IV wished	George IV wished to know	and denotes	
to know whether	whether Scott was Scott	nothing in the	
Scott was the	- trivial	required sense,	
author of Waverley		so no	
		substitution	
		licence exists.	
+-----+-----+-----+			

|
v

THE ADVERTISEMENT: ONE DEVICE, THREE INDEPENDENT PROBLEMS. A theory that does this is not an ad hoc repair - SAY SO EXPLICITLY.

|
v

NOT ONE OF THE THREE: the problem of UNIVERSALS. That is a separate issue in Russell's philosophy, handled by his REALISM about universals. Substituting it shows the list has been half-remembered.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/28: Russell - scope, and the Strawson objection

=====

PRIMARY AND SECONDARY OCCURRENCE - "The King of France is not bald"

PRIMARY (description takes WIDE scope):

there is exactly one King of France AND he is not bald -> FALSE

SECONDARY (negation takes WIDE scope):

it is NOT the case that (there is exactly one King of France and he is bald) -> TRUE

ONE sentence, TWO logical forms. Ambiguity of SCOPE, not of the meanings of the words.

|
v

THE STANDING OBJECTION

STRAWSON, "On Referring", Mind, 1950

Russell has confused a SENTENCE with a USE of a sentence. A speaker who says "The present King of France is bald" does not ASSERT that there is exactly one King of France; he PRESUPPOSES it. When the presupposition fails, THE QUESTION OF TRUTH OR FALSITY DOES NOT ARISE - the utterance is not false but VOID.

|
v

RUSSELL'S AVAILABLE REPLIES

- [1] Strawson describes conversational expectation; Russell gives TRUTH-CONDITIONS, and a logic requires them
- [2] presupposition failure needs a semantics of its own - typically a TRUTH-VALUE GAP - and gaps carry costs for classical logic
- [3] the analysis is a proposal about LOGICAL FORM for a scientifically regimented language, not ordinary-language lexicography

|
v

THE HONEST VERDICT

A GENUINE RIVAL ANALYSIS, not a demonstration of error. Strawson describes ordinary USE better; Russell describes LOGICAL FORM better. OWNER BOUNDARY: Strawson appears here as ONE OBJECTION. His positive theory of reference and his descriptive metaphysics are TOPIC 11.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/28: Russell - acquaintance, description and the Principle

=====

TWO KINDS OF KNOWLEDGE OF THINGS

ACQUAINTANCE direct, presentational, NON-INFERENTIAL - "directly aware... without the intermediary of any process of inference"

OBJECTS: sense-data | memory data | introspective data of one's own mental states | UNIVERSALS

DESCRIPTION indirect, propositional - knowledge THAT there is exactly one thing answering to "the F", plus what is inferred of it

OBJECTS: physical objects | other minds | historical persons | unobservables of science

|
v

THE PLATONIC CONCESSION: acquaintance with UNIVERSALS is a large admission for a philosopher in the British empiricist line, and Russell makes it openly AGAINST Berkeley's nominalism.

|

v
 THE PRINCIPLE OF ACQUAINTANCE (Problems of Philosophy, 1912, Ch. 5)
 "Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly
 of constituents with which we are acquainted."
 IT CONSTRAINS UNDERSTANDING, NOT TRUTH.

|
 v
 THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED
 1 to understand a proposition is to grasp its constituents
 2 I can grasp only what I am acquainted with
 3 yet I plainly understand propositions about Bismarck, Julius
 Caesar and electrons
 4 so EITHER the Principle is false OR those items are NOT
 constituents of the propositions
 5 THE THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS takes the second route: "the F is G"
 contains NO constituent "the F"; its constituents are the
 UNIVERSALS F and G plus logical apparatus - all acquaintance items
 6 therefore the Principle is PRESERVED

|
 v
 THE BISMARCK SERIES (Russell's own, graded)
 BISMARCK HIMSELF acquaintance with his own self-
 consciousness
 ONE WHO MET HIM acquaintance with sense-data he took to be
 of the man; the description is anchored to
 HIS particulars
 ONE WHO READ OF HIM purely descriptive: "the first Chancellor
 of the German Empire"
 ALL OF US, OF "THE MOST
 LONG-LIVED OF MEN" a description whose satisfier we may never
 identify - and the proposition is FULLY
 UNDERSTOOD

|
 v
 ANSWER LINE: "The theory of descriptions is the price Russell pays to
 keep the Principle of Acquaintance while speaking of what he has
 never met."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/28: Russell - logically proper names, and the two modern objections
 =====

LOGICALLY PROPER NAMES
 A symbol that DIRECTLY DESIGNATES an item of acquaintance and could
 not fail to designate.
 In Russell's austere phase the only serious candidates are the
 DEMONSTRATIVES "this" and "that", used of something PRESENTLY GIVEN.

|
 TWO CONSEQUENCES, BOTH EXAMINABLE
 [1] ORDINARY NAMES - "Bismarck", "Socrates", "Homer" - are DISGUISED
 DEFINITE DESCRIPTIONS, analysed by the theory of descriptions
 [2] the class of genuine names shrinks ALMOST TO NOTHING, and it
 shrinks DIFFERENTLY for each speaker and each moment

+-----+-----+		
KRIPKE, Naming and Necessity	SELLARS, "Empiricism and	
lectures 1970, book 1980	the Philosophy of Mind",	
	1956	
+-----+-----+		
Ordinary proper names are NOT	THE MYTH OF THE GIVEN:	
disguised descriptions.	nothing is given	
"Aristotle" would still name	uninterpreted, and what is	
Aristotle even if every	given non-conceptually	
description we associate with	cannot JUSTIFY beliefs.	
him were false. Names are RIGID		
DESIGNATORS.	RUSSELL'S REPLY:	
	acquaintance is	
RUSSELL'S RETREAT: confine the	PRESENTATION, not	
claim to LOGICALLY proper names	knowledge of truths.	
and abandon the description		
theory of ORDINARY names.	RESIDUAL: then how does it	
	GROUND anything? THE LIVE	
STANDARD VERDICT: the LOGIC of	WEAKNESS.	
descriptions survives; the		
THEORY OF NAMES does not.		
+-----+-----+		

v
KEEP THEM APART: Kripke attacks the theory of NAMES; Sellars attacks
the BASE. Different targets, different residues - and Russell can
survive one without surviving the other.

|
v
PHASE WARNING: sense-data acquaintance | the 1918 atomism | later
NEUTRAL MONISM are THREE POSITIONS at three times. Do not present
them as one timeless doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/28: Russell - logical constructions and the supreme maxim

=====

THE SUPREME MAXIM IN SCIENTIFIC PHILOSOPHISING (1914)

"Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities
for inferences to unknown entities."

SOURCES: "The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics"; Our Knowledge of
the External World. Restated in "Logical Atomism" (1924).

|
THE CHOICE IT FORCES

ROUTE A INFER a table BEHIND the appearances, never itself met
COST: an entity I can never check, doing explanatory work
I cannot inspect

ROUTE B DEFINE "the table" as an ordered system of ACTUAL and
POSSIBLE appearances from various viewpoints
COST: the system must really be specifiable

|
v
FOUR WORKED CONSTRUCTIONS - learn at least two of DIFFERENT types
a physical object ("this table") <- classes of ACTUAL and POSSIBLE
sense-data from various points of view
a "nation" <- patterns of behaviour of individual persons
a number <- classes of equinumerous classes (Frege-Russell)
a point of space <- convergent classes of volumes
THE SPREAD (perceptual | social | mathematical | geometrical) is the
evidence that the maxim is a METHOD, not a repair to one problem.

|
v
CONSTRUCTIONS vs ATOMS
ATOMS genuinely exist as independent simples within the
analysis; the RESIDUE analysis SEEKS
CONSTRUCTIONS ... add NO further entity; their SYMBOLS are defined
CONTEXTUALLY; what analysis REMOVES

|
v
THREE THINGS A CONSTRUCTION IS NOT
NOT a fiction - we say TRUE things about tables and nations
NOT an elimination of ordinary talk - the talk is preserved and
given truth-conditions
NOT a permanent phenomenalist metaphysics - a PROPOSED reduction /
structural reconstruction, and Russell's base later became
NEUTRAL EVENTS

|
v
THE STRAIN
The construction needs POSSIBLE sense-data ("sensibilia") from
viewpoints no one occupies. These are not straightforwardly KNOWN
entities, so the inference the maxim was meant to avoid may have
been smuggled back. And a private-sense-data base invites SOLIPSISM;
Russell's reply is that constructions are PUBLIC-THEORETICAL
reconstructions aimed at explanatory economy.

|
v
VERDICT: the TECHNIQUE is permanent; the 1914 PHENOMENALIST INVENTORY
is a phase. Distinguishing the two IS what "critically discuss" asks.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/28: Russell - logical atomism, and the 2020 sentence decoded

=====

"THE PHILOSOPHY OF LOGICAL ATOMISM" - lectures 1918, London; published
in The Monist 1918-19. THE PREFACE CREDITS THE IDEAS TO WITTGENSTEIN.

|
v
THE 2020 QUOTATION, DECODED CLAUSE BY CLAUSE (Q2(c))

"The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the
atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in
analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms."
"last residue in ANALYSIS" .. atomism is defined by a METHOD: what

survives when analysis has removed every complexity
 "LOGICAL ... NOT PHYSICAL" .. the atoms are constituents of FACTS -
 particulars, qualities, relations - not tiny bodies
 "my DOCTRINE" an ONTOLOGY read off a LOGIC, not a
 physics
 |
 v
 WORLD = FACTS, NOT THINGS
 A FACT is what makes a proposition true or false.
 FACTS ARE NOT THEMSELVES TRUE OR FALSE - they are TRUTH-MAKERS;
 propositions are TRUTH-BEARERS.
 A complete catalogue of OBJECTS would still leave undecided which of
 them have which qualities and how they are related. Only FACTS
 settle that.
 |
 v
 THE STRUCTURE OF AN ATOMIC FACT
 MONADIC a PARTICULAR exemplifies a QUALITY "this is red"
 RELATIONAL PARTICULARS stand in a RELATION
 "this is to the left of that"
 "ATOMIC" = CONTAINS NO OTHER FACTS AS CONSTITUENTS.
 It PLAINLY HAS constituents. Reading "atomic" as "partless" is as
 damaging as reading it as "microscopic".
 |
 v
 POINT OF CONTACT WITH THE TRACTATUS: 1.1 makes the same move - "the
 world is the totality of facts, not of things". BUT the two men
 agree that the world is FACTUAL and disagree about what the
 constituents of facts are and how we know them. See panel 28.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/28: Russell - truth-functions, isomorphism and negative facts
 =====

THE TWO-STOREY BUILDING
 UPPER: MOLECULAR PROPOSITIONS
 "this is red AND that is blue" | "... OR ..." | "NOT ..." |
 "IF ... THEN ..."
 TRUTH-VALUE fixed ENTIRELY by the atoms below plus the connective
 GROUND: ATOMIC PROPOSITIONS
 "this is red" | "this is to the left of that" - no connectives
 FOUNDATION: ATOMIC FACTS
 |
 v
 THE PAY-OFF OF TRUTH-FUNCTIONALITY
 NO ADDITIONAL FACT IN THE WORLD CORRESPONDS TO "and" OR "or".
 There is no conjunctive fact over and above the two conjuncts'
 facts. A large ONTOLOGICAL ECONOMY - state it, or you have
 described a truth-table instead of an argument.
 |
 v
 THE ISOMORPHISM THESIS

PROPOSITION	name1	----	relation-word	----	name2
FACT	object1	-----	relation	-----	object2

 SAME LOGICAL STRUCTURE. Names correspond to objects; the ARRANGEMENT
 of names corresponds to the ARRANGEMENT of objects. This is the
 BRIDGE between language and world in Russell's atomism.
 |
 v
 THE NEGATIVE-FACT PROBLEM
 "Socrates is not alive" is TRUE. What makes it true?
 RUSSELL: reluctantly, a NEGATIVE FACT - that a positive state does
 NOT obtain.
 COST: absences are added to the inventory of the world.
 WHY HE PAYS IT: to preserve a DIRECT TRUTH-MAKING relation - every
 truth is made true by something.
 WITTGENSTEIN'S DIFFERENT ROUTE: obtaining elementary states
 constitute the world, and their TOTALITY also determines which
 possible states do NOT obtain (2.05); negation is not a further
 object, and "the logical constants are not representatives"
 (4.0312). NO negative facts required.
 |
 v
 THE EXPOSED ASSUMPTION
 The programme requires that EVERY proposition be a truth-function of
 atomic ones. BELIEF-CONTEXTS ("George IV believes that p") and
 MODAL contexts resist this. Concede the difficulty; do not pretend

the reduction is complete.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/28: Russell - how far descriptions support atomism

=====

THE QUESTION OF 2018 Q4(c) AND 2024 Q3(a): how is the theory of descriptions RELATED to logical atomism?

|

v

WHAT DESCRIPTIONS DO SUPPLY

- [1] contextual analysis removes MERELY APPARENT CONSTITUENTS -
"the F" is shown not to be a constituent at all
- [2] what remains is QUANTIFIED STRUCTURE plus GENUINE LOGICAL CONSTITUENTS
- [3] that is exactly the discrimination atomism needs: real residues separated from grammatical illusions
- [4] methodological continuity - both rest on GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM. Descriptions show the principle has teeth; atomism is the ontology reached by applying it systematically

|

v

WHAT DESCRIPTIONS DO NOT SUPPLY

- [1] NO proof that analysis TERMINATES
 - [2] NO identification of the SIMPLES
 - [3] NO demonstration that reality is EXHAUSTIVELY atomic
- Removing one class of pseudo-constituents is not reaching a base.

|

v

THE VERDICT SENTENCE (write it)

"The theory of descriptions makes logical atomism REASONABLE and does not make it PROVED: it shows how a residue is reached in a particular case, and leaves open whether every analysis reaches one."

|

v

THE FOUR-STAGE ROUTE FOR THE 20-MARK ANSWER

ACQUAINTANCE fixes what is directly available

- > INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS supply the technique of elimination
 - > LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS apply it to the entities of common sense and science
 - > LOGICAL ATOMISM names the residue analysis expects to find
- CONNECTING SENTENCE: "Incomplete symbols supply the scalpel, constructions are the operations performed with it, and atomism is the anatomy the surgeon expects to find - which is why Russell can be confident in the technique long before he is confident about the inventory."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 23/28: The Tractatus - facts, objects and states of affairs

=====

THE OPENING ONTOLOGY

- 1 The world is all that is the case.
- 1.1 The world is the totality of FACTS, not of THINGS.
- 1.13 The facts in LOGICAL SPACE are the world.
- 2 What is the case, a fact, is the existence of STATES OF AFFAIRS.
- 2.01 A state of affairs is a COMBINATION OF OBJECTS.
- 2.013 Each thing is, as it were, in a SPACE of possible states of affairs - POSSIBILITY IS BUILT INTO THE OBJECT.
- 2.06 The existence and non-existence of states of affairs is reality.

|

v

WHY FACTS AND NOT THINGS

A complete inventory of objects leaves everything undecided: it does not tell you which qualities they have or how they are related. What is the case is a matter of CONFIGURATION, and a configuration is a FACT.

|

v

OBJECTS

Logical SIMPLES, characterised NOT by an intrinsic description but by the STATES OF AFFAIRS INTO WHICH THEY CAN ENTER (2.0121, 2.013). The space of possible configurations is fixed once the objects are. THE HONEST GAP: the text gives NO UNCONTESTED EXAMPLE of a simple object or an elementary proposition. It argues that simples are REQUIRED for determinate sense; it does not EXHIBIT them.

|

v
 TRANSLATION CONTROL
 Sachverhalt = "atomic fact" (Ogden/Ramsey) = "state of affairs"
 (Pears-McGuinness). CHOOSE ONE AND STAY WITH IT.
 |
 v
 CONTRAST WITH RUSSELL - do not merge
 RUSSELL'S atoms are identified EPISTEMICALLY, through acquaintance,
 in the 1918 phase.
 WITTGENSTEIN'S objects are POSTULATED by a CONDITION-OF-SENSE
 argument and are never identified.
 TWO ATOMISMS, ONE WORD.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/28: The Tractatus - the picture theory, and the two forms

=====
 THE PICTURING RELATION - three requirements
 (i) ELEMENTS of the picture (names) correspond to OBJECTS
 (ii) the ARRANGEMENT of the elements depicts an arrangement of the
 objects
 (iii) a METHOD OF PROJECTION connects sign to situation: the
 propositional SIGN plus its PROJECTIVE RELATION to the world
 is the PROPOSITION (3.11-3.12)
 TRUE if the depicted state of affairs obtains
 FALSE if it does not
 MEANINGFUL EITHER WAY, because a POSSIBLE arrangement is presented
 (2.201-2.203, 2.221-2.224)
 2.223 "to tell whether a picture is true or false we must compare it
 with reality"
 2.224 "it is impossible to tell from the picture alone whether it is
 true or false"

+-----+-----+ PICTORIAL FORM LOGICAL FORM (Form der Abbildung) (logische Form) +-----+-----+	
+-----+-----+ what a picture must share the MOST ABSTRACT structural with reality to depict it commonality - what EVERY AT ALL, IN ITS OWN MEDIUM picture, in ANY medium, must share with reality (2.18) +-----+-----+	
+-----+-----+ a SPATIAL model shares every meaningful proposition spatial form; a SCORE shares LOGICAL form with the shares acoustic form fact it depicts +-----+-----+	
+-----+-----+ a picture can depict only a proposition can depict ANY what shares ITS form fact whatever - logical form is the UNIVERSAL medium +-----+-----+	
RELATION: logical form is what the pictorial forms HAVE IN COMMON. EVERY picture is a LOGICAL picture (2.182); not every picture is spatial or musical.	

|
 v
 HOW LOGICAL FORM DEFINES THE LANGUAGE-WORLD RELATION (2022 Q3(c),
 second half - do not omit it)
 Because logical form is COMMON to proposition and fact, language and
 world are not two realms needing a bridge. The relation is INTERNAL -
 constitutive of the proposition's being a picture at all - not an
 external correlation fixed by convention or causal contact.

|
 v
 PROVENANCE: "picture theory" is the COMMENTATORS' label. Wittgenstein
 writes Bild (picture/model) and abbilden (to depict). Say "the
 doctrine usually called the picture theory".
 CONSEQUENCE: logical form is NOT a depictable fact - any depiction
 would presuppose it. IT SHOWS ITSELF (4.12, 4.121, 4.1212).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 25/28: The Tractatus - bipolarity, logical space and the Grundgedanke

=====
 BIPOLARITY - THE CONDITION OF SENSE
 A proposition has SENSE (Sinn) only if it CAN be true and CAN be
 false. STRONGER than bivalence, which says only that it HAS one of
 two values.
 ANCHORS 4.06 | 2.223 | 2.224; the TERM comes from Notes on Logic
 (1913).

WHY IT DOES SO MUCH WORK

- 1 to depict is to represent something AS being the case
- 2 to represent something as being the case is to allow that it might NOT be the case
- 3 therefore sense requires the genuine availability of BOTH truth-values

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LOGICAL SPACE - WHERE THE POSSIBILITIES LIVE

- 1.13 the facts in logical space are the world
- 2.11 a picture presents a situation in logical space
- 3.4 a proposition DETERMINES A PLACE in logical space
- 3.41 the propositional sign and the logical co-ordinates: that is the logical place
- 3.42 the existence of the logical place is guaranteed by the mere existence of the constituent parts
- 4.463 a proposition "is like a solid body that restricts the freedom of movement of others" - A PROPOSITION IS A LIMIT ON HOW THE WORLD MAY BE

ANALOGY: logical space is to propositions what a COORDINATE SYSTEM is to points - to specify a point you need the whole grid.

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FOUR CONSEQUENCES

- SENSE IS HOLISTIC to understand p is to understand not-p:
the same logical place, opposite pole
- NEGATION IS NOT AN OBJECT 4.0312, the GRUNDGEDANKE: "my fundamental idea is that the 'logical constants' are not representatives"
- THE WORLD IS DETERMINATE 2.013 - possibility is built into the object, not added to it
- LIMITS OF LANGUAGE =
LIMITS OF THE WORLD ... 5.6 - one cannot think outside logical space, so its bounds cannot be described from outside

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ANSWER LINE: "If the world could not refute it, it did not tell you anything."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/28: The Tractatus - general form, N-operator, two failures

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THE GENERAL FORM OF THE PROPOSITION - give BOTH formulations

- (a) INFORMAL, 4.5: "THIS IS HOW THINGS STAND"
(Es verhaelt sich so und so). OGDEN: "Such and such is the case". FLAG THE RENDERING.
- (b) FORMAL, 6:
[p , x , N(x)]
p (p-bar) the totality of ELEMENTARY propositions
x (xi-bar) ... any arbitrarily selected SET of propositions already formed
N(x) the result of applying the N-OPERATOR

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THE N-OPERATOR (5.502, 5.51) = JOINT NEGATION: none of the selected propositions is true.

- not-p = N(p)
p or q = N(N(p,q))
p and q = N(N(p), N(q))

Quantification through sets of values of propositional functions (5.52); adequacy for INFINITE or MULTIPLY GENERAL cases is DISPUTED.

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WHAT PROPOSITION 6 ASSERTS

- 1 every proposition is a TRUTH-FUNCTION of elementary propositions(5)
- 2 every truth-function is producible by repeated application of ONE operation, N
- 3 so there is ONE general form - that of a FORMAL SERIES generated from the elementary base
- 4 so LOGIC NEEDS NO PRIMITIVE PROPOSITIONS AND NO LOGICAL OBJECTS - the DECISIVE BREAK with Russell and Frege
- 5 so "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251), and logic's propositions are TAUTOLOGIES (6.1)
- 6 so whatever cannot be produced by this rule IS NOT A PROPOSITION - the general form is the CRITERION OF THE SAYABLE

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THE TWO WAYS OF FAILING TO SAY ANYTHING

SINNLOS (senseless, but WELL FORMED)
 TAUTOLOGY true under every truth-condition; excludes NOTHING
 "it is raining or it is not raining"
 CONTRADICTION . false under every truth-condition; excludes
 EVERYTHING
 They belong to the symbolism and SHOW the scaffolding of logic
 (4.461-4.4611, 6.124). NOT nonsensical.
 UNSINNIG (nonsensical)
 "The Absolute is perfect"; "There are objects"
 Depicts NO possible situation; never entered logical space at all.
 THIS IS THE MOST TESTED DISCRIMINATION IN THE TRACTATUS.

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FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS - state as PRESSURES, not as conceded refutations
 [1] there ARE elementary propositions and simple objects - no
 uncontested example is given
 [2] elementary propositions are LOGICALLY INDEPENDENT (2.061, 4.211)
 - COLOUR EXCLUSION pressures this: "this patch is red all over"
 and "this patch is blue all over" are incompatible although
 neither looks like a truth-function of the other. Wittgenstein
 addressed it in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (1929) and
 quickly abandoned the proposed analysis.
 [3] ALL propositions are truth-functions of elementary ones -
 belief-contexts (5.54-5.542) and modality create difficulties
 [4] the N-operator can handle INFINITE domains - disputed
 BOUNDARY: colour exclusion diagnoses a pressure; it does NOT license
 importing MEANING AS USE, which is TOPIC 08.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 27/28: The Tractatus - saying, showing, the limit, the ladder and 7

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THE DERIVATION - why the distinction is FORCED, not stipulated
 1 a proposition depicts by SHARING logical form with what it depicts
 2 to DEPICT that sharing, a further picture would have to stand
 OUTSIDE logical form and represent it as one fact among others
 3 but any picture whatever ALREADY HAS logical form - there is no
 representation from outside representation
 4 a REGRESS also threatens: each attempted statement of form would
 need its own form stated
 5 THEREFORE logical form is NOT SAYABLE. It SHOWS ITSELF in every
 proposition that has it (4.12, 4.121, 4.1212)
 4.1212 "WHAT CAN BE SHOWN, CANNOT BE SAID."

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+-----+-----+	
CAN BE SAID (gesagt)	CAN ONLY BE SHOWN (gezeigt)
+-----+-----+	
propositions of NATURAL	LOGICAL FORM
SCIENCE (6.53)	THE EXISTENCE OF OBJECTS
contingent states of	LOGICAL TRUTHS - the scaffolding
affairs	of the world (6.124)
	ETHICS, AESTHETICS, THE MEANING
	OF LIFE, THE MYSTICAL
	THE LANGUAGE-WORLD RELATION
+-----+-----+	

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VALUE - the exact propositions
 6.41 the sense of the world must lie OUTSIDE the world; in the
 world everything is as it is, and in it there is NO VALUE
 6.42 there can be NO PROPOSITIONS OF ETHICS
 6.421 ethics cannot be put into words; ethics is TRANSCENDENTAL
 6.522 "there is indeed the inexpressible; this SHOWS itself; it is
 the MYSTICAL"
 NOT A DISMISSAL: ethical claims are NOT declared FALSE and NOT
 declared unimportant. A DIFFERENT VERDICT, and a more respectful one.

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THE LIMIT IS DRAWN FROM INSIDE
 PREFACE: the limit "can only be drawn in language, and what lies on
 the other side of the limit will simply be nonsense"
 5.6 the limits of my language mean the limits of my world
 5.61 we cannot say what we cannot think, so we cannot say what we
 cannot say
 SOLIPSISM, BOUNDED ORIENTATION ONLY
 5.62 "what the solipsist MEANS is quite correct, only it cannot be
 SAID: it shows itself"

5.632-5.633 the subject does not belong to the world; it is a
 LIMIT of the world - THE EYE IS NOT IN THE VISUAL FIELD
 5.64 strictly maintained, solipsism COINCIDES WITH PURE REALISM
 USE TO ILLUSTRATE THE BOUNDARY. The private-language critique is
 TOPIC 08.

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SELF-APPLICATION, THE LADDER AND 7

Every sentence of the Tractatus is about logical form, objects and
 the limits of language. BY ITS OWN TEST NONE SAYS ANYTHING.

6.54 (Pears-McGuinness): "anyone who understands me eventually
 recognises them as nonsensical, when he has used them - as steps -
 to climb beyond them. (He must, so to speak, throw away the ladder
 after he has climbed it.)"

7 OGDEN: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent."
 PEARS-McGUINNESS: "What we cannot speak about we must pass over
 in silence."

NAME THE TRANSLATION. THERE IS NO PROPOSITION 7.1 - proposition 7
 is deliberately uncommented and stands alone.

6.53 THE METHOD: say nothing except what can be said, and whenever
 someone attempts a metaphysical statement, demonstrate that he
 has given no meaning to certain signs.

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TWO READINGS - state both, then rule

STANDARD / INEFFABILITY .. logical form, value and the mystical
 MANIFEST themselves although they cannot be stated as facts
 RESOLUTE / THERAPEUTIC ... (Diamond, Conant) 6.54 licenses NO body of
 ineffable truths; the apparent doctrines are ELUCIDATORY NONSENSE
 BOTH AGREE: ethics, aesthetics and the mystical are NOT factual
 propositions within logical space.

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VERDICT: justified as a DERIVED DIAGNOSIS - one structural error
 generates the whole family of philosophical problems; NOT fully
 justified as a STATEABLE DOCTRINE, because the boundary cannot be
 stated without transgressing itself. 4.112: philosophy is an
 ACTIVITY, not a body of doctrine.

NO VERIFICATION PRINCIPLE ANYWHERE IN THE TRACTATUS - TOPIC 07.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 28/28: Comparison, criticism ledger, PYQ routing and the answer spine

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COMPARE BY AXIS, NOT BY PARAGRAPH

AXIS	MOORE	RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
TARGET	scepticism and idealist conflation	misleading grammar and ontological inflation	conditions and LIMITS of propositional sense
CORE TOOL	common sense + act/object	logical analysis (descriptions)	picture theory of propositions
ONTOLOGY	ordinary objects accepted; full perceptual theory UNDER- DETERMINED	particulars, qualities / relations, facts, phase-specific constructions	facts in logical space; simple objects UNSPECIFIED
METAPHYSICS	reject conclusions less certain than truisms	eliminate pseudo- constituents; test what remains	factual propositions SAY; logic, value and metaphysics raise SAY/SHOW
SELF	conscious ACT distinguished from its OBJECT	acquaintance framework varies across phases	solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the LIMIT
LEGACY	analytic / common-sense method	formal analysis and ontological economy	influences positivism, then his OWN later criticism

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THE TWO ATOMISMS

ATOMS acquainted particulars + qualities/relations (R) vs
 UNSPECIFIED objects fixed by combinatorial
 possibility (W)

GROUND logic + a changing acquaintance epistemology (R) vs
 a CONDITION-OF-SENSE argument (W)

INDEPENDENCE .. acknowledged loosely (R) vs STRICTLY insisted upon
 (W), 2.061 and 4.211

NEGATION NEGATIVE FACTS accepted (R) vs the TOTALITY account,

2.05 and 4.0312 (W)
 EXPRESSION 1918 lectures, preface crediting W (R) vs Tractatus,
 written 1918, German 1921, bilingual 1922 (W)
 RULING: TWO ATOMISMS WITH A COMMON ANCESTRY, NOT ONE DOCTRINE.

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CRITICISM LEDGER - always finish with the RESIDUAL

MOORE begs the question -> comparative + dialectical replies ->
 RESIDUAL: no NEUTRAL MEASURE of certainty
 paradox of analysis -> knowledge does not wait on analysis
 -> RESIDUAL: the paradox has no settled Moorean solution

RUSSELL Strawson 1950 -> truth-conditions are what a logic requires
 -> RESIDUAL: a GENUINE RIVAL ANALYSIS
 logically proper names -> restriction accepted openly ->
 RESIDUAL: the class shrinks almost to nothing
 negative facts -> a truth-making cost -> RESIDUAL: NO
 FIXED FINAL INVENTORY

TRACTATUS ethics not factual -> deliberate demarcation -> RESIDUAL:
 standard vs resolute disagree on ineffable truths
 self-application -> 6.54 concedes the ladder -> RESIDUAL:
 successful therapy OR unstable doctrine, disputed
 no exemplified simples -> required for determinate sense ->
 RESIDUAL: necessity does not identify an actual base

THREE DIFFERENT FAILURES: Moore's gap is EPISTEMOLOGICAL, Russell's
 is ONTOLOGICAL, Wittgenstein's concerns the STATUS OF PHILOSOPHICAL
 DISCOURSE. Merging them loses the assessment mark.

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PYQ ROUTING - 14 OWNED PARTS OF 112, JOINT-HIGHEST, ONE IN EVERY YEAR

MOORE (5)	2019 Q3(c) 15 2020 Q2(b) 15 2021 Q3(a) 20
	2024 Q1(c) 10 2025 Q3(c) 15
RUSSELL (6)	2018 Q4(c) 15 2020 Q2(c) 15 2022 Q1(b) 10
	2023 Q4(b) 15 2024 Q3(a) 20 2025 Q1(d) 10
WITTGENSTEIN(3)	2018 Q3(c) 15 2021 Q4(c) 15 2022 Q3(c) 15
SUPPORTING, OWNED ELSEWHERE:	2018 Q3(a) 20 (Empiricism)
	2023 Q4(c) 15 and 2025 Q3(a) 20 (Later Wittgenstein)

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ANSWER SPINE

10 problem -> analysis -> result -> point
 15 frame -> doctrine -> quote -> key move -> result -> assess
 20 frame -> incomplete symbols -> constructions -> atomism ->
 assess -> close

DIRECTIVES: descriptions demand NOTATION | quotations demand that you
 LOCATE THE SENTENCE | saying/showing demands the DERIVATION | Moore
 demands the STRUCTURE OF THE REVERSAL | 2020 Q2(c) demands the
 QUOTED PHRASES DECODED | "how is X related to Y" demands SUPPORT,
 NOT ENTAILMENT | comparison demands an AXIS

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QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

Three programmes, one method used for three incompatible purposes,
 each leaving something deliberately unfinished. MOORE redistributes
 the burden of proof and leaves the ANALYSIS open. RUSSELL secures
 ontological economy and leaves the INVENTORY open. EARLY
 WITTGENSTEIN fixes the conditions of sense with unmatched rigour and
 leaves THE STATUS OF HIS OWN BOOK open. Permanent achievements:
 the reversal of the sceptical burden | the quantificational analysis
 of definite descriptions | sense as determinate exclusion within a
 field of possibilities. Permanent costs: no neutral measure of
 certainty | no completed base | no consistent way of stating the
 boundary the Tractatus draws. State an achievement AND its matching
 cost in the same sentence, and the clause has been understood.